National Institute of Food and Agriculture
U.S. DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE

NOTICE OF FUNDING OPPORTUNITY

Agriculture and Food Research Initiative
Competitive Grants Program
Education and Workforce Development

FUNDING YEAR:	Fiscal Year (FY) 2026
LETTER OF INTENT DEADLINE:	Varies by Program Area Priority (see *Part I, C*)
APPLICATION DEADLINE:	Varies by Program Area Priority (see *Part I, C*)
ANTICIPATED PROGRAM FUNDING:	$39,700,000
FUNDING OPPORTUNITY NUMBER:	USDA-NIFA-AFRI-011596
ASSISTANCE LISTING NUMBER:	10.310

ANNOUNCEMENT

National Institute of Food and Agriculture
United States Department of Agriculture

Assistance Listing Number: The Agriculture and Food Research Initiative (AFRI) Education and Workforce Development (EWD) is listed in the Assistance Listings under number 10.310.

Table 1: Key Dates and Deadlines

Task Description	Deadline
Application:	5:00 P.M. Eastern Time, on the DATE 2026 deadline dates indicated in Part I, C
Letter of Intent:	Only required for A7001, 5:00 P.M. Eastern Time, on the LOI deadline dates indicated in *Part I § C.7*
Applicants Comments:	Within six months from the issuance of this notice (NIFA may not consider comments received after the sixth month)

Table 2: Program Area Priorities and Deadlines

Program Area Priority	**2026 Review Cycle Deadlines**[1]
1. Professional Development for Agricultural Literacy (A7501)	Thursday, March 19, 2026
2. Agricultural Workforce Training at Community Colleges (A7601)	Thursday, March 19, 2026
3. Food and Agricultural Non-formal Education (A7801)	Thursday, March 19, 2026
4. Research and Extension Experiences for Undergraduates (A7401)	Thursday, March 19, 2026
5. Predoctoral Fellowships (A7101)	Thursday, April 16, 2026
6. Postdoctoral Fellowships (A7201)	Thursday, April 30, 2026
7. Education and Workforce Development Workshop Grants (A7001)	Continuous throughout the year but at least 210 days before the start of the workshop and upon invitation after submission of a Letter of Intent at least 255 days before the workshop begins.

[1] All applications must be received by 5:00 p.m. Eastern Time on the deadline date.

The United States Department of Agriculture (USDA), to the extent permitted by law, will no longer make grants or otherwise fund programs or activities that improperly discriminate on the basis of race or sex, including discrimination in the name of Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion policies. Instead, USDA will prioritize merit and efficiency. USDA recognizes programs and initiatives will have the greatest impact when these programs and initiatives put American farmers, ranchers, and foresters first by:

- solving the most pressing challenges they face;
- protecting America's food, fuel, and fiber supply to enhance national security;
- supporting production of healthy and safe food for consumers;
- expanding and developing domestic markets;
- training the next generation of agriculturalists; and
- fueling innovation to keep American farmers at the forefront of productivity.

The National Institute of Food and Agriculture (NIFA) is committed to advancing these principles and encourages applicants to actively engage farmers, ranchers, and foresters when applying for funding opportunities to ensure relevancy and adherence to them. NIFA also encourages agricultural leaders to engage in the peer review panel process to ensure American producers are better served through research, education, and extension activities.

Stakeholder Input. NIFA seeks comments on all Notice of Funding Opportunities (NOFOs) so it can deliver programs efficiently, effectively, with integrity, and with a focus on customer service. NIFA considers comments to the extent possible when developing NOFOs, and uses comments to help meet the requirements of (7 U.S.C. 7613(c)(2)). Applicants may submit written comments to Policy@usda.gov. Please use the following subject line: Response to the AFRI Education and Workforce Development NOFO.

Centers of Excellence. Applicants are encouraged to visit NIFA's Centers of Excellence (COE) webpage for information on the COE designation process, including COE criteria, and a list of programs offering COE opportunities. A recording of COE outreach and COE implementation webinars are also available.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This notice identifies the objectives for AFRI EWD program projects, deadlines, funding information, eligibility criteria for projects and applicants, and application forms and associated instructions.

The anticipated amount available for new grants for the deadlines in this NOFO is approximately $39.7 million in AFRI funding. Additional projects submitted under this NOFO may be considered should funding become available beyond the amount listed above.

The AFRI is America's flagship competitive grants program that provides funding for fundamental and applied research, education, and extension projects in the food and agricultural sciences. In 2026, NIFA requests applications for the AFRI's EWD program area priorities to support:

1. professional development opportunities for K-14 educational professionals;
2. non-formal education that cultivates food and agricultural interest in youth;
3. workforce training at community, junior, and technical colleges;
4. training of undergraduate students in research and extension;
5. fellowships for predoctoral candidates;
6. fellowships for postdoctoral scholars; and
7. education and workforce development workshop grants.

This NOFO solicits Standard Grants and Food and Agricultural Science Enhancement (FASE) Grants, whereas project types solicited in this NOFO are Research, Education, Extension, and Integrated Research, Education, and/or Extension projects. Grant types and project types solicited vary by program area priority, and not all grant types are solicited within each program area priority. See *Part I, C* for grant and project types solicited by each specific program area priority and *Part II, C* for a description of each individual grant type and project type.

Applications from and collaborations with institutions eligible for Strengthening Grants are welcome. More information is available on the AFRI FASE and Established Program to Stimulate Competitive Research (EPSCoR) page.

2026 UPDATES

1. A Mentoring Plan (MentP) is now required for all AFRI grant applications solicited in this NOFO (excluding workshop grants) for projects that involve any type of education, training or mentoring of students or other individuals including high school students, undergraduate students, graduate students, professional degree students, postdoctoral scholars, other professionals or any other individual receiving any type of formal, or non-formal training on the proposed project. For additional important details, see the "FY 2026 AFRI Education and Workforce Development NOFO Additional Information for Part IV, C" on the AFRI NOFO Resources webpage.
2. Year-round Workshop Grant applications are accepted after submission of a Letter of Intent (LOI), see Part I § C for more information. The LOI must be submitted a minimum of 255 days before the start of the workshop. The full Workshop Grant application must be submitted a minimum of 210 days before the start of the workshop.

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PART I. FUNDING OPPORTUNITY DESCRIPTION

A. Legislative Authority

Section 2(b) of the Competitive, Special, and Facilities Research Grant Act (hereafter referred to as the Act) (7 U.S.C. 3157), as amended, authorizes the Agriculture and Food Research Initiative (AFRI), a competitive grant program, to provide funding for fundamental and applied research, education, and extension to address food and agricultural sciences in the following six priority areas:

1. Plant health and production and plant products;
2. Animal health and production and animal products;
3. Food safety, nutrition, and health;
4. Bioenergy, natural resources, and environment;
5. Agriculture systems and technology; and
6. Agriculture economics and rural communities.

To the maximum extent practicable, NIFA, in coordination with the Under Secretary for Research, Education, and Economics (REE), will make grants for high priority research, education, and extension, taking into consideration, when available, the determinations made by the National Agricultural Research, Extension, Education, and Economics Advisory Board (NAREEEAB) pursuant to the Competitive, Special, and Facilities Research Grant Act (7 U.S.C. 3157). The Secretary delegates the authority to the Under Secretary for Research, Education and Economics in 7 CFR 2.21, and the Under Secretary delegates that authority to NIFA in 7 CFR 2.66.

B. Purpose and Priorities

The purpose of AFRI (listed in the Assistance Listings under number 10.310) is to support research, education, and extension projects that will help farmers, ranchers, foresters, and other agricultural producers address key problems of local, regional, and national importance in sustaining food and agricultural systems. These include farm and ranch production efficiency, profitability, and sustainability; domestic biofuels and bio-based products; forestry; aquaculture; rural communities and entrepreneurship; human nutrition; mitigating impacts of biotic and abiotic constraints on food production; food safety; prevention of agricultural pests and diseases, and genetic improvement of plants and animals. In addition, the economic sustainability of food systems is an overarching priority for the projects funded in response to this NOFO; therefore, projects focusing on plant or animal species or commodities that are important to small- or medium-sized farms or ranches are also welcome. Through this support, AFRI advances knowledge in both fundamental and applied sciences important to agriculture. Additionally, AFRI supports work in education and extension activities that deliver science-based knowledge to end users, allowing them to make informed, practical decisions. This AFRI EWD NOFO provides funding for research-only, education-only, extension-only, and/or integrated research, education, and/or extension projects addressing the six priorities identified in *Part I, A*. Each Program Area Priority within this NOFO may offer all or some of these project types.

Addressing agricultural challenges requires research, education, extension, and integrated programs in concert with science-based approaches that increase the production capability of agriculture and natural resources.

Background
AFRI is NIFA's flagship competitive grants portfolio for food and agricultural sciences, and funding is offered through the Foundational and Applied Science (FAS), Sustainable Agricultural Systems (SAS), and Education and Workforce Development (EWD) NOFOs for addressing critical societal issues.

The Program Area Priorities in this NOFO address the following legislatively-authorized sub-priorities:

A. Plant Health and Production and Plant Products;
B. Animal Health and Production and Animal Products;
C. Food Safety, Nutrition, and Health;
D. Bioenergy, Natural Resources, and Environment;
E. Agriculture Systems and Technology; and
F. Agriculture Economics and Rural Communities.

C. Program Area Description
The Program Area Priorities in this NOFO address projected shortfalls of qualified graduates in the agricultural, food, forestry, range, and energy resources sectors of the U.S. economy (Employment Opportunities for College Graduates). Applicants are encouraged to develop projects that equip students with the foundational knowledge and skills in Artificial Intelligence (AI), preparing them to thrive in an increasingly digital society or support educators with tools and training needed not only train students about AI, but also to utilize AI in their classrooms to improve educational outcomes. Projects may create training programs that equip participants with essential skills and competencies across the respective program area priority learning pathways. This NOFO seeks applications for education and training grants that focus on further enhancing the distinct components of the pipeline for developing the workforce in the food and agricultural sciences. The AFRI EWD Program Area Priorities have four overarching goals:

1. Growing Agricultural Literacy and Workforce Development for the Future offers institutional grants to provide K-14 teachers and administrators with increased knowledge of the food and agricultural sciences and help them develop improved curricula to train the agricultural workforce for the future. See *Part I, C.1* **"Professional Development for Agricultural Literacy" (Program Code A7501**).
2. Training or Retraining of Agricultural Workers provides institutional training grants to develop a technology- and data-savvy workforce ready for the field and industrial jobs. See *Part I, C.2* for **"Agricultural Workforce Training Grants at Community Colleges" (Program Code A7601).**
3. Developing Pathways provides formal or non-formal education and experiential learning for students to enter or gain skills applicable to the food and agriculture fields. This NOFO seeks to support the development of non-formal education activities that cultivate interest and build public confidence in the safe and enhanced use of technology in food and agricultural sciences. See *Part I, C.3* for **"Food and Agricultural Non-formal Education" (Program Code A7801)**. This NOFO also offers grants that propose formal experiential learning for undergraduates in food, agriculture, or allied disciplines and helps them learn the technical and leadership

skills required for employment in the food and agricultural sectors or for graduate programs. See *Part I C.4* for **"Research and Extension Experiences for Undergraduates" (Program Code A7401)**.

4. Advancing Science supports graduate and post-graduate education in food and agriculture disciplines. See *Part I C.5* and *Part I C.6* for **"Predoctoral Fellowships" (Program Code A7101)** and **"Postdoctoral Fellowships" (Program Code A7201)**, respectively.

Total AFRI EWD Program Funds – Approximately $39.7 million. Additional projects submitted under this NOFO will be considered should funding become available beyond the amount indicated above.

Key Information Applicable to all AFRI EWD Program Area Priorities:

1. All applications must adhere to the requirements in *Part IV*.
2. All applications to the AFRI EWD Program Area must be aligned with at least one of the six AFRI Farm Bill Priority Areas (*Part I, A*) and must address the Program Area Priorities described subsequently.
3. All AFRI EWD projects are required to provide opportunities for development of leadership skills which are necessary for preparing project participants for agriculture-related careers in the private sector, government, and academia. Projects must demonstrably incorporate a leadership development component through competencies, such as critical thinking, problem-solving, teamwork, communication skills, and training in ethics and professionalism.
4. The AFRI EWD Program Area Priorities anticipate funding projects with measurable outcomes/objectives. These may include but are not limited to: 1) number and duration of students and participants that are supported directly or undertaking internships, externships, certifications, and other experiential learning opportunities; 2) number of K-14 teachers, educational professionals, and/or students who indirectly benefit from the projects; 3) number of international experiences that promote American leadership in innovation and ingenuity; 4) number of publications, patents, and workshops; 5) quality of developed curricula materials, or academic programs; 6) success of recruitment and retention programs; 7) quality of collaborations developed among institutions; 8) measurable changes in student learning or engagement; and 9) measurable changes in the number of graduates in food and agricultural science disciplines.
5. Applications that include study abroad or collaborations with international mentors must also include a description of how that experiential learning will directly benefit U.S. food and agriculture production systems; improve agricultural education and teaching, as well as promote American leadership in innovation and ingenuity as described in this Notice of Funding Opportunities.
6. A MentP is now required for all AFRI grant applications (excluding workshop grants) for projects that involve any type of education, training or mentoring of students or other individuals including high school students, undergraduate students, graduate students, professional degree students, postdoctoral scholars, other professionals or any other individual receiving any type of formal, or non-formal training on the proposed project. For additional important details, see the AFRI NOFO Resources webpage. For

predoctoral and postdoctoral fellowships, please consult the specific Program Area Priority's narrative guidance for MentP requirements.

Applications are solicited in the following seven Program Area Priorities:

1. Professional Development for Agricultural Literacy (PDAL)
2. Agricultural Workforce Training at Community Colleges (AWT)
3. Food and Agricultural Non-Formal Education (FANE)
4. Research and Extension Experiences for Undergraduates (REEU)
5. Predoctoral Fellowships
6. Postdoctoral Fellowships
7. Education and Workforce Development Workshop Grants

For a program informational webinar please visit the NIFA calendar for dates, event registration, and link. If you need a reasonable accommodation to participate in any of the informational webinars listed, please contact the event host listed no later than 10 days prior to the event.

Program Area 1. Professional Development for Agricultural Literacy

Table 3: Professional Development for Agricultural Literacy Key Information

Title	Description
Program Code:	A7501
Program Code Name:	Professional Development for Agricultural Literacy
Assistance Listing Number	10.310
Project Type(s):	Education, Extension, or Integrated Projects only
Grant Type(s):	a. Standard Grants and FASE (Strengthening Standard) Grants only b. See *Part II, C.2* for requirements specific to FASE Grant applications.
Application Deadline	**FY 2026:** Thursday, March 19, 2026 (5:00 p.m. Eastern Time)
Grant Duration:	36-48 months
Maximum Award Amount(s):	a. Including indirect costs: $500,000 b. A minimum of 50% of project direct costs requested must be for participant support. c. Each review cycle NIFA may award up to two grants per lead institution.
Program Area Priority Contact(s):	A7501@usda.gov

Program Area Priority:
The PDAL Program Area Priority seeks to increase the number of K-14 educational professionals trained in the food and agricultural sciences. Participants (teachers, post-baccalaureate pre-service teachers, counselors, administrators) are expected to develop and apply skills necessary for integrating food and agricultural science concepts in their classes; explore the opportunities available in food and agricultural science career paths; and/or forge mentorships with professional and business leaders, and faculty at two- and four-year institutions.

Education, Extension, or Integrated Projects must:

a. Promote faculty expertise and encourage widespread implementation of educational innovation at K-14 levels in the food and agricultural sciences. This includes topics that contain elements of the human sciences (e.g., disciplines that address issues challenging individuals, youth, families, and communities).
b. Provide immersive learning experiences (e.g., teacher hands-on research, teacher experiential learning), curriculum development and implementation, and teaching training for K-14 education professionals (e.g., teachers, counselors, administrators) and post-baccalaureate pre-service teachers to create and replicate best practices to improve student success outcomes within the food and agricultural sciences.
    1) Projects including curriculum development components must be led by or include key personnel with curriculum development credentials to ensure materials produced comply with the most appropriate pedagogy, teaching standards, and other applicable institutional, state, and national accreditation requirements.
    2) For the purposes of this Program Area Priority, immersive learning experiences refer

to those activities that allow the participant (i.e., K-14 education professionals) to learn by doing and participating in meaningful experiences. After being presented with a problem, participants research, try, solve, and reflect on the process allowing them to apply the lesson more broadly to their classroom, teaching, and lives.

c. Non-exhaustive examples of projects include:
   1) Developing self-sustaining models for professional development that better prepare education professionals to provide outstanding teaching, guidance, institutional structures, etc., that enhance student outcomes in the food and agricultural sciences.
   2) Changing instructional approaches to effectively identify skill gaps and address conceptual areas particularly challenging to students.
   3) Integrating innovations in science and pedagogy into existing professional development programs (e.g., through hands-on research and extension experiences with partner institutions and laboratories).
   4) Exploring self-sustaining web-based approaches for professional development for education professionals.
   5) Adapting curricula to train or retrain agricultural workforce for the future.
   6) Other methods to fill the existing gap of professional development in advanced food and agricultural sciences for education professionals at the K-14 education level.

Additional Information:

a. Requests exceeding budgetary guidelines will not be reviewed.
b. Unless otherwise stated, grants are not renewable.
c. Application and submission information, including page limits and narrative font sizes, for this Program Area Priority is available on the AFRI NOFO Resources webpage. Proposals that do not comply with these instructions may be excluded from review and consideration of funding.
d. A minimum of 50% of project direct costs for PDAL projects must be for participant support, including items such as participant stipends, cost of subsistence (housing, meals) and dependent care for immersive experiences, reasonable travel, classroom materials and teaching kits, and laboratory use fees. Participant support costs included in subawards may count towards the 50% minimum.
e. Use of undergraduate or graduate students as project staff is allowed under this Program Area Priority as long as the requested effort support is allocable, reasonable, and necessary for the execution of the project. Undergraduate and graduate student tuition remission costs are not allowed.
f. Projects that create educator training opportunities that help effectively integrate Artificial Intelligence-based understanding, tools, and modalities into classrooms and curriculum focused on food and agricultural sciences are welcome.
g. Projects in elementary and middle school education settings are welcome.
h. Projects integrating participant interpersonal skill development activities and training for effective in-person and/or virtual teaching are welcome.
i. Projects that involve participation from industry and nonprofit organizations through collaborating mentors and/or that connect education professionals to existing USDA and Federal resources (e.g., USDA Agricultural Research Service, USDA Forest Service, other Federal laboratories, open data resources) to enhance student outcomes in the food and agricultural sciences are welcome.

j. As applicable, if the majority of project activities are taking place off-site, off-campus indirect cost rates should be charged.
k. If organized by the Program Area Priority, the PD will be required to attend one NIFA AFRI EWD PD meeting during the performance period of the award. Reasonable travel expenses must be included as part of the project budget. While budgets should account for this travel, NIFA may consider virtual, or hybrid meetings.
l. Reasonable costs for evaluation and hiring of evaluation professionals may be included.
m. A MentP is required. For additional important details, see the AFRI NOFO Resources webpage.

Program Area 2. Agricultural Workforce Training at Community Colleges

Table 4: Agricultural Workforce Training at Community Colleges Key Information

Title	Description
Program Code:	A7601
Program Code Name:	Agricultural Workforce Training Grants
Assistance Listing Number:	10.310
Project Type(s):	Education Projects only a. Education Projects only for **Standard Grants and Strengthening Standard Grants**
Grant Type(s):	a. Standard Grants, and FASE (Strengthening Standard) Grants only b. See *Part II C.2* for requirements specific to FASE Grant applications.
Application Deadline	**FY 2026:** Thursday, March 19, 2026 (5:00 p.m. Eastern Time)
Grant Duration:	a. **12-24 months for Design Projects** Standard Grants and Strengthening Standard Grants b. **36-48 months for Implementation Projects** Standard Grants and Strengthening Standard Grants
Maximum Award Amount(s):	a. Including indirect costs: $250,000 for Design Project Standard Grants and Strengthening Standard Grants b. Including indirect costs: $650,000 for Implementation Project Standard Grants and Strengthening Standard Grants c. Each review cycle NIFA may award up to two grants, in any project type combination, per lead institution
Program Area Priority Contact(s):	A7601@usda.gov

Program Area Priority:
The AWT Program Area Priority seeks to develop a workforce ready for the field as well as industry jobs in the food and agricultural sector. Through the development of new workforce training programs, or the expansion, improvement, or renewal of existing workforce training programs at community, junior, and technical colleges/institutes, this program will expand job-based experiential learning opportunities, acquisition of industry-accepted credentials and occupational competencies for students to enable a work-ready labor force for the 21st century. Proposals aimed towards developing baccalaureate or graduate degree programs or pathways towards these degrees are not supported under this Program Area Priority.

In order to strengthen the capacity of Community Colleges, the AWT program is offering two focus areas: Design and Implementation, with distinct requirements, goals, timelines, and maximum budgets. (1) Design projects seek to support faculty and staff to design and develop new credentialed workforce training programs that will train the workforce once the credential is recognized by the cognizant institution. Design projects do not support nor require student activities or training, but the development of training programs. (2) Implementation projects seek

to train students to acquire the skills and tools necessary to secure an industry-accepted credential and join the workforce. Implementation projects may update or expand existing workforce training programs, but these activities are restricted to the first year of the grant; the remaining project time must be allocated to student training. AWT applicants must design their proposal based on the focus area that best fits their project's goals, objectives, and timeline. Applicants need not have applied or received a Design or Implementation project grant to be eligible to apply or receive the other focus area award.

Design Projects must:

a. Be developed and carried out by community/junior/technical colleges or institutes with active partnership of employers or other community partners.
b. Design and develop new workforce training programs or stackable-credential frameworks in the food and agricultural sciences at community, junior, and technical colleges or institutes aimed at developing a workforce ready for field and industrial jobs.
c. Describe how the project or frameworks may link high school and community college education to enable participants to gain credentials to join, rejoin or advance in the workforce.
d. Describe the type and relevance of the industry-accepted credential the workforce training program will provide to intended participants.
e. Describe the type and relevance of experiential learning opportunities that will allow participants to gain on-the-job training and exposure to work environments.
f. Provide a timeline and plan for the developed program or credential to be recognized by cognizant institutions.
g. Articulate benefits accrued from the design project and provide evidence of a high likelihood that quality future implementation applications will be submitted.

Implementation Projects must:

a. Provide students the skills and tools necessary to secure industry-accepted credentials to join the workforce upon participation completion.
b. Be developed by, or in active partnership with, community/junior/technical colleges/ institutes and their industry partners. All applications to this Program Area Priority must demonstrate committed and active partnership with and relevant to industry.
c. Expand and improve existing workforce training programs in the food and agricultural sciences at community, junior, and technical colleges/institutes to develop a workforce ready for field and industrial jobs.
d. Describe the type and relevance of industry-accepted credential(s) the workforce training program will provide to participants.
e. Allocate a reasonable portion of the funds to student support, including items, such as participant stipends, course enrollment, hands-on training, laboratory use fees, credential testing fees, and other costs that will allow the participant to attain the credential they are being trained for.

Non-exhaustive examples of projects include:

a. Industry-based training programs/apprenticeships allowing students to earn while they learn;
b. Job-based, experiential learning opportunities that allow students more time working in

job simulation or 'on-the-job' training environments;

c. Refreshing existing workforce development curriculum or development of stackable credential frameworks to meet the needs of the 21st century agricultural industry;
d. Opportunities for students to utilize appropriate cutting-edge technology and advanced data skills in their learning experiences.

Additional Information for <u>ALL</u> Design and Implementation projects:

a. Requests exceeding budgetary guidelines will not be reviewed.
b. Unless otherwise stated, grants are not renewable.
c. Application and submission information including page limits and narrative font sizes for this Program Area Priority is available on the AFRI NOFO Resources webpage. Proposals that do not comply with these instructions may be excluded from review and consideration of funding.
d. Projects including curriculum development components must be led by or include key personnel with curriculum development credentials to ensure materials produced comply with the most appropriate pedagogy, teaching standards, and other applicable institutional, state, and national accreditation requirements.
e. Curriculum for workforce training developed, expanded, or improved under this Program Area Priority must lead participants to earn a technical certificate, stackable credential, 2-year associates or technical degree or other industry accepted credential. (Certificates, training, or coursework for/part of baccalaureate or post-graduate degrees or training **are not** supported under this Program Area Priority).
f. Projects developing training programs and curriculum that provide the skills and knowledge to acquire industry-accepted food and agriculture-supportive credentials in Artificial Intelligence (AI) technology are welcome.
g. Funds requested may include but are not limited to support for participant stipends and travel, costs of course enrollment, personnel salaries, software, and curricula.
h. Use of 4-year undergraduate or graduate students as project staff is allowed under this Program Area Priority as long as the requested effort support is allocable, reasonable, and necessary for the execution of the project. Four-year undergraduate and graduate student tuition remission costs are not allowed.
i. Projects that involve partnerships with local government, economic development organizations, and workforce-focused nonprofit organizations are welcome.
j. Self-sustaining projects that will continue after grant funds expire, as well as those that serve high-unemployment geographic areas, are welcome.
k. As applicable, if most project activities are taking place off-site, off-campus indirect cost rates should be charged.
l. If organized by the program, the PD will be required to attend one NIFA AFRI EWD PD meeting during the performance period of the award. Reasonable travel expenses must be included as part of the project budget. While budgets should account for this travel, NIFA may consider holding virtual, or hybrid meetings.
m. Reasonable costs for evaluation and hiring of evaluation professionals may be included.
n. A Mentoring Plan (MentP) is required. For additional important details, see the AFRI NOFO Resources webpage.

Program Area 3. Food and Agricultural Non-Formal Education (FANE)

Table 5: Food and Agricultural Non-Formal Education Key Information

Title	Description
Program Code:	A7801
Program Code Name:	Food and Agricultural Non-Formal Education
Assistance Listing Number	10.310
Project Type(s):	Extension, Education, or Integrated Projects only
Grant Type(s):	a. Standard and FASE (Strengthening Standard) Grants only b. See *Part II C.2* for requirements specific to FASE Grant applications.
Application Deadline	**FY 2026:** Thursday, March 19, 2026 (5:00 p.m. Eastern Time)
Grant Duration:	36-48 months
Maximum Award Amount(s):	a. Including indirect costs: $650,000
Program Area Priority Contact(s):	A7801@usda.gov

Program Area Priority:
Major advances in agricultural productivity and rural prosperity in the past have resulted from transformative technologies, such as breeding tools and strategies and mechanization. There are several emerging technologies that hold a similar promise. This Program Area Priority will support content development and activities for non-formal education to foster development of technology-savvy youth. Projects must adopt or develop curriculum and activities to cultivate interest and competencies in STEM and in food and agricultural sciences supported by the six AFRI Farm Bill Priority Areas (*Part I, A*). Data science, including artificial intelligence, automation, robotics, gene editing, biotechnology and other projects involving emerging technologies will be supported in this Program Area Priority.

FANE applications must:

a. Develop curriculum and activities to increase youth's understanding of emerging technologies such as; artificial intelligence, data science, gene editing, biotechnology, robotics, automation, and other innovations. Curriculum will promote the food and agricultural enterprise by highlighting technology-based careers. Projects should prepare youth to meet the needs of the future workforce through enhanced non-formal education modules.
b. Develop curriculum and/or outreach materials that clearly communicate the benefits of emerging agricultural technologies.
c. Complement and build upon programs that have successfully demonstrated youth development strategies and outcomes (i.e., 4-H programming, Agriculture in the Classroom, FDA's Agricultural Biotechnology Education and Outreach Initiative, etc.).
d. Involve youth in the design, execution, and evaluation of activities that lead to the development of consumer-friendly content that builds public confidence in the safe use of

artificial intelligence, data science, biotechnology and other emerging technologies in agriculture and the food system.

Additional Information:

a. Requests exceeding budgetary guidelines will not be reviewed.
b. Unless otherwise stated, grants are not renewable.
c. Application and submission information including page limits and narrative font sizes for this Program Area Priority is available on the AFRI NOFO Resources webpage. Proposals that do not comply with these instructions will be excluded from review and consideration of funding.
d. Projects that enhance access and interest in innovative agricultural technology (e.g., artificial intelligence and data science, robotics and automation, gene editing, biotechnology and other emerging technologies) in STEM education are welcome.
e. Projects that promote team, active learning, and resiliency are welcome.
f. Projects must institute an evaluation system to assess participant learning and outcomes throughout the duration of the project. This plan must include clear metrics of success.
g. Projects should be designed for youth in K-12, however if a youth development program serves a similar age range outside the K-12 boundaries, allowances can be made with justification.
h. Projects that involve participation from industry and nonprofit organizations through collaborating mentors and/or that connect education professionals to existing USDA and Federal resources (e.g., USDA Agricultural Research Service, Forest Service, Federal laboratories, open data resources) to enhance student outcomes in food and agricultural sciences are welcome.
i. As applicable, if the majority of project activities take place off-site, off-campus indirect cost rates should be charged.
j. If organized by the program, the PD will be required to attend one NIFA AFRI EWD PD meeting during the performance period of the award. Reasonable travel expenses must be included as part of the project budget.
k. Funds requested may include but are not limited to support of participant stipends and travel; provider personnel salaries; software; and curricula.
l. Reasonable costs for evaluation and hiring of evaluation professionals may be included.
m. A MentP is required. For additional important details, see the AFRI NOFO Resources webpage.

Program Area 4. Research and Extension Experiences for Undergraduates

Table 6: Research and Extension Experiences for Undergraduates Key Information

Title	Description
Program Code:	A7401
Program Code Name:	Research and Extension Experiences for Undergraduates
Assistance Listing Number	10.310
Project Type(s):	Research, Extension, Education, or Integrated Projects
Grant Type(s):	a. Standard Grants and FASE (Strengthening Standard) Grants only b. See *Part II § C.2* for requirements specific to FASE Grant applications.
Application Deadline	**FY 2026:** Thursday, March 19, 2026 (5:00 p.m. Eastern Time)
Grant Duration:	a. 48 months
Maximum Award Amount(s):	a. Including indirect costs: $650,000 b. Each review cycle NIFA may award up to two REEU projects per lead institution.
Program Area Priority Contact(s):	A7401@usda.gov

Program Area Priority:
The REEU Program Area Priority promotes research and extension learning experiences for undergraduates such that upon graduation they may enter the agricultural workforce with exceptional skills. This initiative allows colleges and universities to provide opportunities for undergraduate students, including those from community colleges.

Projects must provide undergraduate students with experiential learning opportunities that include significant research, extension/outreach, and/or education components in the food and agricultural sciences. Of interest are projects that provide experiences in innovative agricultural technologies, including artificial intelligence (AI), data science, robotics and other cutting edge digital tools. Incorporation of mentoring opportunities for undergraduates to train K-12 students in these areas to equip them with the foundational knowledge and skills and expose them to educational and career pathways in AI for food and agricultural sciences is encouraged.

Non-exhaustive examples of experiential projects include:

a. Research and extension apprenticeships, internships, or similar participatory learning within the six AFRI Farm Bill Priority Areas (*Part I, A*).
b. Practicums in agricultural laboratories, farms, or Cooperative Extension programs.
c. Externships in the private or public sector.

Additional Information:

a. Requests exceeding budgetary guidelines will not be reviewed.
b. Unless otherwise stated, grants are not renewable.
c. Application and submission information including page limits and narrative font sizes for

this Program Area Priority are available on the AFRI NOFO Resources webpage. Proposals that do not comply with these instructions may be excluded from review and consideration of funding.

d. Project costs for REEU projects must be predominantly for student support, including items such as participant stipends, housing, meals, travel, and laboratory use fees. Costs in budget categories outside Participant Support must be modest and reasonable (and may include justified support for the coordination of the program).
e. The budget for student stipends should reflect standard annual increases in costs-of-living commensurate to those requested for faculty salaries.
f. Tuition for course credit and promotional items are not allowable costs in this program.
g. At least 50% of the undergraduate fellows must come from outside the host institution or organization, particularly from small institutions where opportunities are not easily available for these experiences.
h. Participating students could also build their skills necessary for graduate studies; explore the opportunities available in academia, business, government, and other career paths; and forge mentorships with professional and business leaders and faculty.
i. Applications that involve new collaborations or enhance existing partnerships with community colleges and other institutions where limited research and extension opportunities exist in mission-relevant STEM fields are welcome.
j. Applications that involve industry participation (e.g., through collaborating mentors) and/or in a food and agricultural science industry setting where there is a documented shortage of talent or lack of adequate skills preparation for the needs of the industry are welcome.
k. Projects that will catalyze and result in the implementation of a self-sustaining model for increased or enhanced experiential learning for an undergraduate student population at the host and partner institutions are welcome.
l. Projects should develop a plan for tracking student outcomes, beyond their participation in the program, that demonstrates the impacts of the program on career choices and post-graduation employment and/or enrollment in higher education.
m. A comprehensive evaluation plan with measurable outcomes is required. For additional important details, see the AFRI NOFO Resources webpage.
n. If organized by the program or the coordination network, the PD will be required to attend one NIFA AFRI EWD PD meeting during the performance period of the award. Reasonable travel expenses must be included as part of the project budget. While budgets should account for this travel, NIFA may consider virtual or hybrid meetings.
o. Awarded projects are required to maintain a website, linked to a central REEU webpage hosted by the REEU Education Coordinated Network, which describes the program, eligibility for student participation, and application guidelines.
p. Previously awarded REEU projects that wish to continue their program, should reapply as a new application with justified novel elements, and include a progress report detailed in the "Related Documents" list on the AFRI NOFO Resources webpage. These applications should differ from the previously awarded applications and will be competed with new and resubmitted applications.
q. Reasonable costs for evaluation and hiring of evaluation professionals may be included.
r. A Mentoring Plan (MentP) is required. For additional important details, see the AFRI NOFO Resources webpage.

Program Area 5. Predoctoral Fellowships

Table 7: Predoctoral Fellowships Key Information

Title	Description
Program Code:	A7101
Program Code Name:	Predoctoral Fellowships
Assistance Listing Number	10.310
Project Type(s):	Research, Education, Extension, or Integrated Projects
Grant Type(s):	a. Predoctoral Fellowship Grants only a. See *Part II C.2* for requirements specific to FASE Grant applications.
Application Deadline	**FY 2026:** Thursday, April 16, 2026 (5:00 p.m. Eastern Time)
Grant Duration:	Up to 36 months
Maximum Award Amount(s):	a. Including institutional allowance: $180,000 total per project and are limited to a total of **$**60,000 per year for the following: 1) Up to $35,000 per year salary or stipend 2) Up to $22,000 per year for other expenditures (e.g. tuition, fees, fringe benefits, supplies, travel, workshops, publications, etc.) 3) Up to $3,000 per year institutional allowance, in lieu of indirect costs which are not permitted on Predoctoral Fellowship Grants 4) With the exception of the salary or stipend, awarded funds in other budget categories may be carried over from one year to other years. The salary or stipend is capped at $35,000 per year and cannot be carried over from year one to the next.
Program Area Priority Contact(s):	nifafellows@usda.gov

Program Area Priority:
The Predoctoral Fellowships Program Area Priority helps develop new scientists and professionals to enter research, education, and/or extension fields within the food and agricultural sciences within the private sector, government, or academia. The aim of these fellowships is to cultivate future leaders who can solve emerging agricultural challenges of the 21st century. NIFA is particularly interested in supporting fellows that address (1) agricultural production capability; (2) new markets for agriculture and forestry products; (3) value-added innovation; and (4) agricultural science policy leadership.

Research, education, extension, and integrated research, education, and/or extension projects must include all of the following:

a. Objectives that are aligned with one or more of the six AFRI Farm Bill Priority Areas (as described in Part I, A);
b. Well-developed academic experiences;
c. Productive and interactive MentPs;
d. Appropriate and applicable training/career development activities; and

e. Substantive evaluation plans (see the AFRI NOFO Resources webpage for additional information).

Eligible Predoctoral Fellows – The individual predoctoral PD must be a citizen, national, or permanent resident of the United States and, as per 7 CFR 3430.303, have advanced to candidacy, as per institutional requirements, by:

a. Fiscal Year 2026 competition: April 16, 2026

Documentation from the graduate advisor or the institution must be provided by the application deadline. Instructions for providing eligibility documentation can be found on the AFRI NOFO Resources webpage. The intent of the NIFA Predoctoral Fellowship Program is to support current doctoral students who are at the stage of conducting dissertation research, ultimately leading to completion of the dissertation and respective terminal degree. Predoctoral students, inclusive of those with baccalaureate or master's degrees, who meet the above criteria, may apply.

While the Predoctoral Fellowships Program Area Priority is a component of the AFRI Food and Agriculture Science Enhancement (FASE) grant types, the applicant fellow need not be from, or planning to carry out the fellowship project at, a Strengthening Grant eligible institution to be eligible for a Predoctoral Fellowship grant.

Additional Information:

a. Requests exceeding budgetary guidelines will not be reviewed.
b. Unless otherwise stated, grants are not renewable.
c. Application and submission information including page limits and narrative font sizes for this Program Area Priority is available on the AFRI NOFO Resources webpage. Proposals that do not comply with these instructions may be excluded from review and consideration of funding.
d. The predoctoral candidate must be the sole PD listed on the Key Personnel form of the application. The mentor should not be listed as a Co-PD. Select "Graduate Student" for the Predoctoral Fellowship applicant and "Other (Specify)" for the corresponding scientific mentor(s). We highly recommend that applications be submitted through the mentor's institution with the mentor institution listed as the applicant.
e. At the time of the award and release of funds from NIFA to the sponsoring institution, Fellows are required to carry out their projects on a full-time basis (i.e., 100% effort), as specified by the sponsoring institution in accordance with its own policies.
f. The applicant must identify the functional focus of the fellowship (i.e., Research, Education, Extension, or Integrated) leading to a doctoral degree.
g. The selection of disciplines to address an issue is to be determined by the prospective applicant in consultation with appropriate mentors.
h. Evidence of scholastic achievement should be demonstrated through current doctoral transcript, program of study, and/or other academic successes.
i. This Program Area Priority welcomes multidisciplinary, transdisciplinary, and applied approaches that involve industry participation as appropriate.
j. Fellows are expected to build the professional skills necessary for career agility; explore opportunities available in academia, industry, government, and other career paths; and forge mentorships with professional and business leaders and faculty. As part of the Fellows' professional development, attendance at scientific or professional meetings and

experiences in industry or at field locations aimed at the development of skills in the applied sciences are welcome.

k. Training opportunities to integrate Artificial Intelligence (AI) technology-based understanding, tools, and modalities into the Fellow's professional skill set are welcome.

l. If organized by the program, the PD will be required to attend one NIFA AFRI EWD PD meeting during the performance period of the award. Reasonable travel expenses must be included as part of the project budget. While budgets should account for this travel, NIFA may consider virtual, or hybrid meetings.

m. Consistent with the program goal of fostering career independence, NIFA Predoctoral Fellowships can be converted to Standard Grants under certain circumstances (e.g., if the Fellow obtains a faculty position). One condition is that the Fellow substantively completes at least 50% of the fellowship performance period (e.g., 12 months for a 24-month award, 18 months for a 36-month award). Note that actual performance may occur prior to the official award start date and must be validated by the Authorized Representative (AR). The conversion process includes the following:
    1. A letter (PDF) from the PD indicating objectives completed, funds remaining, timeline involved, etc. Said letter must be signed by the AR.
    2. A letter (PDF) from the mentor attesting to the fellowship accomplishments that might be considered towards substantive fellowship performance (i.e., commencement date of actual performance, time spent on career development and planning/training, mentoring, project planning, etc.).
    3. Email both letters to the National Program Leader (Program Point of Contact on the Notice of Award). If initially agreed upon by the National Program Leader, additional institutional administrative processes need to take place (e.g., relinquishment, submission of an application, revised budget, etc.). Said processes must be executed within the performance period of the original award. NIFA reserves the right to approve or deny the conversion request. Note: Predoctoral Fellowships cannot be converted into Postdoctoral Fellowships.

Program Area 6. Postdoctoral Fellowships

Table 8: Postdoctoral Fellowships Key Information

Title	Description
Program Code:	A7201
Program Code Name:	Postdoctoral Fellowships
Assistance Listing Number	10.310
Project Type(s):	Research, Education, Extension, or Integrated Projects
Grant Type(s):	a. Postdoctoral Fellowship Grants only b. See *Part II C.2* for requirements specific to FASE Grant applications.
Application Deadline	**FY 2026:** Thursday, April 30, 2026 (5:00 p.m. Eastern Time)
Grant Duration:	Up to 24 months
Maximum Award Amount(s):	a. Including institutional allowance: $244,000 1) Funds must be requested primarily for salary or stipend and be properly justified 2) Other expenditures (e.g., fringe benefits, supplies, travel, workshops, publications, etc.) may not exceed $60,000 per year and must be itemized and properly justified 3) Up to $3,000 per year institutional allowance, in lieu of indirect costs which are not permitted on Postdoctoral Fellowship Grants
Program Area Priority Contact(s):	nifafellows@usda.gov

Program Area Priority:
The Postdoctoral Fellowships Program Area Priority helps to develop new scientists and professionals to enter research, education, and/or extension fields within the food and agricultural sciences within the private sector, government, or academia. The aim of these fellowships is to cultivate future leaders who can solve emerging agricultural challenges of the 21st century. NIFA is particularly interested in supporting fellows that address (1) agricultural production capability; (2) new markets for agriculture and forestry products; (3) value-added innovation; and (4) agricultural science policy leadership.

Research, education, extension and integrated research, education and/or extension projects must include all of the following:

a. Objectives that are aligned with one or more of the six AFRI Farm Bill Priority Areas (*Part I, A*);
b. Well-developed academic experiences and global competencies;
c. Productive and interactive mentoring;
d. Appropriate and applicable training/career development activities; and
e. Substantive evaluation plans.

Eligible Postdoctoral Fellows – As per 7 CFR 3430.303, all doctoral degree requirements must be satisfied by:

a. Fiscal Year 2026 competition: no earlier than January 1, 2023, and no later than January 30, 2027.

Documentation from the graduate advisor, graduate committee, or the institution must be provided by the application deadline. Instructions for providing eligibility documentation can be found on the AFRI NOFO Resources webpage. The postdoctoral PD must be a citizen, national, or permanent resident of the United States.

While the Postdoctoral Fellowships program area priority is a component of the AFRI Food and Agriculture Science Enhancement (FASE) grant types, the applicant fellow need not be from or planning to carry out the fellowship project at a Strengthening Grant eligible institution to be eligible for a Postdoctoral Fellowship grant.

Additional Information:

a. Requests exceeding budgetary guidelines will not be reviewed.
b. Unless otherwise stated, grants are not renewable.
c. Application and submission information including page limits and narrative font sizes for this Program Area Priority on the AFRI NOFO Resources webpage. Proposals that do not comply with these instructions may be excluded from review and consideration of funding.
d. The postdoctoral scholar must be the sole PD listed on the Key Personnel form of the application. The mentor should not be listed as a Co-PD. Select "Post-Doctoral" for the Postdoctoral Fellowship applicant. Select "Other (Specify)" for the corresponding scientific mentor(s). Enter "Mentor" for corresponding scientific mentor(s) in the Other Project Role Category Field.
e. At the time of the award and release of funds from NIFA to sponsoring institution, Fellows are required to carry out their projects on a full-time basis (i.e., 100% effort), as specified by the sponsoring institution in accordance with its own policies.
f. Note that the Program Area Priority Additional Information identified for Predoctoral Fellowships also applies to Postdoctoral Fellowships.
g. Although a proposed project may fit in the context of the mentor's existing scientific area, the Postdoctoral Fellowship Grant should initiate an independent scientific program, rather than serve as an extension of ongoing projects in the mentor's laboratory.
h. Note that postdoctoral proposals must indicate program code A7201 in the NIFA Supplemental Information Form (application package).
i. The postdoctoral applicant, in their Project Summary/Abstract, should indicate the Farm Bill Priority Area name (*Part I, A*), Program Area name, and Program Area Priority Code from the AFRI FAS NOFO that most closely matches the topic of the proposed postdoctoral project plan. Postdoctoral proposals will be reviewed within a respective AFRI FAS Program Area. A table of the AFRI Foundational and Applied Science Priority and Program Areas, along with Program Codes can be found in the AFRI FAS NOFO. Additional information is on the AFRI NOFO Resources webpage. Do not use a FAS program code in the NIFA Supplemental Information Form, or the application is at risk of being returned without review.

j. This Program Area Priority welcomes multidisciplinary, transdisciplinary, and applied approaches that involve industry participation as appropriate.
k. Training opportunities to integrate Artificial Intelligence (AI) technology-based understanding, tools, and modalities into the Fellow's professional skill set are welcome.
l. If organized, the PD will be required to attend one NIFA AFRI EWD PD meeting during the performance period of the award. The PD is also required to attend a PD meeting of the Foundational and Applied Science Program Area Priority with which the project is most closely aligned during the performance period of the award. Reasonable travel expenses must be included as part of the project budget. While budgets should account for this travel, NIFA may consider virtual, or hybrid meetings.
m. Consistent with the program goal of fostering career independence, NIFA Postdoctoral Fellowships can be converted to Standard Grants under certain circumstances (e.g., if the Fellow obtains a faculty position). One condition is that the Fellow substantively completes at least 50% of the fellowship performance period (e.g., 12 months for a 24-month award, 18 months for a 36-month award). Note that actual performance may occur prior to the official award start date and must be validated by the Authorized Representative (AR). The conversion process includes the following:
    1. A letter (PDF) from the PD indicating objectives completed, funds remaining, timeline involved, etc. Said letter must be signed by the AR.
    2. A letter (PDF) from the mentor attesting to the fellowship accomplishments that might be considered towards substantive fellowship performance (i.e., commencement date of actual performance, time spent on career development and planning/training, mentoring, project planning, etc.).
    3. Email both letters to the National Program Leader (Program Point of Contact on the Notice of Award). If initially agreed upon by the National Program Leader, additional institutional administrative processes need to take place (e.g., relinquishment, submission of an application, revised budget, etc.). Said processes must be executed within the performance period of the original award. NIFA reserves the right to approve or deny the conversion request.

Program Area 7. Education and Workforce Development Workshop Grants

Table 9: Education and Workforce Development Workshop Grants Key Information

Title	Description
Program Code:	A7001
Program Code Name:	Education and Workforce Development Workshop Grants
Assistance Listing Number	10.310
Project Type(s):	Research, Education, Extension, or Integrated Projects
Grant Type(s):	a. Workshop and Strengthening Workshop grants only b. See *Part II, C.2* for requirements specific to Workshop grant and FASE Grant applications.
Letter of Intent Deadline:	a. Required. The LOI must be submitted a minimum of 255 days before the workshop begins. b. LOIs must follow the instructions in Part IV, A and be emailed to the program contact(s) below
Application Deadline:	Continuous throughout the year after submission of an approved LOI. If invited, the full Workshop Grant application must be submitted a minimum of 210 days before the start of the workshop.
Grant Duration:	Up to 60 months
Maximum Award Amount(s):	$50,000
Program Area Priority Contact(s):	A7001@usda.gov

Workshop grant applications should focus on at least one of the four overarching goals of this AFRI EWD Program Area:

1. Growing Agricultural Literacy and Workforce Development for the Future
2. Training or Retraining of Agricultural Workers
3. Developing Pathways for formal or non-formal experiential learning
4. Advancing Science via career development of graduate students and postdoctoral scholars in the food and agricultural sciences

Workshop grants submitted to the EWD NOFO may encompass any project type (research, education, extension, or integrated) but must focus on education and workforce development of K-14 students, undergraduates, graduate students, postdoctoral scholars, or educators. Workshop topics related to Artificial Intelligence (AI) related professional development for educators and students, workforce readiness, and experiential learning are welcome. Applications for scientific workshops that exclusively focus on disseminating the findings of fundamental or applied research or advancing areas of science unrelated to education, workforce training, or career development will not be accepted. Such requests should be directed to the AFRI Foundational and Applied Science NOFO.

Workshop grants must develop activities and programing that bring stakeholders together to discuss, coordinate, and advance innovations supportive of food and agriculture-related disciplines and workforce; activities should be interactive learning sessions with the goal of producing a collaborative result. A seminar activity (lecture/presentation) with a selected speaker is an eligible activity if it includes other engagement among workshop participants that advances agricultural literacy.

Additional Information:

1. Requests exceeding budgetary guidelines will not be reviewed.
2. Applications submitted less than 210 days before the start of the workshop will be declined without review.
3. Unless otherwise stated, grants are not renewable.
4. NIFA will not fund workshop grants with the sole purpose of supporting travel and subsistence to attend conferences/workshops.
5. Workshops may be held in conjunction with or complementary to other organization's events (conferences) but are to have their own identity and purpose. NIFA will not support workshop grants where funds are used as sponsorship of other conferences.
6. Application and submission information, including page limits and narrative font sizes for this Program Area Priority, are available on the AFRI NOFO Resources webpage. Proposals that do not comply with these instructions may be excluded from review and consideration of funding.

PART II. AWARD INFORMATION

A. Available Funding

The anticipated amount available for the AFRI Education and Workforce Development NOFO in FY 2026 is approximately $39,700,000. Additional projects submitted under this NOFO may be considered should additional funding become available beyond the amount listed above. USDA is not committed to fund any particular application or to make a specific number of awards.

Of the total amount available to make awards for the AFRI program, no less than 30 percent will be made available to fund integrated research, education, and extension projects. Of the AFRI funds allocated to research activities, no less than 60 percent will be directed toward grants for fundamental (or basic) research and 40 percent toward grants for applied research. Of the AFRI funds allocated to fundamental research, not less than 30 percent will be directed toward research by multidisciplinary teams. It is expected that no less than 15 percent of the funds will be made available for Food and Agricultural Science Enhancement (FASE) Grants, and no more than two percent of the funds available for fundamental research will be made available for Equipment Grants (see *Part II C* for information about FASE Grants including Equipment Grants).

Of the amount available to support the Program Area Priorities in this NOFO, no less than 11.25% will be made available for Strengthening grant types under the FASE program.

The funds will be awarded through a grant for performance periods of up to five years. NIFA may choose to issue a grant on a continuation basis. A continuation award is an award instrument by which NIFA agrees to support a specified level of effort for a predetermined period of time with a statement of intention to provide additional support at a future date, provided that performance has been satisfactory, appropriations are available for this purpose, and continued support would be in the best interest of the Federal government and the public. USDA is not committed to fund any particular application or to make a specific number of awards.

The Automated Standard Application for Payments, operated by the Department of Treasury, Bureau of Fiscal Service, is the designated payment system for awards resulting from this NOFO.

B. Application Restrictions

NIFA will evaluate applications using the criteria described in *Part V*. Application for this FY 2026 NOFO is limited to the following application types:

1. *New application*: New applications will be evaluated using the criteria described in *Part V* and are subject to the due dates herein (see *Appendix III* for definition).
2. *Resubmitted application*: Resubmitted applications must include the one-page "Response to Previous Review" and are subject to the same criteria and due dates herein. Resubmitted applicants must enter the NIFA-assigned proposal number of the previously submitted application in the *Federal Field (Field 4)* on the application form (see *Appendix III* for definition).

C. Project and Grant Types

The following describes the types of *projects* or *grants* that are eligible for funding:

1. **Project Types.** Applicants must propose one of the AFRI project types specified within the relevant Program Area Priority descriptions in Part I C. Only project types specifically solicited under each Program Area Priority described in Part I C will be considered for review. A detailed description of the project types (Research, Education, Extension, and Integrated Research, Education, and/or Extension) available across all AFRI NOFOs is in the "AFRI Project Types" PDF in the "Related Documents" list on the AFRI NOFO Resources webpage. An Integrated Project includes at least two of the three functions of the agricultural knowledge system (i.e., research, education, and extension) within a project.

2. **Grant Types**. Applicants must select the appropriate AFRI grant type specified within the relevant Program Area Priority Descriptions in Part I C. Only grant types specifically solicited under each Program Area Priority described in Part I C will be considered for review. A detailed description of the grant types (Standard Grants, Workshop Grants, and FASE Grants) available across all AFRI NOFOs is in the "AFRI Grant Types" PDF in the "Related Documents" list on the AFRI NOFO Resources webpage.

D. Ethical Conduct of Funded Projects

In accordance with sections 2, 3, and 8 of 2 CFR Part 422, institutions that conduct USDA-funded extramural research must foster an atmosphere conducive to research integrity, bear primary responsibility for prevention and detection of research misconduct, and maintain and effectively communicate and train their staff regarding policies and procedures. In the event an application to NIFA results in an award, the Authorized Representative (AR) assures, through acceptance of the award that the institution will comply with the above requirements. Award recipients must, upon request, make available to NIFA the policies, procedures, and documentation to support the conduct of the training. See Responsible and Ethical Conduct of Research for further information.

PART III. ELIGIBILITY INFORMATION

A. Eligibility Requirements

Applicants for AFRI must meet all the requirements discussed in this NOFO. Failure to meet the eligibility criteria by the application deadline may result in exclusion from consideration or preclude NIFA from making an award. For those new to Federal financial assistance, NIFA's About Grants provides highly recommended information about grants and other resources to help understand the Federal awards process.

Eligibility is linked to the project type as specified below.

1. **Research, Education, or Extension Projects**

   Eligible applicants for single-function Research, Education or Extension Projects include:

   a) State Agricultural Experiment Station;
   b) colleges and universities (including junior colleges offering associate degrees or higher);
   c) university research foundations;
   d) other research institutions and organizations;
   e) Federal agencies;
   f) national laboratories;
   g) private organizations or corporations;
   h) individuals who are U.S. citizens, nationals, or permanent residents; and
   i) any group consisting of two or more entities identified in a) through h).

   Eligible institutions do not include foreign and international organizations.

2. **Integrated Projects**

   Eligible applicants for Integrated Projects include:

   a) colleges and universities;
   b) 1994 Land-Grant Institutions; and
   c) Hispanic-serving agricultural colleges and universities (see NIFA's Hispanic-Serving Agricultural Colleges and Universities page).

   For item a) under Integrated Projects, the terms "college" and "university" mean an educational institution in any state which:

   a) admits as regular students only persons having a certificate of graduation from a school providing secondary education, or the recognized equivalent of such a certificate;
   b) is legally authorized within such state to provide a program of education beyond secondary education;
   c) provides an educational program for which a bachelor's degree or any other higher degree is awarded;
   d) is a public or other nonprofit institution; and
   e) is accredited by a nationally recognized accrediting agency or association.

   A research foundation maintained by a college or university is eligible to receive an award under this program.

3. **Food and Agricultural Science Enhancement Grants**
   Part II, C.2 contains the eligibility details for Food and Agricultural Science Enhancement (FASE) Grants. Note that under FASE opportunity, only Strengthening Standard, Predoctoral Fellowship Grants, Postdoctoral Fellowship Grants, and Strengthening Workshop are solicited in this NOFO.

Applicants must respond to the Program Area Priorities and deadlines found in *Part I, C*. Grant recipients may subcontract to organizations not eligible to apply provided such organizations are necessary for the conduct of the project. Failure to meet an eligibility criterion by the application deadline may result in the application being excluded from consideration or, even though an application may be reviewed, will preclude NIFA from making an award (see *Part III, B*).

USDA **will not accept** competitive applications for grants and cooperative agreements submitted for due dates after June 20, 2025, and/or research and development (R&D) contract proposals submitted to solicitations issued after June 20, 2025, for dangerous gain-of-function research, as defined in Section 8 of E.O. 14292.

Duplicate or Multiple Submissions – submission of duplicate or predominantly overlapping applications is not allowed. NIFA will disqualify both applications if an applicant submits multiple applications that are duplicative or substantially overlapping to NIFA programs within the same fiscal year.

B. Request for Determination of Status

1. Strengthening Grant Eligibility

If an institution is applying for a Strengthening Grant under the FASE program refer to the "AFRI Grant Types" PDF in the Related Documents list on the AFRI NOFO Resources webpage).

2. Multi-Campus Institution

All institutions grouped under one main campus as listed in Table 1 following Appendix III, unless located in an Established Program to Stimulate Competitive Research (EPSCoR) state (listed in *Part II, C.2*), are excluded from eligibility for all strengthening funds. However, if any campus within a multi-campus listing can provide information demonstrating that it is administratively independent or has an independent accreditation, then the institution may petition for an exemption to this rule and request eligibility for strengthening funds. The LOI (if required) and the application must include a letter indicating how the institution is independent of the main campus, either through accreditation or administration, how the institution is eligible for a Strengthening Grant, and total Federal funds received for science and engineering research and development. The letter must be signed by the Authorized Representative (AR).

C. Cost Sharing or Matching

Applicants MUST provide matching contributions on a dollar-for-dollar basis for all Federal funds awarded under AFRI for applied research grants unless a waiver applies. Matching funds requirements for AFRI programs included in this NOFO may be found at 7 U.S.C. 3157 (b)(9)(A-C).

For Applied Research Grants:
Match Required –If an applied Research (see Appendix III) Project or Integrated Project with an applied research component, is commodity-specific and not of national scope, the grant recipient is required to match the USDA funds awarded on a dollar-for-dollar basis from non-Federal sources with cash and/or in-kind contributions. (7 U.S.C. 3157(9)C)

1. Match not required – If the applied research or integrated project with an applied research component is not commodity specific or is national in scope, then no match is required.

D. Centers of Excellence

Pursuant to Section 7214 of the Agricultural Act of 2014 (7 U.S.C. 5926), NIFA will recognize and prioritize Center of Excellence (COE) applicants that carry out research, extension, and education activities that relate to the food and agricultural sciences. A COE is composed of one or more of the following entities that provide financial or in-kind support to the COE.

1. State agricultural experiment stations.
2. Colleges and universities.
3. University research foundations.
4. Other research institutions and organizations.
5. Federal agencies.
6. National laboratories.
7. Private organizations, foundations, or corporations.
8. Individuals; or
9. Any group consisting of two or more of the entities described in (1) through (8).

COE designation is available only for the **Standard Grant and the Coordinated Agricultural Project (CAP) Grant** applications submitted to the Program Area Priorities in the Education and Workforce Development, Foundational and Applied Science, and Sustainable Agricultural Systems NOFOs. If applicable, *Part IV, C*, of the NOFO contains additional requirements for COE consideration.

PART IV. APPLICATION AND SUBMISSION

A. Letter of Intent

A Letter of Intent is only required for Education and Workforce Development Workshop Grants (A7001) workshop grants and must be submitted 255 days prior to the start of the workshop. For detailed guidance on LOI submission, see "AFRI Letter of Intent Instructions" in the "Related Documents" list on the AFRI NOFO Resources webpage.

B. Method of Application

Applicants must apply to this NOFO electronically; no other method or response is accepted. The electronic application for this NOFO and additional resources are available on Grants.gov and Grants 101. **Table 10** provides instructions on how to obtain an electronic application. **Part III** of the NIFA Grants Application Guide contains detailed information regarding the Grants.gov registration process. The NIFA Grants Application Guide is contained in the specific funding opportunity package or a sample of the guide can be found here. When applying for a NIFA award, it is important to reference the version of the guide that is included in the specific funding opportunity application package.

Table 10: Steps to Obtain Application Materials

Steps	Action
Step One: Register	New Users to Grants.gov must register early with Grants.gov prior to submitting an application (Register Here).
Step Two: Download Adobe	Download and Install Adobe Reader (see Adobe Software Compatibility for basic system requirements).
Step Three: Find Application	Using this funding opportunity number **USDA-NIFA-AFRI-011596**, search for application here: Opportunity Package.
Step Four: Assess Readiness	Contact an AR prior to starting an application to assess the organization's readiness to submit an electronic application.

Table 11: Help and Resources

Grants.gov Support	NIFA Support
Grants.gov Online Support Telephone support: 800-518-4726 Toll-Free or 606-545-5035 Email support: support@grants.gov Self-service customer-based support: Grants.gov iPortal Customer service business Hours 24/7, except Federal holidays.	Email: grantapplicationquestions@usda.gov Business hours: Monday thru Friday, 7a.m. – 5p.m. ET, except Federal holidays

C. Content and Form of the Application

The NIFA Grants Application Guide is part of the corresponding application package for this NOFO. The NOFO overrides the NIFA Grants Application Guide if there is a discrepancy between the two documents. Applicants that do not meet the application requirements, to include partial applications, risk being excluded from NIFA's review. NIFA will assign a proposal

number to all applications that meet the requirements of this NOFO. Applicants must refer to the proposal number when corresponding with NIFA. **Table 12** outlines other key instructions for applicants.

Table 12: Key Application Instructions

Instruction	References **(All references are to the NIFA Grants Application Guide)**
Attachments must be in a portable document format (PDF) format.	Part IV
Check the manifest of submitted files to verify attachments are in the correct format.	Part IV
Conduct an administrative review of the application before submission.	Part IV
Follow the submission instructions.	Part IV
Provide an accurate email address, where designated, on the SF-424 R&R.	Part V
Contact the Grants.gov helpdesk for technical support and keep a record of the correspondence.	N/A
Contact NIFA if applicant does not receive correspondence from NIFA regarding an application within 30 days of the application deadline.	N/A

AFRI Specific Application Instructions. Application and submission information including page limits and narrative font sizes for AFRI Education and Workforce Development NOFO applications are available in the "FY 2026 AFRI Education and Workforce Development NOFO Additional Information for Part IV, C" in the "Related Documents" list on the AFRI NOFO Resources webpage.

We recommend that you conduct an administrative review of the application before submission of it via Grants.gov to ensure that it complies with all preparation instructions. An application checklist is included in Part VII of the NIFA Grants.gov Application Guide to assist with this review.

You should check the application for completeness. The application should be checked for the following required items, which must include:

1. Project Summary/Abstract
2. Project Narrative.
3. Bibliography & References Cited
4. Logic Model for Integrated Projects (if applicable)
5. Management Plan for Integrated Projects (if applicable)

6. Data Management Plan
7. Mentoring Plan (if not included within the project narrative).
8. Facilities & Other Resources
9. Curriculum Vitae
10. Conflict of Interest Lists
11. Current and Pending Support
12. Budget
13. Budget Justification

This is not an exhaustive list of required items; it only serves to highlight items that may be overlooked. **Failure to include any of the three critical required documents of Project Summary/Abstract, Project Narrative, or Bibliography & References Cited sections as PDF attachment will result in the application not being reviewed or considered for funding by NIFA.**

We send email correspondence to the AR regarding the status of submitted applications. We strongly encourage you to provide accurate email addresses, where designated, on the SF-424 R&R Application for Federal Assistance.

If the AR has not received correspondence from NIFA regarding a submitted application within 30 days of the established deadline, contact the Program Contact identified in *Part I, C* and request the proposal number assigned to the application. **Failure to do so may result in the application not being considered for funding by the peer review panel. Once the application has been assigned a proposal number, you should cite this number on all future correspondence.**

D. Funding Restrictions

Federal Indirect Costs (IDC) not to exceed 30 percent of total Federal funds awarded (TFFA). Section 1462(a) and (c) of the National Agricultural Research, Extension, and Teaching Policy Act of 1977 (7 U.S.C. 3310(a) and (c)) limits IDC for the overall award to 30 percent of Total Federal Funds Awarded (TFFA) under a research, education, or extension grant. The maximum IDC rate allowed under the award is determined by calculating the amount of IDC using:

1. the sum of an institution's negotiated IDC rate and the IDC rate charged by sub-awardees, if any; or
2. 30 percent of TFFA.

The maximum allowable IDC rate under the award, including the IDC charged by the sub-awardee(s), if any, is the lesser of the two rates above.

If the result of number one above is the lesser of the two rates, the grant recipient is allowed to charge the negotiated IDC rate on the prime award and the sub-award(s), if any. Any sub-awards would be subject to the sub-awardee's negotiated IDC rate. The sub-awardee may charge its negotiated IDC rate on its portion of the award, provided the sum of the IDC rate charged under the award by the prime awardee and the sub-awardee(s) does not exceed 30 percent of the TFFA.

If number two above is the lesser of the two rates, then the maximum IDC rate allowed for the overall award, including any sub-award(s), is limited to 30 percent of the TFFA. That is, the IDC of the prime awardee plus the sum of the IDC charged by the sub-awardee(s), if any, may not exceed 30 percent of the TFFA.

In the event of an award, the prime awardee is responsible for ensuring the maximum IDC allowed for the award is not exceeded when combining IDC for the Federal portion (i.e., prime and sub-awardee(s)) and any applicable cost-sharing. Amounts exceeding the maximum allowable IDC are considered unallowable. See sections 408 and 410 of 2 CFR 200.

If the applicant does not have a negotiated rate, and NIFA is the cognizant agency, the applicant must calculate an IDC rate in order to request IDC. Applicants are not required to complete the IDC package during the application process. Applicants need only to calculate an IDC rate to serve as a basis for requesting IDC, please see National Institute of Food and Agriculture (usda.gov) for additional resources. If awarded, the applicant will be required to submit a complete IDC proposal package to obtain a negotiated rate.

Organizations that do not have a current negotiated (including provisional) rate, may also elect the De Minimis rate (2 CFR 200.414). The Uniform Guidance offers the option of electing to charge a de Minimis rate of 15 percent of modified total indirect costs (MTDC) which may be used indefinitely. As described above and in 2 CFR 200.403, costs must be charged consistently as either indirect or direct costs but may not be double charged or inconsistently charged as both. If elected, this methodology must be used consistently for all Federal awards until such time as a non-Federal entity chooses to negotiate for a rate, which it may do at any time.

See NIFA Indirect Costs for information including additional resources and NIFA Indirect Cost Guidance Chart.

Successful applicants must not use grant funds awarded under the authority of this NOFO for the construction of a new building or facility or the acquisition, expansion, remodeling, or alteration of an existing building or facility (including site grading and improvement, and architect fees).

PART V. APPLICATION REVIEW REQUIREMENTS

A. NIFA's Evaluation Process

NIFA evaluates each application in a two-part process. First, we screen each application to ensure that it meets the administrative requirements set forth in this NOFO. All administrative requirements must be met in order for the application to proceed to the next level of review. Second, a scientific peer-review process will be used to technically evaluate applications that have met the administrative requirements using a review panel (see NIFA Peer Review Process).

Scientific Peer Review Process:

NIFA selects reviewers for the review panel based upon their training and experience in relevant scientific, extension, or education fields, taking into account the following factors:

1. The level of relevant formal scientific, technical education, or extension experience of the individual, as well as the extent to which an individual is engaged in relevant research, education, or extension activities.
2. The need to include experts from various areas of specialization within relevant scientific, education, or extension fields.
3. The need to include other experts (e.g., agricultural producers, range or forest managers/operators, researchers, educators, evaluators, and consumers) who can assess relevance of the applications to audiences and to program needs.
4. The need to include experts from a variety of organizational types (e.g., colleges, universities, industry, state and Federal agencies, and private profit and non-profit organizations) and geographic locations.
5. The need to maintain a balanced composition with regard to the reviewer's area of expertise, geographic area, and entity type, as appropriate.
6. The need to include reviewers who can judge the effective usefulness of each application to producers and the general public.

After each peer review panel has completed its deliberations, the responsible program staff of NIFA will recommend that your project is either approved for support from currently available funds or declined due to insufficient funds or unfavorable review.

NIFA reserves the right to negotiate with the PD/PI and/or the submitting organization or institution regarding project revisions (e.g., reductions in the scope of work, funding level, period, or method of support) prior to recommending any project for funding.

After the review process has been completed, NIFA sends copies of reviews, *not* including the identity of reviewers, and a summary (if applicable) of the review panel comments to the PD.

Conflicts of interest. NIFA takes extreme care to prevent any actual or perceived conflicts of interest that may influence the review or evaluation (see NIFA Peer Review Process for Competitive Grant Applications).

B. Evaluation Criteria

NIFA will use the following criteria to evaluate applications to these programs:
A reviewer's written evaluation entails two levels of assessment. First, the reviewer summarizes how well the application addressed each evaluation criterion. After the application has been assessed for strengths and weaknesses of each criterion, the reviewer then evaluates the overall likelihood that the project will have significant outcome and impact. The written reviews are used to begin panel discussions with other reviewers serving on the peer review panel. Through these discussions, peer review panelists come to consensus on the final ranking of the applications. A complete description of NIFA's peer review process can be found on the NIFA Peer Review Process for Competitive Grant Applications page.

Detailed evaluation criteria for each project type, grant type, and centers of excellence are found in the "AFRI Review Criteria" PDF in the "Related Documents" list on the AFRI NOFO Resources webpage. We will use the appropriate evaluation criteria to review applications submitted in response to this NOFO.

C. Centers of Excellence

In addition to evaluating applicants using the criterion listed in *Part V, B of this NOFO*, NIFA will use the COE standards described in this NOFO to evaluate applicants that rank highly meritorious and requested to be considered as a COE. In instances where applicants are found to be equally meritorious with the application of a non-COE applicant, NIFA will prioritize the COE applicant meeting the COE criteria. NIFA will effectively use the COE prioritization as a "tie breaker." Applicants that rank highly meritorious but who did not request consideration as a COE or who are not deemed to have met the COE standards may still receive funding.

Applicants that meet the COE requirements will have the COE designation in their notice of award. Entities recognized as COE will maintain that distinction for the duration of their period of performance or as identified in the terms and conditions of that award.

D. Organizational Management Information

Applicants must submit specific management information prior to an award and update the information as needed. Applicants may only need to provide an update if there was a change in previously provided information under this or another NIFA program. NIFA provides the requisite forms during the pre-award process. Although an applicant may be eligible for award under this program, there are factors that may exclude an applicant from receiving Federal financial and nonfinancial assistance and benefits under this program (e.g., debarment or suspension of an individual, or a determination that an applicant is not responsible).

E. Application Disposition

Applicants may withdraw at any time before NIFA makes a final funding decision. NIFA will retain all applications, including withdrawn applications and unfunded applications.

PART VI. AWARD ADMINISTRATION

A. General

Within the limit of funds authorized, the NIFA awarding official will make grants to responsible and eligible applicants whose applications are judged most meritorious under the procedures set forth in this NOFO. The date specified by the NIFA awarding official as the effective date of the grant must be no later than September 30 of the Federal fiscal year in which the project is approved for support and funds are appropriated for such purpose, unless otherwise permitted by law. The project need not be initiated on the grant effective date, but as soon thereafter as practical so that project goals may be attained within the funded project period. All funds granted by NIFA under this NOFO may be used only for the purpose for which they are granted in accordance with the approved application and budget, regulations, terms and conditions of the award, applicable Federal cost principles, USDA assistance regulations, and NIFA General Awards Administration Provisions, 7 CFR Part 3430, subparts A through E.

Award Notice. The award document will provide pertinent instructions and information as described in 2 CFR 200.211 (see NIFA's Terms and Conditions).

B. Administrative and National Policy Requirements

Several Federal statutes and regulations apply to grant applications and the projects outlined in this NOFO (some are listed here: Federal Regulations). Unless specifically noted by statue or award-specific requirements, NIFA Federal Assistance Policy Guide applies to all NIFA awards.

C. Expected Program Outputs and Reporting Requirements

Output and reporting requirements are included in the award terms and conditions. If there are any program or award-specific award terms, they will be identified in the Award Notice.

Additional requirements on expected performance goals, indicators, and targets may be required as a condition of an award issued per this NOFO.

PART VII. OTHER INFORMATION

A. Use of Funds and Changes in Budget

Delegation of fiscal responsibility. Unless the terms and conditions of the award state otherwise, awardees may not in whole or in part delegate or transfer to another person, institution, or organization the responsibility for use or expenditure of award funds.

Changes in Budget or Project Plans. In accordance with 2 CFR 200.308, awardees must request prior approval from NIFA for the following program or budget-related reasons (the awardee is subject to the terms and conditions identified in the award):

1. Change in the scope or the objective of the project or program without prior written approval (even if there is no associated budget revision required).
2. Change in a key person specified in the application or the Federal award.
3. Disengagement from the project for more than three months, or a 25 percent reduction in time devoted to the project.
4. Inclusion of costs that require prior approval in accordance with 2 CFR 200 Subpart E (Cost Principles), or 2 CFR Part 300 Appendix IX, (Principles for Determining Costs Applicable to Research and Development under Awards and Contracts with Hospitals), or 48 CFR, unless waived by the Federal awarding agency, 48 CFR Part 31, Contract Cost Principles and Procedures;
5. Transfer of funds budgeted for participant support costs to other categories of expense (2 CFR 200.456 Participant support costs);
6. Sub-awarding, transferring or contracting out of any work under a Federal award, including fixed amount sub-awards (see 2 CFR 200.333, Fixed Amount Sub-awards), unless described in the application and funded in the approved Federal awards. This provision does not apply to the acquisition of supplies, material, equipment, or general support services.
7. Changes in the approved cost-sharing or matching provided by the non-Federal entity; and
8. The need for additional Federal funds to complete the project.
9. Transferring funds between the construction and non-construction work under a Federal award.
10. A no-cost extension (meaning, an extension of time that does not require the obligation of additional Federal funds) of the period of performance, other than any one-time extension authorized by the Federal agency in accordance with paragraph 2 CFR 200.308(g)(2). All requests for no-cost extensions should be submitted at least 10 calendar days before the conclusion of the period of performance. The Federal agency may approve multiple no-cost extensions under a Federal award if not prohibited by Federal statute or regulation.
11. Salary rates of pay exceeding an Executive Level IV salary range (see "Rates of Pay for the Executive Schedule" under the "Executive & Senior Level Employee Pay Tables" header at https://www.opm.gov/policy-data-oversight/pay-leave/salaries-wages/) require prior NIFA approval. This rate does not include any fringe benefits, general and administrative (G&A), overhead, or other expenses. Requests for approval must include the salary rate of pay and a justification for the rate and be sent to the Authorized Departmental Officer (ADO) to awards@usda.gov.

12. No more than 50 percent of the total dollars of this award may be subcontracted to another party(ies) without prior written approval of the ADO, except subcontracts to Federal agencies.

B. Confidential Aspects of Applications and Awards

When an application results in an award, it becomes a part of NIFA transaction records, which are available to the public. Information that the Secretary of Agriculture determines to be confidential, privileged, or proprietary in nature will be held in confidence to the extent permitted by law. Therefore, applicants should clearly mark any information within the application they wish to have considered as confidential, privileged, or proprietary. NIFA will retain a copy of an application that does not result in an award for three years. Such an application will be released only with the consent of the applicant or to the extent required by law. An applicant may withdraw at any time prior to the final action thereon.

C. Regulatory Information

This program is not subject to the provisions of Executive Order 12372, which requires intergovernmental consultation with state and local officials. Under the provisions of the Paperwork Reduction Act of 1995 (44 U.S.C. Chapter 35), the collection of information requirements contained in this notice have been approved under OMB Document No. 0524-0039.

D. Language Access Services

NIFA offers language access services, such as interpretation and translation of vital information, free of charge. If you need interpretation or translation services, please visit NIFA Language Access Services or contact Lois Tuttle, Equal Opportunity Specialist, at Lois.Tuttle@usda.gov or (443) 386-9488.

APPENDIX I: AGENCY CONTACT

AFRI Program Office E-mail: AFRI@usda.gov

Specific questions pertaining to technical matters may be directed to the appropriate Program Area Priority Contacts:

Program Area Priority Contacts

Program Area Priority	Program Area Priority Contacts
Professional Development for Agricultural Literacy (A7501) Grants	A7501@usda.gov
Agricultural Workforce Training (A7601) Grants	A7601@usda.gov
Food and Agricultural Non-formal Education (A7801)	A7801@usda.gov
Research and Extension Experiences for Undergraduates (A7401)	A7401@usda.gov
Predoctoral Fellowships (A7101)	nifafellows@usda.gov
Postdoctoral Fellowships (A7201)	nifafellows@usda.gov
Education and Workforce Development Workshop Grants (A7001)	For LOIs, A7001@usda.gov

For administrative questions related to

1. Grants.gov, see *Part IV*
2. Other NOFO or application questions, please email grantapplicationquestions@usda.gov
3. Awards under this NOFO, please email awards@usda.gov

U.S. Postal Mailing Address:
National Institute of Food and Agriculture
U.S. Department of Agriculture
P.O. Box 419205, MS 10000
Kansas City, MO 64141-6205

Courier/Package Delivery Address:
National Institute of Food and Agriculture
United States Department of Agriculture
2312 East Bannister Road, MS 10000
Kansas City, MO 64141-3061

APPENDIX II: GLOSSARY OF TERMS

Glossary of Terms

Agriculture and Food Research Initiative – AFRI
Assistance Listing Number – ALN
Authorized Departmental Officer – ADO
Authorized Representative – AR
Agricultural Research, Extension, and Education Reform Act of 1998 – AREERA
Coordinated Agricultural Project – CAP
Centers of Excellence – COE
Data Management Plan – DMP
Education and Workforce Development – EWD
Established Program to Stimulate Competitive Research – EPSCoR
Food and Agricultural Science Enhancement - FASE
Indirect costs – IDC
Mentoring Plan – MentP
Management Plan - MP
National Institute of Food and Agriculture – NIFA
Notice of Funding Opportunity – NOFO
Research, Education, and Economics – REE
United States Department of Agriculture – USDA

APPENDIX III: DEFINITIONS

Refer to 7 CFR 3430 Competitive and Noncompetitive Non-formula Federal Assistance Programs – General Award Administrative Provisions for additional definitions.

Terms	Definitions
Applied Research	Research that includes expansion of the findings of fundamental research to uncover practical ways in which new knowledge can be advanced to benefit individuals and society.
Continuation Award	An award instrument by which NIFA agrees to support a specified level of effort for a predetermined period of time with a statement of intention to provide additional support at a future date, provided that performance has been satisfactory, appropriations are available for this purpose, and continued support would be in the best interest of the Federal government and the public.
Co-Investigator	Co-Investigators (CI) are Senior or Key Personnel including collaborators or cooperators who are responsible for achieving specific objectives within the project. They have the same status as a Co-Project Directors in terms of contribution to the project, but they can't assume the responsibilities of the Project Director. The budget associated with CIs should be listed under the Senior or Key Personnel budget lines.
Co-Project Director	A Co-Project Director (Co-PD) is someone who could assume the Project Director's (PD) responsibilities if the PD steps out of that role prior to the completion of the project term. Co-PDs on an application are presumed to be approved by the lead institution. Note that NIFA makes awards to institutions, not individuals. Therefore, Co-PDs ideally should serve at the same institution as the PD. Team members responsible for achieving specific objectives should be listed as Co-Investigators. International partners are ineligible to serve as PD or Co-PD and should be listed as Co-Investigator.
Education Activity	Education activity or teaching activity means formal classroom instruction, laboratory instruction, and practicum experience in the food and agricultural sciences and other related matters such as faculty development, student recruitment and services, curriculum development, instructional materials and equipment, and innovative teaching methodologies.

Terms	Definitions
Established Program to Stimulate Competitive Research	EPSCoR is a list of eligible states that are eligible for USDA EPSCoR funding which is determined every year by NIFA. This list includes states having a funding level no higher than the 38th percentile of all States based on a 3-year rolling average of AFRI funding levels, excluding FASE Strengthening funds. The current list is included in the "AFRI Grant Types" PDF in the "Related Documents" list on the AFRI NOFO Resources webpage.
Extension Activity	Extension activity means an act or process that delivers science-based knowledge and informal educational programs to people, enabling them to make practical decisions.
Food and Agricultural Science Enhancement Grants	FASE Grants mean funding awarded to eligible applicants to strengthen science capabilities of Project Directors, to help institutions develop competitive scientific programs, and to attract new scientists into careers in high-priority areas of National need in agriculture, and food sciences. FASE awards may apply to any of the three agricultural knowledge components (i.e., research, education, and extension). FASE awards include Pre- and Postdoctoral Fellowships, New Investigator grants, and Strengthening grants.
Fundamental Research	Fundamental research means research that (i) increases knowledge or understanding of the fundamental aspects of phenomena and has the potential for broad application; and (ii) has an effect on agriculture, food, or nutrition.
Limited Institutional Success	Limited institutional success means institutions that are not among the most successful universities and colleges for receiving Federal funds for science and engineering research. A list of successful institutions is provided in the "Table 2 Least Successful Institutions" PDF in the "Related Documents" list on the AFRI NOFO Resources webpage.
Matching	The process through which a grant recipient match awarded USDA funds with cash and in-kind contributions on a dollar-for-dollar basis. The matching funds must derive from non-Federal sources.
Multidisciplinary Project	A project on which investigators from two or more disciplines collaborate to address a common problem. These collaborations, where appropriate, may integrate the biological, physical, chemical, or social sciences.
New Application	An application not previously submitted to a program.

Terms	Definitions
Project Director	The PD is legally responsible for management, progress, and completion of the project and for ensuring that project funds are used to accomplish project objectives. The PD submits reports to NIFA periodically and communicates with the National Program Leader. PD has also been historically known as Principal Investigator.
Renewal Application	A project application that seeks additional funding for a project beyond the period that was approved in an original or amended award.
Resubmitted Application	A project application that was previously submitted to a program, but the application was not funded.
Resubmitted Renewal Application	A project application that requests additional funding for a project beyond the period that was approved in the original award. This is an application that had previously been submitted for renewal to but not funded.
Strengthening Grants	Funds awarded to institutions eligible for FASE Grants to enhance institutional capacity, with the goal of leading to future funding in the project area, as well as strengthening the competitiveness of the investigator's research, education, and/or extension activities. Strengthening grants consist of Standard, Coordinated Agricultural Project, and Workshop Grant types as well as Seed Grants, Equipment Grants, and Sabbatical Grants.
Transdisciplinary Team	A team composed of investigators from multiple disciplines that cross boundaries using holistic approaches to address complex challenges that cannot be solved using single-disciplinary approaches.

APPENDIX IV: OTHER AFRI RESOURCES

AFRI program information is available on the NIFA AFRI website. The following are among the materials available:

1. Notice of Funding Opportunities
2. AFRI Annual Review
3. Frequently Asked Questions
4. Interagency Programs
5. AFRI NOFO Resources
   a. ***Most Successful Universities and Colleges.*** Any institution listed on this list, Most Successful Universities and Colleges Receiving Federals Funds, is not eligible for Strengthening Grants from the FASE program unless they are located in an EPSCoR state. See "Table 1 Most Successful Institutions" in the "Related Documents" list.
   b. ***Lowest One Third of Universities and Colleges Receiving Federal Funds.*** The lowest one third of universities and colleges receiving Federal funds is used to determine eligibility for possible waiver of matching funds requirement for Equipment Grants (see "Table 2 Least Successful Institutions" in the "Related Documents" list).
   c. ***Flow Chart for Strengthening Grant Eligibility.*** The Flow Chart for Strengthening Grant Eligibility will help to determine your eligibility to apply for strengthening grants (see "Strengthening Eligibility Decision Tree" in the "Related Documents" list).
6. AFRI Deadlines

FY 2026 Education and Workforce Development NOFO Additional Information for Part IV, C

2/2026 Update: Page 33 - 34:Addition of Mentor and Reference Letters (Pre and Post-doctoral Fellowships)

Note that the required content and forms for applications vary by the program area priority described in the NOFO. Along with the information on this first page, see the appropriate program area priority section for relevant details:

PART IV—APPLICATION AND SUBMISSION INFORMATION

C. Content and Form of Application Submission

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In addition to the information in the AFRI Education and Workforce Development NOFO, additional AFRI specific application instructions can be found below. **All application attachments must be in a portable document format (PDF). Supporting information referenced throughout this Part IV.C. can be found at the NIFA Grants.gov Application Guide, also included in the grants.gov application package.**

Using the bookmark feature in your PDF reader will allow you to navigate easily to the different sections in this document.

1) **SF 424 R&R Cover Sheet**
   Information related to the questions on this form are explained in detail in Part V.130 Field 4 of the NIFA Grants.gov Application Guide. See Part V.100 Field 17 of the NIFA Grants.gov Application Guide for the required certifications and assurances (e.g., Prohibition Against Entities Requiring Certain Internal Confidentiality Agreements).
2) **SF 424 R&R Project/Performance Site Location(s)**
   Detailed information related to the questions on this form is dealt with in detail in Part V.110 of the NIFA Grants.gov Application Guide.
3) **R&R Other Project Information Form**
   Detailed information related to the questions on this form is dealt with in detail in Part V.120 of the NIFA Grants.gov Application Guide.

A. Field 7. Project Summary/Abstract

1. Professional Development for Agricultural Literacy grant applications

Title the attachment as 'Project Summary' in the document header and save file as 'ProjectSummary'.

The summary should explain the relevance of the project to the goals of the Program Area or Program Area Priority within this NOFO to which the application is submitted. See Part V.120 of NIFA Grants.gov Application Guide for further instructions and a link to the suggested template.

The following instructions are in addition to those included in Part V.120 of the NIFA Grants.gov Application Guide.

The Project Summary **must** indicate the following**:**

1) Project title;
2) Indicate the primary AFRI Farm Bill Priority area focus of the project by selecting one of the following:
   a. Plant health and production and plant products;
   b. Animal health and production and animal products;
   c. Food safety, nutrition, and health;
   d. Bioenergy, natural resources, and environment;
   e. Agriculture systems and technology; or
   f. Agriculture economics and rural communities.
3) Project duration;
4) Project Director;
5) Submitting organization;
6) Other organizations involved in the project;
7) Location(s) (schools, colleges, universities, national labs, field stations, etc.) at which the proposed professional development activities will occur;
8) Facilitator to participant ratio;
9) Number of participants per year; and

In addition to the information requested above, please provide a maximum 1-page and approximately 250-word abstract. The abstract should briefly describe the project's objectives, activities, education professionals to be recruited, and intended impact. The abstract should also include the relevance of the project to the goals of the PDAL program area.

2. Agricultural Workforce Training grant applications

Title the attachment as 'Project Summary' in the document header and save file as 'ProjectSummary'.

The summary should explain the relevance of the project to the goals of the Program Area or Program Area Priority within this NOFO to which the application is submitted. See Part V.120 field 7 of NIFA Grants.gov Application Guide for further instructions and a link to the suggested template.

The following instructions are in addition to those included in Part V.120 of the NIFA Grants.gov Application Guide.

The Project Summary **must** indicate the following**:**

1) Project title;
2) Indicate the primary AFRI Farm Bill Priority area focus of the project by selecting one of the following:
   a. Plant health and production and plant products;
   b. Animal health and production and animal products;
   c. Food safety, nutrition, and health;
   d. Bioenergy, natural resources, and environment;
   e. Agriculture systems and technology; or
   f. Agriculture economics and rural communities.
3) Project duration;
4) Project Director;
5) Submitting organization;
6) Other organizations involved in the project;
7) Name or type of industry-accepted credential the project will generate or participants will achieve;
8) Number of expected participants per year; and
9) Location(s) (colleges, businesses, etc.) at which the proposed activities will occur.

In addition to the information requested above, please provide a maximum 1-page and approximately 250-word abstract. The abstract should briefly describe the project's objectives, activities, participants to be recruited (if applicable), and intended impact. The abstract should also include the relevance of the project to the goals of the Agricultural Workforce Training program area.

3. Food and Agriculture Non-formal Education grant applications

Title the attachment as 'Project Summary' in the document header and save file as 'ProjectSummary'. See Part V.120 Field 7 of NIFA Grants.gov Application Guide for further instructions and a link to the suggested template.

The Project Summary **must** indicate the following:

1) Project title
2) Indicate the primary AFRI Farm Bill Priority Area focus of the project by selecting one of the following:

a. Plant health and production and plant products;
b. Animal health and production and animal products;
c. Food safety, nutrition, and health;
d. Bioenergy, natural resources, and environment;
e. Agriculture systems and technology; or
f. Agriculture economics and rural communities.

3) Project duration;
4) Project Director;
5) Submitting organization;
6) Other organizations involved in the project;
7) Location(s) (universities, national labs, field stations, etc.) at which the proposed activities will occur;
8) Technology being addressed;
9) Number of participants per year;
10) Relevance of the project to the goals of Food and Agriculture Non-formal Education (FANE) program area; and
11) Relevance of the project to the goals of FANE Program.

In addition to the information requested above please provide a maximum 1-page and approximately 250-word abstract. The abstract should briefly describe the project's objectives, activities, and participants to be recruited, and intended impact.

4. Research and Extension Experiences for Undergraduates grant applications

Title the attachment as 'Project Summary' in the document header and save file as 'ProjectSummary'. See Part V.120 Field 7 of NIFA Grants.gov Application Guide for further instructions and a link to the suggested template.

For **REEU project applications**, the Project Summary **must** indicate the following:

1) Project title
2) Indicate the primary AFRI Farm Bill Priority Area focus of the project by selecting one of the following six Farm Bill Priority Areas.
   a. Plant health and production and plant products;
   b. Animal health and production and animal products;

c. Food safety, nutrition, and health;
d. Bioenergy, natural resources, and environment;
e. Agriculture systems and technology; or
f. Agriculture economics and rural communities.

3) Project duration;
4) Project Director;
5) Submitting organization;
6) Other organizations involved in the project's operation;
7) Location(s) (universities, national labs, field stations, etc.) at which the proposed undergraduate research and/or extension will occur;
8) Main field(s) and sub-field(s) of the research and/or extension;
9) Number of mentors;
10) Mentor to participant ratio;
11) Number of undergraduate participants per year;
12) Percentage of undergraduate students from the host institution;
13) Number of weeks per year that the students will participate;
14) Relevance of the project to the goals of REEU program area; and
15) Relevance of the project to the goals of AFRI Education and Workforce Development (EWD); and
16) Provide a maximum 1-page and approximately 250-word abstract that briefly describes the project's objectives, activities, and students to be recruited, and intended impact.

5. Pre-and Post-doctoral Fellowships grant applications

Title the attachment as 'Project Summary' in the document header and save file as 'ProjectSummary'. See Part V.120 of NIFA Grants.gov Application Guide for further instructions and a link to the suggested template. The summary should be a maximum of one page and approximately 250 words.

The Project Summary **must** indicate the following:

1) Names and institutions of the PD and Primary Mentor (more than one if Integrated project only);
2) Predoctoral (program code A7101) or Postdoctoral (program code A7201) application;
3) Project type (research, education, extension, or integrated research, education and/or extension) and concise project description in the applicant's proposed predoctoral program or postdoctoral training;
4) Indicate the primary AFRI Farm Bill Priority Area focus of the project

by selecting one of the following:

a. Plant health and production and plant products;
b. Animal health and production and animal products;
c. Food safety, nutrition, and health;
d. Bioenergy, natural resources, and environment;
e. Agriculture systems and technology; or
f. Agriculture economics and rural communities.

5) Relevance of the proposal to the goals of pre- or post-doctoral program area;
6) Relevance of the proposal to the goals of AFRI Education and Workforce Development (EWD).
7) ***Postdoctoral applicants ONLY:***
   a. Indicate the Program Area Priority Name and Program Code from the AFRI Foundational and Applied Science request for applications that most closely topically matches the proposed project.
   b. A table of the AFRI Foundational and Applied Science Program Area Priority Names and Program Codes is listed below (Table 1) and can be found on the AFRI Foundational and Applied Science Program funding opportunity page.
   c. ***Submit the application with the Postdoctoral Fellowship program code A7201 on the SF424.***
   d. Postdoctoral proposals will be reviewed by a respective AFRI Foundational and Applied Science Program Area.

Table 1: Program Area Priorities

The Program Area Priorities are summarized as follows:

Program Area[1]	Program Code	Program Area Priority Name
PHPPP	A1102	1a. Foundational Knowledge of Agricultural Production Systems
PHPPP	A1103	1b. Foundational Knowledge of Plant Products
PHPPP	A1112	1c. Pests and Beneficial Species in Agricultural Production Systems
PHPPP	A1152	1d. Physiology of Agricultural Plants
PHPPP	A1141	1e. Plant Breeding for Agricultural Production
PHPPP	A1113	1f. Pollinator Health: Research and Application
PHPPP	A1143	1g. Conventional Plant Breeding for Cultivar Development
AHPAP	A1211	2a. Animal Reproduction
AHPAP	A1231	2b. Animal Nutrition, Growth and Lactation
AHPAP	A1251	2c. Welfare of Agricultural Animals

AHPAP	A1221	2d. Diseases of Agricultural Animals
AHPAP	A1201	2e. Animal Breeding, Genetics, and Genomics
FSNH	A1332	3a. Food Safety and Defense
FSNH	A1364	3b. Innovations in Food Manufacturing Technologies
FSNH	A1344	3c. Diet, Nutrition, and the Prevention of Chronic Diseases
FSNH	A1343	3d. Food and Human Health
FSNH	A1366	3e. Mitigating Antimicrobial Resistance Across the Food Chain
BNRE	A1401	4a. Soil Health
BNRE	A1411	4b. Water Quantity and Quality
BNRE	A1414	4c. Bioeconomy and Biobased Products
BNRE	A1451	4d. Landscape-Scale Production Systems
AST	A1521	5a. Engineering for Agricultural Production and Processing
AST	A1531	5b. Biorefining and Biomanufacturing
AST	A1511	5c. Nanotechnology for Agricultural and Food Systems
AST	A1551	5d. Engineering for Precision Crop and Water Management
AERC	A1601	6a. Small and Medium-Sized Farms
AERC	A1641	6b. Economics, Markets and Trade
AERC	A1642	6c. Social Implications of Food and Agricultural Technologies
AERC	A1661	6d. Rural Economic Development
AERC	A1651	6e. Environmental and Natural Resource Economics
Crosscutting	A1402	7a. Agricultural Microbiomes in Plant Systems and Natural Resources
Crosscutting	A1701	7b. Critical Agricultural Research and Extension (CARE)
Crosscutting	A1541	7c. Data Science for Food and Agricultural Systems (DSFAS)
Crosscutting	A1181	7d. Agricultural Biosecurity
Crosscutting	A1713	7e. Rapid Response to Emerging and Re-emerging Pest and Disease Events Across Food and Agricultural Systems
Crosscutting	A1811	7f. AFRI Commodity Board Co-funding Topics
Crosscutting	A1712	7g. Rapid Response to Weather Events Across Food and Agricultural Systems

[1] PHPPP=Plant Health and Production and Plant Products, AHPAP=Animal Health and Production and Animal Products; FSNH=Food Safety, Nutrition, and Health; BNRE=Bioenergy, Natural Resources, and Environment; AST=Agriculture Systems and Technology; AERC=Agriculture Economics and Rural Communities; Crosscutting=Crosscutting Program Area Priorities

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6. **Education and Workforce Development Workshop Grants**
   Title the attachment as 'Project Summary' in the document header and save file as 'ProjectSummary'.

The summary should also include the relevance of the project to the goals of the Program Area or Program Area Priority within this NOFO to which the application is submitted. See Part V.120 Field 7 of NIFA Grants.gov Application Guide for further instructions. The suggested template for the Project Summary is located on the NIFA Application Support Templates page "Project Summary" in the attachments list. The project summary should be maximum 1-page and approximately 250 words.

B. Field 8. Project Narrative

1. Professional Development for Agricultural Literacy grant applications

Title the attachment as 'Project Narrative' in the document header and save file as 'ProjectNarrative'.

The Project Narrative may not exceed ten-pages of written text using 12-point font with single line spacing (i.e., no more than six lines per vertical inch), including all figures and tables. Margins must be 1-inch on all sides. Do not use a condensed or narrow font (e.g., Arial Narrow).

To ensure fair competition, applications exceeding the applicable page limitation or violating the limitations on margins or font size will be returned without review.

The Project Narrative must include all of the following:

1) **Specific Application Type Information**
   a. Resubmissions – Response to Previous Review (only applies to Resubmitted Applications, see Part II § B of the NOFO.)
   b. The Project Narrative attachment for resubmissions should include two components:
      i) A maximum one-page response to the previous review (containing the previous proposal number in the first line) titled "Response to Previous Review" as the first page of the attachment and the Project Narrative below.
      ii) The one-page "Response to Previous Review" does not count against the Project Narrative page limit.
2) **Overview**
   a. Provide a brief description of the objectives of the PDAL program to be developed. What AFRI Priority Area(s) is (are) being addressed;

who are the intended participants; what skills gaps and/or academic challenges are being addressed; and what student outcomes will be impacted.

b. Project Justification: Summarize the body of knowledge justifying the need for the proposed project. Describe any ongoing or recently completed, significant activities related to the proposed project. If this application builds upon a previously awarded PDAL grant, please include information about prior program accomplishments, evaluation outcomes, and how the current proposal is innovative and not duplicative of previous awards.

3) Approach

a. Approach to K-14 food and agricultural sciences professional development
   i) Describe the type and details of how immersive learning experiences will be provided for K-14 educational professionals.
   ii) Describe the proposal's creative approach to K-14 professional development in the food and agricultural sciences. Using either actual experiences or literature, show why you selected this approach.

b. Plan of Operation and Methodology
   i) Provide detailed description of the research, education and/or extension participant activities that will be pursued. How will these experiences lead to enhanced student outcomes?
   ii) Describe procedures for accomplishing the objectives of the project. Describe plans for management of the project to ensure its proper and efficient administration. Describe the way in which resources and personnel will be used to conduct the project.
   iii) Identify all important project milestones (performance metrics that indicate when project goals will be met) and dates as they relate to project start-up, execution, evaluation, dissemination, and closeout.

c. Recruitment, Selection, and Continued Support for K-14 Educators
   i) The recruitment plan should be described with as much specificity as possible, including the types and/or names of academic institutions where educational professionals will be recruited and the efforts that will be made to attract educators from low-resource schools.
   ii) Describe the criteria that will be used to select participants.

iii) Indicate how participants, who leave the program early, will be replaced.
iv) Describe additional support that will be provided to participants after the project ends.

4) **The Research, Education and/or Extension Environment**
   a. Describe the experience of the key personnel in providing quality immersive, experiential learning experiences in the food and agricultural sciences and training in the most effective pedagogical strategies for K-14 education.
   b. Describe the institutional support/partnerships for the proposed training. How does the proposed project align with and contribute to applicant and partner institutions' goals for enhancing K-14 education in their community/state/region?
   c. Describe the environment of the host site(s), including, but not limited to, physical plan(s), accommodations for participants with disabilities, accessibility, location(s) of proposed activities, etc.
5) **Project Evaluation and Reporting**
   a. Clearly define a plan with a timeline to extensively evaluate the project using formative and summative assessment tools that can help inform future implementations of immersive learning based professional development programs. Identify pitfalls and limitations to the proposed approach and how these will be addressed.
   b. Define the approach for evaluating both participant (educator) and K-14 student outcomes.
6) **Expected Outputs**
   Please use the format provided below. Expected Outputs table does not count against the ten-page limit of the Project Narrative.

Total expected outputs during grant period	**Expected Number**
(1) Number of products to be developed through grant funds during the grant period (i.e., curricula, academic programs, recruitment/retention programs, materials,	
(2) Number of K-14 education professionals supported by this grant for professional development during the grant period	

(3) Number of students who will indirectly benefit from the products produced from the grant during the grant period (i.e., using the curriculum/instrumentation).	

2. Agricultural Workforce Training grant applications

Title the attachment as 'Project Narrative' in the document header and save file as 'ProjectNarrative'.

The Project Narrative may not exceed ten-pages of written text using 12-point font with single line spacing (i.e., no more than six lines per vertical inch), including all figures and tables. Margins must be 1-inch on all sides. Do not use a condensed or narrow font (e.g., Arial Narrow).

To ensure fair competition, applications exceeding the applicable page limitation or violating the limitations on margins or font size will be returned without review.

The Project Narrative attachment must include all of the following:

1) Specific Application Type Information

a. Resubmissions – Response to Previous Review (only applies to Resubmitted Applications, see Part II § B of the NOFO.)
b. The Project Narrative attachment for resubmissions should include two components:
   i) A maximum one-page response to the previous review (containing the previous proposal number in the first line) titled "Response to Previous Review" as the first page of the attachment and the Project Narrative below.
   ii) The one-page "Response to Previous Review" does not count against the Project Narrative page limit.

2) Overview

a. Provide a brief description of the objectives of the program to be developed. The AFRI Farm Bill Priority Area(s) and workforce need being addressed; the anticipated project audience; and the project's objectives.
b. Summarize the body of knowledge justifying the need for the

proposed project. Describe any ongoing or recently completed, significant activities related to the proposed project.

3) **Approach**

a. Curriculum Development Mechanisms

i) For Design Projects: Describe what elements of curriculum development for workforce training the project will pursue. Curriculum development can include and is not limited to creation of curriculum and instructional delivery systems, pilot testing/ implementation of curriculum and delivery methods, development of assessment tools, and evaluation.

ii) For Implementation Projects: Describe the need to update or expand existing curriculum or training programs. In these projects, updating or expansion of curriculum is limited to the first year of the project with the remaining time being allocated for student training.

iii) Describe the industry-accepted credential(s) the project is to generate and/or participants are to obtain after participation in the project; include the applicability and potential pitfalls generating or obtaining such credential(s). Describe the need for such credential and current buy-in from industry or other groups who may seek to hire the students who obtain the credential.

iv) Describe the proposal's creative approach to agricultural workforce training. Using either actual experiences or literature, show why you selected this approach.

b. Plan of Operation and Methodology

Applications should provide detailed descriptions of the education activities that will be pursued. This discussion should indicate how these activities will lead to enhanced agricultural workforce training.

i) Describe procedures for accomplishing the objectives of the project.

ii) Describe plans for management of the project to ensure its proper and efficient administration.

iii) Describe the way in which resources and personnel will be used to conduct the project.

iv) Identify all important project milestones (performance metrics that indicate when project goals will be met) and dates as they

relate to project start-up, execution, evaluation, dissemination, and closeout.

v) For Implementation projects: Recruitment, Selection, Mentoring, and Continued Support for Participants. The recruitment plan should be described with as much specificity as possible. How will participants be recruited? What criteria will be used to select participants? How will participants, who leave the program early, be replaced? What additional support will be provided to participants after the project ends? While a mentoring plan is required for this program (see section F. Field 12. Other Attachments below), within this section describe how the mentoring activities occur throughout the project and are part of the student learning.

4) The Education Environment

a. Describe the experience of the key personnel in providing quality agricultural workforce training and creating/implementing curricula for the same.

b. Fully describe the Institutional Support/Partnerships for the proposed training. How does the proposed project align with and contribute to the applicant and partner institutions' goals for enhancing workforce training in their community/state/region? Projects that involve partnerships with local government, economic development organizations, and workforce-focused nonprofit organizations are encouraged.

c. Describe the environment of the host site(s), including, but not limited to, physical plan(s), accommodations for participants with disabilities, accessibility, location(s) of proposed activities, etc.

5) Project Evaluation and Reporting

a. Proposals should include a clear internal evaluation plan which describes measures and methods for collecting and analyzing primarily student-focused outcomes and impacts, including metrics/indicators, to determine the extent to which the stated objectives have been achieved. Metrics to be captured include, but are not limited to the number of on-the-job training opportunities, students completing and acquiring the credential, students being placed in jobs after acquiring the credential, etc. Please be as specific as possible in describing the linkages among activities, outputs, and different types of outcomes (e.g., changes in participant

knowledge and awareness of careers in agriculture and training and employment opportunities) and the relevance and potential impact on successfully preparing and supporting students and other communities of learners to enter the future food and agricultural workforce.

b. Identify pitfalls and limitations to proposed approaches and how these will be addressed.
c. As applicable, define the approach for evaluating participant outcomes.

6) Expected Outputs

Please use the format provided below. Expected Outputs table does not count against the ten-page limit of the Project Narrative.

Total expected outputs during grant period	**Expected Number**
(1) Number of products to be developed through grant funds during the grant period (i.e., curricula, academic programs, recruitment/retention programs, materials, on-the-job training opportunities)	
(2) Number of students to be directly supported by this grant (i.e., scholarships, fellowships, paid on-the-job training opportunities, included as a cost in your project budget)	
(3) Number of students who will indirectly benefit from the products produced from the grant during the grant period (i.e., using the curriculum/ instrumentation, enrolled in the program, recruited or retained but not paid by the grant using scholarships, fellowships and assistantships).	

3. Food and Agriculture Non-formal Education grant applications

Title the attachment as 'Project Narrative' in the document header and save file as 'ProjectNarrative'.

The Project Narrative section may not exceed ten-pages of written text using 12-point font with single line spacing (i.e., no more than six lines per vertical inch), including all figures and tables. Margins must be 1-inch on all sides. Do not use a condensed or narrow font (e.g., Arial Narrow).

To ensure fair competition, applications exceeding the applicable page limitation or violating the limitations on margins or font size will be returned without review.

The Project Narrative must include all of the following (see page and font restrictions noted above):

1) **Specific Application Type Information**
    a. Resubmissions – Response to Previous Review (only applies to Resubmitted Applications, see Part II § B of the NOFO.)
    b. The Project Narrative attachment for resubmissions should include two components:
        i) A maximum one-page response to the previous review (containing the previous proposal number in the first line) titled "Response to Previous Review" as the first page of the attachment and the Project Narrative.
        ii) The one-page "Response to Previous Review" does not count against the Project Narrative page limit.
2) **Overview**
    a. Provide a brief description of the objectives of the program to be developed; the AFRI Farm Bill Priority Area(s) and technology being addressed; the anticipated project audience; the project's objectives; timetable; and participating organizations' commitment to the activity.
    b. Summarize the body of knowledge justifying the need for the proposed project. Describe any ongoing or recently completed, significant activities related to the proposed project.
3) **The Extension Environment**
    a. For the project director, the faculty who may serve as mentors, and the institution(s) or organization(s) where the activities will occur, describe their experience(s) working with youth, specifically their experience in implementing positive youth development strategies.
    b. Describe the experience of key personnel in providing quality nonformal education in agricultural technology.
    c. Fully describe the institutional support/partnerships for the proposed project. How does the proposed project

align with and contribute to the applicant and partner institutions' goals for enhancing understanding of agricultural technology in their community/state/region? Projects that involve partnerships with local government, economic development organizations, and nonprofit organizations are encouraged.

d. Describe the environment of the host site(s), including, but not limited to, physical plan(s), accommodations for participants with disabilities, location(s) of proposed activities, etc.

4) Approach

a. Youth Involvement
   i) The proposed involvement of youth in the design, execution, and evaluation of activities that promote learning about agricultural technology should be described with as much specificity as possible, including utilization of appropriate youth development strategies, and a whole-child approach.

b. Outreach Materials Development
   i) Describe what element of outreach and materials the project will pursue to clearly communicate the demonstrated benefits of agricultural technology, the safety record of the regulatory system, and how technology can address agricultural challenges.
   ii) Describe the proposal's creative approach to cultivate interest and build public confidence in the safe and enhanced use of technology in agriculture and food systems. Use either actual experiences and/or literature to show why you selected this approach.

c. Plan of Operation and Methodology
   i) Applications should provide detailed descriptions of the extension activities that will be pursued. This discussion should indicate how these activities will lead to interest and build public confidence in the safe and enhanced use of technology in agriculture and food systems.
   ii) Describe procedures for accomplishing the objectives of this project. Describe plans for management of the project to ensure its proper and efficient administration. Describe the way in which resources and personnel will be used to conduct the project.

iii) Identify all important project milestones (performance metrics that indicate when project goals will be met) and dates as they relate to project start-up, execution, evaluation, dissemination, and closeout.

iv) (If applicable) Recruitment, Selection, and Continued Support for Participants. The recruitment plan should be described with as much specificity as possible. How will participants be recruited? What criteria will be used to select participants?

5) Project Evaluation and Reporting

a. Clearly define a plan with a timeline to extensively evaluate the project using formative and summative assessment tools that can help inform future implementations of agricultural technology nonformal education programs. Identify pitfalls and limitations to proposed approaches and how these will be addressed;

b. Define the approach for tracking how the development of the consumer-friendly content builds confidence in the safe use of technology in agricultural and food systems;

c. Describe how potential adoption of the agricultural technology will be utilized by other institutions and/or organizations.

d. Specifically describe the youth-centered learning outcomes (e.g. skills or knowledge obtained, interest and competencies in STEM and food and agricultural sciences, etc.) and associated measures to evaluate outcomes;

e. Describe how these outcome measures were chosen; and

f. Provide strategies to assess, at the project-level, management of the project for successful outcomes.

6) Expected Outputs

Please use the table format below. Expected Outputs table does not count against the ten-page limit of the Project Narrative.

Total expected outputs during grant period	**Expected Number**
(1) Number of products to be developed through grant funds during the grant period (i.e., curricula, outreach materials)	
(2) Number of youth participants to be directly supported by this grant	

(3) Number of youth who will indirectly benefit from the products produced from the grant during the grant period (i.e. using the materials, enrolled in the project)	

4. Research and Extension Experiences for Undergraduates grant applications

Title the attachment as 'Project Narrative' in the document header and save file as 'ProjectNarrative'.

The Project Narrative section may not exceed a total of ten-pages of written text using 12- point font with single line spacing (i.e., no more than six lines per vertical inch), including all figures and tables. Margins must be 1-inch on all sides. Do not used a condensed or narrow font (e.g., Arial Narrow).

To ensure fair competition, applications exceeding the applicable page limitation or violating the limitations on margins or font size will be returned without review.

The Project Narrative (see page and font restrictions noted above)

1) **Specific Application Type Information**
   a. Response to Previous Review (only applies to Resubmitted Applications, see Part II § B of the NOFO)
   b. The Project Narrative attachment for resubmissions should include two components:
      i) A maximum one-page response to the previous review (containing the previous proposal number in the first line) titled "Response to Previous Review" as the first page of the attachment and the Project Narrative.
      ii) The one-page "Response to Previous Review" does not count against the Project Narrative page limit.
   c. Progress Report (Only applies to proposals building on previously awarded REEU projects). This requirement only applies to project directors who are submitting a proposal in the current FY competition AND who have held an REEU award in the last five years. These applications must include a progress report within the applicable page limitation of the Project Narrative and should

highlight program accomplishments, evaluation outcomes, and resulting adjustments and developments in the program's scope and logistics (if any). This section should be labeled "Progress Report."

2) **Overview**
   a. Provide a brief description of the objectives of the proposed host site(s)/location(s), intended student participants, intellectual focus, organizational structure, timetable, and participating organizations' commitment to the activity.

3) **The Research, Education and/or Extension Environment**
   a. For the project director, the faculty who may serve as mentors, and the institution(s) or organization(s) where the activities will occur, describe the experience, and the record of the involvement with undergraduate students. Include information on the record of faculty/mentors in publishing work involving undergraduate authors and in providing professional development opportunities for undergraduate students.
   b. Describe the environment of the host site(s), including, but not limited to, physical plan(s), accommodations for students with disabilities, accessibility, location(s) of proposed activities, etc.

4) **Approach**

   The Approach **must** include the following:
   a. Student Recruitment, Selection, and Retention
      i) The recruitment plan should be described with as much specificity as possible, including the types and/or names of academic institutions where students will be recruited.
      ii) The number of students per project should be appropriate to the institutional or organizational setting and to the way research is conducted in the discipline.
      iii) Indicate how undergraduate fellows, who leave the program early, will be replaced.
   b. Nature of Student Activities
      i) Proposals should address the approach to undergraduate research, education and/or extension training being taken and should provide detailed descriptions of the research, education and/or extension projects that the undergraduate students will pursue. This discussion should indicate the significance of the research, education and/or extension

area(s) and, when appropriate, the underlying theoretical framework, hypotheses, and questions.

ii) Proposals must present plans that will ensure the development of student faculty interaction and student-student communication.

c. Institutional Support

i) Fully describe the institutional support for the proposed training. How does the proposed project align with the institution's goals for experiential learning? How does the proposed project contribute to achieving these goals?

5) Project Evaluation and Reporting

a. Clearly define a plan with a timeline to extensively evaluate the project using formative and summative assessment tools that can help inform future implementations of experiential learning programs. Identify pitfalls and limitations to proposed approaches and how these will be addressed;

b. Define the approach for longitudinal tracking of the students after completion of the Research and Extension Experiences for Undergraduates program; include strategies for tracking Fellows to their exit point from the institution; and if employed where and at what level, if graduate training then what institutions and in what level/areas of study etc.;

c. Specifically describe the student-centered learning outcomes (e.g., skills or knowledge obtained, presentations and publications, graduation rates, students matriculating to graduate schools, etc.) and associated measures to evaluate outcomes;

d. Describe how these outcome measures were chosen; and

e. Provide strategies to assess, at the project-level, management of the project for successful outcomes.

6) Expected Outputs

Please use the table format below. Expected Outputs table does not count against the ten-page limit of the Project Narrative.

Total expected outputs during grant period	**Expected Number**
(1) Number of students to be directly supported by this grant (i.e., scholarships, fellowships, assistantships, internships included as a cost in your project budget) for undergraduate education	

(3) Number of female students to be directly supported by this grant(i.e., scholarships, fellowships, assistantships, internships included as a cost in your project budget) for undergraduate education	
(5) Number of students supported by this grant (i.e., scholarships, fellowships, assistantships) who are pursuing:	
5-A. Two-year or other certificates	
5-B. Four-year Undergraduate degrees	
(6) Number of student domestic experiences, with a government or non- governmental organization that is not affiliated with your university, to be supported by this grant	

5. Pre and Post-doctoral Fellowships grant applications

Title the attachment as 'Project Narrative' in the document header and save file as 'ProjectNarrative'.

1) For Predoctoral Grant applications, the Project Narrative section may not exceed a total of six-pages using 12-point font with single line spacing (i.e., no more than six lines per vertical inch), including all figures and tables. Margins must be 1-inch on all sides. Do not use a condensed or narrow font (e.g., Arial Narrow).
2) For Postdoctoral Grant applications, the Project Narrative section may not exceed a total of ten-pages using 12-point font with single line spacing (i.e., no more than six lines per vertical inch), including all figures and tables. Margins must be 1-inch on all sides. Do not use a condensed or narrow font (e.g., Arial Narrow).

To ensure fair competition, applications exceeding the applicable page limitation or violating the limitations on margins or font size will be returned without review.

NOTE: The project narrative attachment includes: Response to Previous Review (for resubmitted applications ONLY); Training/Career Development Plan; Mentoring Plan; Project Plan; and Evaluation Plan. All components will be considered in accordance with the Part V. B Evaluation Criteria.

1) Response to Previous Review (only applies to Resubmitted

Applications, see Part II § B of the NOFO)

a. A maximum one-page response to the previous review. Include:
   i) Previous proposal number.
   ii) "Response to Previous Review" as the title on the first page of the project narrative attachment.
b. The one-page "Response to Previous Review" does not count against the Project Narrative page limit.
c. The "Response to Previous Review" is not applicable to new applications (**see Part II § B of the NOFO)**.

2) Training/Career Development Plan

The Training/Career Development Plan is a statement of career goals and a description of fellowship activities, knowledge, and skills that will lead to career independence.

This Career Development Plan must include:

a. A personal statement addressing overall career goals and objectives;
b. A description of *specific* fellowship activities to achieve professional goals and objectives;
c. Any other extension, education, and/or research activities (e.g., teaching in formal or informal settings, cross-disciplinary collaborations, etc.) to enhance career development;
d. Explanation of new knowledge and skills expected from the fellowship activities;
e. Plans for transition to career independence.

3) Mentoring Plan

The applicants are expected to identify a Primary Mentor who will be willing to help them in their application and projects as well as professional development (more than one Primary Mentor is acceptable for Integrated Projects only). If there are other collaborating mentors, their role and responsibilities to the project and development of the applicant's skills should be clearly described. For predoctoral applications, if the primary mentor is not the student's graduate advisor or laboratory sponsor, the relationship between advisor's work and the primary mentor's research should be clearly defined, and the contribution of each individual in the student's project as well as degree completion should be included. The commitment of the mentor(s) is included in the evaluation criteria as it pertains to project personnel.

In describing the role of the mentor, *the applicant should*:

a. Indicate how the mentoring and educational training will add to the skill sets and help in achieving professional goals and objectives.
b. Articulate *specific* mentoring activities the mentor and applicant will be engaged in, including specific deliverables from these activities and how/why these activities were chosen.
c. Explain the role and commitment of the primary mentor.
d. If applicable, briefly describe the role of collaborating mentors.
e. With respect to the Primary Mentor, provide specifics on what the mentor will do and where applicable highlight successes of past mentees relevant to the proposal and career aspiration of the PD (do not just list all previous mentees).

***NOTE*:** The Primary Mentor *must* submit a Letter of Commitment (as an attachment to Field 12, Other Attachments, of the Other Project Information form) explicitly indicating their respective responsibilities throughout the proposed project in relation to the Project Director.

4) Project Plan

Predoctoral Applicants: It is expected that predoctoral students will be working with a primary mentor or advisor who has funded research and that the fellow may work on another aspect of this research. Moreover, the mentor/advisor will already have the facilities, equipment, technologies, and methodologies for the projects developed with the fellow.

a. Experimental methods, especially if these are routinely or generally used, do not need detailed description. However, sufficient details on the experimental approach or strategy as well as pitfalls must be provided to allow assessment of feasibility of study.
b. The Project scope should be within the 3-year timeframe of the fellowship.

Postdoctoral Applicants: The research should be clearly differentiated from the mentor's work. The applicant should describe the portability of the research and outline what from this work will go with them in a new role. Clearly articulate how this project and the data that comes from it will help foster career independence. Proven techniques and technologies as part of the experimental approach, especially if these are routinely employed, do not have to be provided in detail (but should be appropriately cited).

a. Experimental approaches or strategies including possible pitfalls and alternatives must be provided to assess the overall feasibility of the

proposed study.

b. The scope of the project should be within the 2-year timeframe.

Project Plans should contain the following:

a. Introduction
   i) Include a well-defined problem, a clear statement of the long-term goal(s) and supporting objectives of the proposed project.
   ii) Summarize the body of knowledge or other past activities that substantiate the need for the proposed project.
   iii) Describe ongoing or recently completed activities related to the proposed project including the work of key project personnel.
   iv) Include preliminary data/information pertinent to the proposed work.
   v) All works cited should be referenced (see Bibliography & References Cited).

b. Rationale and Significance
   i) Concisely present the rationale behind the proposed project and how it will advance the current knowledge in the field;
   ii) Clearly describe the specific relationship of the project's objectives to the primary AFRI Farm Bill Priority Area as identified in the Project Summary/Abstract.

c. Approach
   Provide a concise description of the proposed project and the problem(s) to be addressed. Clearly describe the approaches to be used. Specifically, this section must include:
   i) A description of the project details proposed and the sequence in which the activities are to be performed;
   ii) Methods to be used in carrying out the proposed project and feasibility of the methods (detail only if a new and unproven method is to be used; if employing commonly used methods provide information on the expertise available);
   iii) Expected outcomes and outcome measures;
   iv) Means by which results will be analyzed, assessed, or interpreted;
   v) How results or products will be used;
   vi) Discuss any potential pitfalls that may be encountered, and how they will be addressed;
   vii) Limitations to proposed procedures;
   viii) A full explanation of any materials, procedures, situations, or

activities related to the project that may be hazardous to personnel, along with an outline or precautions to be exercised to avoid or mitigate the effects of such hazards;

ix) A timeline for attainment of objectives and for production of deliverables with specific, measurable outcomes.

5) Evaluation Plan

Applicants must provide a plan for evaluating progress towards fellowship objectives related to the training/career development plan, mentoring plan, and project plan. In developing evaluation plan components related to the project type, the applicant may refer to the AFRI Project Types resource on the AFRI Notice of Funding Opportunities Resources page. The fellowship evaluation plan should include:

a. Milestones, which signify the completion of major deliverables, events, and accomplishments.
b. Measurable indicators to verify that the fellowship is on schedule and on track for successful conclusion.
c. A dissemination plan describing the methods that will be used to communicate findings and fellowship accomplishments.
d. A description of how the fellowship proposal aligns with the Predoctoral and Postdoctoral Fellowship program aim of cultivating future leaders who can solve emerging agricultural challenges.

6. Education and Workforce Development Workshop Grants

Title the attachment as 'Project Narrative' in the document header and save file as 'ProjectNarrative'.

The Project Narrative section may not exceed a total of ten-pages of written text using 12- point font with single line spacing (i.e., no more than six lines per vertical inch), including all figures and tables. Margins must be 1-inch on all sides. Do not use a condensed or narrow font (e.g., Arial Narrow).

To ensure fair competition, applications exceeding the applicable page limitation or violating the limitations on margins or font size will be returned without review.

The Project Narrative (see page and font restrictions noted above)

1) Specific Application Type Information

a. Response to Previous Review (only applies to Resubmitted Applications, see Part II § B of the NOFO)

b. The Project Narrative attachment for resubmissions should include two components:

   i) A maximum one-page response to the previous review (containing the previous proposal number in the first line) titled "Response to Previous Review" as the first page of the attachment and the Project Narrative.

   ii) The one-page "Response to Previous Review" does not count against the Project Narrative page limit.

c. A mentoring plan is not required.

2) Introduction

Include a clear statement of the long-term goal(s) and supporting objectives of the proposed project. Summarize the body of knowledge or past activities that substantiate the need for the proposed project. Describe ongoing or recently completed activities significant to the proposed project including the work of key project personnel. Include preliminary data/information pertinent to the proposed project. This section should include in-depth information on the following, when applicable:

a. Estimates of the magnitude of the issues and the relevance to stakeholders and ongoing state-federal food and agricultural research, education, and extension programs;

b. The role of stakeholders in problem identification, planning, implementation, and evaluation, as appropriate; and

c. Reasons for performing the work at the proposed institution.

All works cited should be referenced (see Bibliography & References Cited in Part IV § C3(c)), below).

3) Rationale and Significance

a. Concisely present the rationale behind the proposed project;

b. Describe the specific relationship of the project's objectives to one of the AFRI EWD Program Area Priorities. Applications that do not address at least one AFRI EWD Program Area Priority will not be reviewed; and

c. Clearly describe the potential long-range improvement in and sustainability of U.S. agriculture and food systems. These purposes are described under Purpose and Priorities in Part I § B of the NOFO. Any novel ideas or contributions that the proposed

project offers should also be discussed in this section.

4) **Approach**
   a. A justification for the meeting;
   b. Recent meetings on the same subject with dates and locations;
   c. Names and organizational affiliations of the chair and other members of the organizing committee;
   d. A proposed program (or agenda) for the workshop, including a listing of scheduled participants and their institutional affiliations; and
   e. The method of announcement or invitation that will be used.

C. Field 9. Bibliography & References Cited

No Page Limit. Title the attachment as 'Bibliography & References Cited' in the document header and save file as 'BibliographyReferencesCited'.

All work cited in the text should be referenced in this section of the application. All references must be complete; include titles and all co-authors; conform to an acceptable journal format; and be listed in alphabetical order using the last name of the first author or listed by number in the order of citation.

D. Field 10. Facilities & Other Resources

No Page Limit. Title the attachment as 'Facilities & Other Resources' in the document header and save file as 'FacilitiesOtherResources'.

E. Field 11. Equipment

No Page Limit. Title the attachment as 'Equipment' in the document header and save file as 'Equipment'.

Describe available equipment. Items of nonexpendable equipment necessary to conduct and successfully complete the proposed project should be listed in Field C. of the R&R Budget and described in the Budget Justification (see Part IV§ C.6 below).

F. Field 12. Other Attachments

The following instructions are in addition to those noted in Part V.120 of the NIFA Grants.gov Application Guide.

1. **Key Personnel Roles**

   2-Page Limit. Title the attachment as 'Key Personnel' and save file as 'KeyPersonnel'.

a. *For Integrated Grant Applications* – state for key personnel an estimate of the percent of time devoted to research, education, and/or extension activities.

Clearly describe the roles and responsibilities of the PD, collaborator(s), etc. (biographical sketches for key personnel including mentor(s) should not be included here). If it will be necessary to enter into formal consulting or collaborative arrangements with others, such arrangements should be fully explained and justified. Evidence (letters of support) for this type of collaboration should be provided in the 'Documentation of Collaboration' attachment (see item 6 below).

2. Logic Model

2-Page Limit. **Required for all Integrated Project applications. Encouraged for Research, Education, or Extension Project applications.** Title the attachment as 'Logic Model' and save file as 'LogicModel'.

Include the elements of a logic model detailing the activities, outputs, and outcomes of the proposed project. The logic model planning process is a tool that should be used to develop your project before writing your application. This information may be provided as a narrative or formatted into a logic model chart. For more information and resources, see Integrated Programs' Logic Model Planning Process.

Failure to include a logic model for an integrated project may result in the application not being considered for review.

3. Management Plan

2-Page Limit. **Required for Integrated Project applications. Encouraged for Research, Education, or Extension Project applications.** Title the attachment as 'Management Plan' and save file as 'ManagementPlan'.

The plan is to be clearly articulated and include an organizational chart, administrative timeline, and a description of how the project will be governed, as well as a strategy to enhance coordination, collaboration, communication, and data sharing and reporting among members of the project team and stakeholder groups. The plan must also address how the

project will be sustained beyond the award end date.

The management plan must also include an advisory group of principal stakeholders, partners, and professionals to assess and evaluate the quality, expected measurable outcomes, and potential impacts for the proposed research, education and/or extension. Please include rationale for their role, and how they will function effectively to support the goals and objectives of the project. The plan must demonstrate how partners and stakeholders contribute to project assessment on an annual basis.

4. **Data Management Plan (DMP)**
   2-Page Limit. Required for all applications. Title the attachment as 'Data Management Plan' and save file as 'DataManagementPlan'.

   Clearly articulate how the project director (PD) and co-PDs plan to manage and disseminate the data generated by the project. The DMP will be considered during the merit review process (see Part V § B of the NOFO). See Part V.320, of the NIFA Grants.gov Application Guide for NIFA attachment specifications.

   For the guidelines on preparation and inclusion of a DMP in your application, see Data Management Plan for NIFA-Funded Research, Education and Extension Projects at NIFA website. Also included on the web page are FAQs and information about accessing examples of DMPs. In addition, general guidelines for Data Management Planning for USDA agencies are available at the National Agricultural Library website.

5. **Mentoring Plan (MentP)**
   A Mentoring Plan is required for all grant types (except Workshop Grants) that involve student or participant training or mentoring. The guidelines below apply to all grant types except Predoctoral Fellowships and Postdoctoral Fellowships, which have their own unique mentoring requirements within the Field 8. Project Narrative attachment.

   Title the attachment as 'Mentoring Plan' and save file as 'MentoringPlan'.

   There is a 2-page limit for standard grant applications. Mentoring plans should be included as a separate attachment and uploaded to field 12 of the grant application. All student types should be included in the same mentoring plan.

The Mentoring Plan should describe:

1) past or proposed training of individuals who will serve as mentors including equipping, mentoring, or monitoring activities they have received or will receive to help them effectively mentor students and trainees during the project;
2) the groups of students or individual trainees to be mentored on the project, including students grades 9-12, undergraduate students, graduate students, postdoctoral scholars, professionals and any other individuals to be trained or mentored on the project;
3) detailed mentoring activities to be delivered throughout the project to each distinct category or group of students and/or trainee participants, including those activities provided through research, education, Extension or outreach efforts; and
4) expected outcomes derived from the mentoring activities and prospective impact(s) on the food and agricultural sciences.

6. Documentation of Collaboration

No Page Limit. Title the attachment as 'Documentation of Collaboration' in the document header and save file as 'Collaboration'.

Include evidence of collaboration and contributions amongst the host institution and partners.

Evidence, *e.g.*, letter(s) of support, must be provided that the collaborators involved have agreed to render services, including letters of commitment for subcontracts. The applicant also will be required to provide additional information on consultants and collaborators in the budget portion of the application.

7. Preprints

Limited to 2 preprints. Title the attachment as 'Preprints' in the document header and save file as 'Preprints'.

Preprints related to the Project Narrative are allowed if they are directly germane to the proposed project. Information may not be appended to an application to circumvent page limitations prescribed for the Project Narrative. Extraneous materials will not be used during the peer review process. Only manuscripts in press for a peer- reviewed journal will be

accepted and must be accompanied by letters of acceptance from the publishing journals. Preprints attached in support of the application must be single-spaced. Each preprint must be identified with the name of the submitting organization, the name(s) of the PD(s), and the title of the application.

8. **Minority-Serving Institution Documentation**
   Optional: May be needed if applying for a FASE Strengthening Standard Grant.
   Title the attachment as 'Minorityinfo' in the document header and save file as 'Minorityinfo'.
   1) Letter identifying percentage of applicable minority students.
   2) Request for Determination of Status– see Part III § B of the NOFO.

9. **Mentor and Reference Letters (Pre and Post-doctoral Fellowships)**
   1) **Primary Mentor Commitment Letter**
      One Primary Mentor letter is required. If there is more than one Primary Mentor (Integrated Projects Only), a Primary mentor letter should be provided for each mentor. The mentor letter(s) should indicate:
      a. the quality of the applicant in regard to their ability to develop into a leader in food and agriculture;
      b. the applicant's oral and written communication skills and critical and analytical skills;
      c. the applicant's level of intellectual independence;
      d. the role of the student and mentor in the development of the application;
      e. their respective committed responsibilities throughout the proposed project in relation to the Project Director;
      f. a statement that the research by the applicant is independent and not an extension of the mentor's research (for postdoctoral applicants only); and
      g. any other pertinent and relevant information to indicate the applicant is deserving of being awarded a prestigious AFRI EWD Pre- or Post-doctoral Fellowship.
   2) **Collaborating Mentor Letter(s)**
      Other mentor letter(s) should generally comment on the items listed above for the Primary Mentor Letter of Commitment, limited to one page.

3) **Reference Letters(s)**
Three reference letters are required. Letters should not come from identified mentor(s) but must be obtained from other individuals who know the applicant well to substantially speak towards the applicant's academic and research accomplishments and ability to complete the doctoral degree program, or undertake an independent postdoctoral research, education, extension, or integrated research, education and/or extension project. Reference letters should be no longer than one- page.

4) **Academic Standing**
   a. For **predoctoral applications,** documentation from the graduate advisor, graduate committee or the institution indicating that the applicant has advanced to candidacy, as per institutional requirements, by the date specified in the EWD NOFO.
   b. For **postdoctoral applications**, documentation from the graduate advisor, graduate committee or the institution that all doctoral degree requirements were satisfied by the date specified in the EWD NOFO.

4) R&R Senior/Key Person Profile (Expanded)

Detailed information related to the questions on this form is available in Part V.130 of the NIFA Grants.gov Application Guide. This section of the guide includes instructions about the people who require senior/key person profile, and details about the biographical sketch and the current and pending support, including a link to the suggested template for the current and pending support.

A Senior/Key Person Profile must be completed for the PD and each co-PD, senior associate, and other professional personnel, including collaborators playing an active role in the project. Collaborators only providing services or materials should not be listed in the R&R Senior/Key Person Profile. Evidence (letters of support) for this type of collaboration should be provided in the Documentation of Collaboration (see Part IV § C.3(f6)).

G. Project Role Field
Complete appropriately.

H. Other Project Role Category Field
Complete appropriately, if applicable.

I. Attach Biographical Sketch Field
2-Page Limit (excluding publications listings) per PD, co-PD, senior associate, and other professional personnel. Title the attachment as 'Biographical Sketch' in

the document header and save file as 'BiographicalSketch' followed by the last name of the PD or co-PD such that each biographical sketch file in the application has a distinct file name.

The Biographical sketch of the applicant (PD) and each co-PD, senior associate, and other professional personnel must be included. In addition, include:

1. Author identifier (ORCID, https://orcid.org) of the researcher if available.
2. Digital Object Identifier (DOI) of all publications where possible.

If applicable, the application must include a list of data publications or published data products relevant to the proposed project, following recommended data citation format.

In addition, Biographical sketch must include:

1. A presentation of academic, extension, and/or research credentials including, as applicable: earned degrees, teaching experience, employment history, professional activities, honors and awards, and grants received; and
2. The number of continuing education courses developed and taught/trained the number of educators by the applicant.
3. All relevant publications in refereed journals during the past four (4) years including those in press.

The Conflict of Interest list must not be included in the biographical sketch, but it must be provided as a separate document (see Part IV § C.7(b) for more information).

J. Attach Current and Pending Support Field

No Page Limit. Title the attachment as 'Current and Pending Support' in the document header and save file as 'CurrentPendingSupport'.

The suggested template for Current and Pending Support is located on the NIFA Application Support Templates page ("Current & Pending Support" in the attachments list). Current and Pending Support information is only required for the PD and co-PDs identified.

Note: Even if no other funding is currently reported under the 'Active' section of this attachment, each senior/key person must list this grant application under

the 'Pending' section of this attachment.

As an addendum to the Current and Pending Support, provide a brief summary for any completed, current, or pending projects that appear similar to the current application.

5) **R&R Personal Data**
As noted in Part V.140 of the NIFA Grants.gov Application Guide, the submission of this information is voluntary and is not a precondition of award. Part V.140 also notes the importance and use of the information.

6) **R&R Budget**
Detailed information related to the questions on this form is available in Part V.150 of the NIFA Grants.gov Application Guide.

K. Matching Funds

Applicants MUST provide matching contributions on a dollar-for-dollar basis for all Federal funds awarded under AFRI for applied research grants or integrated projects with an applied research component.

If you conclude that matching funds are not required as specified under Part III § C of the NOFO, Cost Sharing or Matching, you must include an explanation for your conclusion in the Budget Justification. We will consider this justification when determining final matching requirements or if required matching can be waived. NIFA retains the right to make final determinations regarding matching requirements.

For grants that require matching funds as specified under Part III § C of the NOFO, the Budget Justification must list matching sources along with the identification of the entity(ies) providing the match as well as the total dollar amount being pledged. NIFA is no longer requiring written verification of commitments of matching support (a pledge agreement). However, you are still subject to documentation, valuing and reporting requirements, etc. as specified in 2 CFR Part 200, "Uniform Administrative Requirements, Cost Principles, and Audit Requirements for Federal Awards (the Uniform Guidance)," 7 CFR 3430, "Competitive and Noncompetitive Non-Formula Federal Assistance Programs – General Award Administrative Provisions," and program-specific regulations, as applicable. In instances where match is required, any resulting award will require the signature of an Authorized Representative. Only when NIFA receives the award signed by the AR will award funds be released and available for drawdown.

The sources and the amount of all matching support from outside the applicant organization must be summarized on a separate page and placed in the application immediately following the Budget Justification. If included, although not required, all pledge agreements must be placed in the application immediately following the summary of matching support.

Establish the value of applicant contributions in accordance with applicable cost principles. Refer to 2 CFR Part 200, "Uniform Administrative Requirements, Cost Principles, and Audit Requirements for Federal Awards," for further guidance and other requirements relating to matching and allowable costs.

L. Budget Periods

Applications must contain a budget for each budget period for the entire duration of the proposed project. Annual and cumulative budgets are required.

If a PDAL, AWT, FANE, or REEU application is funded, the Project Director will be required to attend one AFRI EWD Project Directors' meetings during the performance period of the award.

If a Predoctoral fellowship grant application is funded, the Project Director will be required to attend one AFRI Fellows Project Directors' meeting during the performance period of the award.

Postdoctoral fellowship Project Directors are required to attend one AFRI Fellows Project Directors' meeting AND a PD meeting of the Foundational and Applied Science program area priority with which the project is most closely aligned during the performance period of the award.

Reasonable travel expenses (location to be determined by NIFA program staff) should be included as part of the project budget.

See Part I § C of the NOFO for limitation of budget amounts, use of funds, and budget periods.

1. For Integrated Project Applications, projects must budget sufficient resources to carry out the proposed set of research, education, and/or extension activities that will lead to the desired outcomes. No more than two-thirds of a project's budget may be focused on a single component.
2. For Workshop Grant Applications, the budget for the workshop may include an

appropriate amount for transportation and subsistence costs for participants and for other workshop-related costs. NIFA will not support Workshop Grants with the sole purpose of supporting travel or to be implemented as subawards for travel grants. Workshop Grant awards must not exceed $50,000 and are not renewable. Indirect costs are not permitted on Workshop Grant awards. Include an itemized breakdown of all support requested from AFRI EWD in the Budget Justification (Field K. of the R&R Budget).

M. Subcontract Arrangements

If it will be necessary to enter into a formal subcontract agreement with another institution, then refer to the following items.

1. Letters of commitment (including proposed amount of subaward) and statement of work are required to be included in the application for each subaward. Letters of commitment are to be included in Field 12, Other Attachments of the R&R Other Project Information.
2. If the cumulative amount for subawards exceeds 50 percent of the total Federal funds requested or in instances where the proposed subaward is to a Federal agency, then the applicant must provide budgetary detail (i.e., budget and budget justification) for each subaward. If this is the case then refer to Part V.150 Section H. of the NIFA Grants.gov Application Guide for instructions on how to include this information as part of the application.

N. Field H. Indirect Costs

See Part V.150 Section H of the NIFA Grants.gov Application Guide for details, and Part IV § D of the NOFO for additional information.

O. Field K. Budget Justification

No Page Limit. Title the attachment as 'Budget Justification' in the document header and save file as 'BudgetJustification'.

All cumulative budget categories, with the exception of Indirect Costs, for which support is requested must be individually listed (with costs) in the same order as the cumulative budget. If consulting, collaborative, or sub contractual arrangements are included in the application, these arrangements should be fully explained and justified. The rate of pay for any consultant must be included, if known at the time of application. Please include a cost breakdown for the consultant, including the number of days in service, travel, and per diem, as well as the rate of pay. Letters of consent or collaboration signed by the Authorized Representative and other evidence should be provided in the Documentation of Collaboration (see Part IV § C.3(f6)) to show that collaborators have agreed to participate. A proposed statement of work, biographical sketch, and a budget for each arrangement involving the transfer of substantive programmatic work or the provision of financial assistance to a third party must be supplied. Allowable expenditures must be appropriately discussed in the

budget justification. In multi- institutional applications, a budget and budget narrative must be included for each institution involved. The lead institution and each participating institution must be identified.

1. *For Integrated Project Applications* – Each function should be represented by one or more objectives within the application. Projects must budget sufficient resources to carry out the proposed set of research, education, and/or extension activities that will lead to the desired outcomes. No more than two-thirds of a project's budget may be focused on a single component.

7) Supplemental Information Form

Instructions related to this form are explained in detail in Part VI.300 of the NIFA Grants.gov Application Guide.

P. Field 2. Program to which you are applying

Enter the Program Code Name and the Program Code for the Program Area to which you are applying from the information provided in the Program Area Descriptions beginning in Part I § C of the NOFO. An application can only be submitted to one program area. Note that accurate entry of the Program Code Name and Program Code is extremely important for proper and timely processing of application. Failure to enter this information correctly may result in your application not being retrieved on time for review and subsequently not being considered for funding. If you have a question about which topic area is appropriate for your application, please contact the Program Area Contact.

Q. Field 8. Conflict of Interest List

No Page Limit. Title the attachment as 'Conflict of Interest' in the document header and save file as 'Conflict of Interest'. See Part V.300 Field 8 of the NIFA Grants.gov Application Guide for further instructions and a link to the suggested template.

A Conflict of Interest List is required for all applications submitted to the AFRI EWD NOFO. The Conflict of Interest List should be provided as a separate PDF attachment and not included in the vitae or resume. A Conflict of Interest List must be completed individually for all personnel who have submitted a Biographical Sketch in the R&R Senior/Key Personnel Profile. **Collate all individual Conflict of Interest lists into a single document file.** The lists can only be submitted as a single PDF attachment.

The required template for the Conflict of Interest List is located on the NIFA Application Support Templates page ("Conflict of Interest List" in the attachments list)

National Institute of Food and Agriculture Grants Application Guide

March 2026

Guidance documents lack the force and effect of law, unless expressly authorized by statute or incorporated into a contract. USDA may not cite, use, or rely on any guidance that is not available through their guidance portal, except to establish historical facts.

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I. Introduction

This Application Guide will help you prepare and submit grant applications to NIFA through Grants.gov. Where appropriate, relevant sections of the Grants.gov User Guide and NIFA Policy Guide have been incorporated by reference.

Applicants for all types of NIFA grants can use this guide to prepare for the pre-award and application processes.

I.100 Acronyms Used in this Guide

- ADO: Authorized Departmental Officer
- AFRI: Agriculture and Food Research Initiative
- AL: Assistance Listing
- AO: Authorizing Official
- AOR: Authorized Organizational Representative
- FO: Funding Opportunity
- IRB: Institutional Review Board
- NIFA: National Institute of Food and Agriculture
- OGFM: Office of Grants and Financial Management
- NOFO: Notice of Funding Opportunity
- RFP: Request for Proposal
- SAM: System for Awards Management
- SBIR: Small Business Innovation and Research
- STTR: Small Business Technology Transfer
- UEI: Unique Entity Identifier
- USDA: United States Department of Agriculture

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I.200 Glossary of Applicant Resources

Applicants to NIFA grant opportunities will have access to a variety of websites and guides to help them through the grant process. A brief list of these essential resources is below.

Grants.gov

Grants.gov is a government website that provides a centralized location for grant seekers to find and apply for federal funding opportunities. Today, the Grants.gov system houses information on over 1,000 grant programs and vets grant applications for federal grant-making agencies.

NIFA's funding opportunities are posted to Grants.gov, and applications can be submitted through the Grants.gov Workspace portal.

NIFA Policy Guide

The NIFA Federal Assistance Policy Guide describes the statutory and regulatory responsibilities of NIFA federally funded recipients.

The Policy Guide continues to provide comprehensive guidance on roles and responsibilities, application and review processes, award notification and administration procedures, award terms and conditions, uniform administrative requirements, allowable costs, reporting requirements, close-out procedures, and audit requirements.

The latest version of the NIFA Policy Guide can be found at NIFA's Federal Assistance Policy Guide page.

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Notice of Funding Opportunity List

A Notice of Funding Opportunity (NOFO) is a notice that provides potential applicants with detailed information about an opportunity to submit an application for Federal financial assistance.

The notice generally includes the purpose, eligibility, restrictions, focus areas, evaluation criteria, regulatory information, and instructions on how to apply.

NIFA's upcoming NOFOs are posted on NIFA's NOFO List.

Terms and Conditions

Award terms and conditions are determined by statutory, regulatory, and agency requirements, as well as each grant's circumstances. Terms and conditions dictate important items related to your grant, including method of payment, reporting frequency and content, and prior approval requirements.

References to the terms and conditions of your award are located on the Notice of Award. More information can be found on NIFA's Terms and Conditions page.

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I.300 Grant Types and Requirements Overview

NIFA offers three types of grants to support food and agricultural programs.

- Competitive Grants: Applicants compete for limited grant funds. Applications are subject to a rigorous peer review process. Competitive grants are announced through a Notice of Funding Opportunity (NOFO).

- Non-Competitive Grants: Non-competitive grants are directed by Congress to support designated institutions for research, education, or extension on topics of importance to a state or region. Non-competitive grants are announced through a Request for Proposal (RFP).

- Capacity Grants: These grants are intended for land-grant institutions, schools of forestry, and schools of veterinary medicine to fund research and extension activities. The amount of funds provided to each institution is determined by a formula, which is often statutorily defined. Capacity grants were formerly called Formula Grants, and they are announced through a Request for Proposal (RFP).

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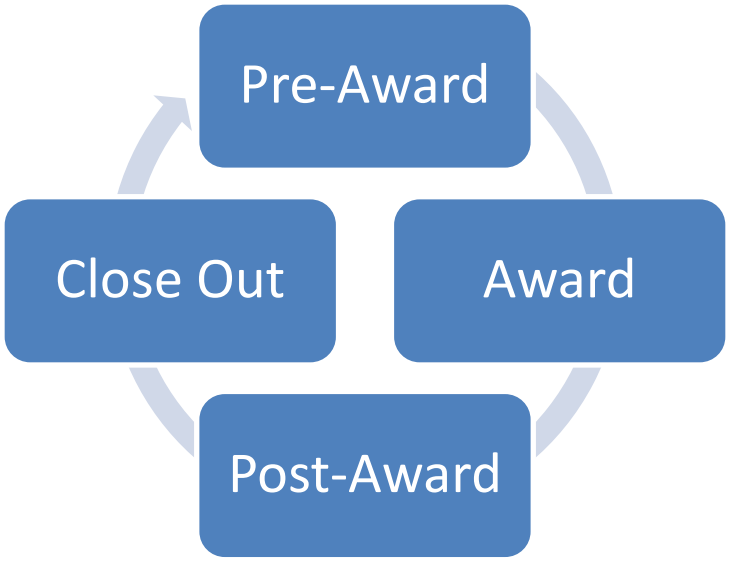
I.400 The NIFA Grants Process

NIFA has a four-stage grant process that applies to grants and cooperative agreements administered by the agency.

Before applying to a funding opportunity with NIFA, it's important to familiarize yourself with the grant and pre-award process.

The stages of the grant process are:
1. Pre-Award
2. Award
3. Post-Award
4. Close Out



This Grant Application guide covers the initial "Pre-Award" Phase of NIFA's grant process. Successful applicants will work closely with NIFA program staff to navigate the Award, Post-Award, and Close Out Processes.

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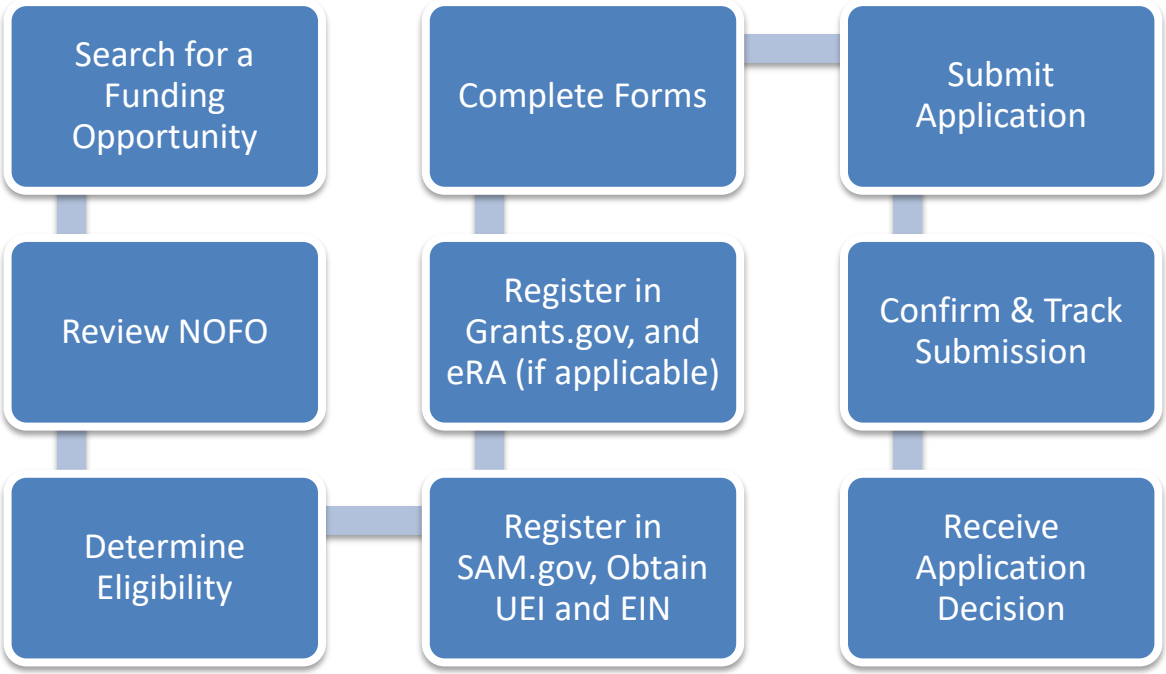
NIFA program staff are key resources for questions related to funding opportunities that may arise during the pre-award application process. Information on how to contact the NIFA program staff responsible for a given funding opportunity can be found in the NOFO or RFP for that opportunity.

The Pre-Award Phase consists of the following steps:

- III.100: Search for a Funding Opportunity
- III.200: Review NOFO or RFP
- III.300: Determine Eligibility
- III.400: Register in SAM.gov, Obtain UEI and EIN
- III.500: Register in Grants.gov
- III.600: Register in eRA Commons
- IV.100: Complete Forms
- IV.300: Submit Application
- VI.100: Confirm and Track Submission
- VI.300: Receive Application Decision



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I.500 Top Tips for Grant Applicants

- Refer to the NOFO or RFP for your funding opportunity to find the most critical information needed to prepare your application. These documents provide application deadlines, a list of required forms, attachment formatting requirements, and contact information for NIFA program staff.

- Allow enough time to complete all required steps before the close of the application deadline. Some steps, like registering your organization on SAM.gov, can take 4-6 weeks to complete.

- Questions about applicant eligibility or the specific funding program that you are interested in should be directed to the NIFA program staff listed in the NOFO or RFP.

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II. Helpful Links & Contact Information

NIFA and Grants.gov provide a variety of resources to assist grant applicants. Please review the resources below or contact NIFA with any questions that may arise during the grant application process.

NIFA Resources

- Search for Funding Opportunities
- General Grant Writing Tips for NIFA Competitive Grant Proposals

Grants.gov Resources

- How to Apply for Grants
- How to Register on Grants.gov
- How to use Grants.gov Workspace
- Grants.gov FAQs
- Grants.gov Help

eRA Resources

- NIFA's eRA Reference Center
- Registering your organization in eRA
- Understanding eRA Commons Accounts
- How to Apply: eRA Application Guide

Contact Information

- Questions about Grants.gov or Workspace:
  Grants.gov Help: Support@Grants.gov
- General questions about the NIFA grant application process:
  GrantApplicationQuestions@usda.gov
- Questions about SBIR/STTR:
  SBIR/STTR Program and Staff Contact Information

NOFOs and RFPs will contain contact information of NIFA program staff working on a particular funding opportunity. All specific questions regarding that funding opportunity should be directed to NIFA program staff.

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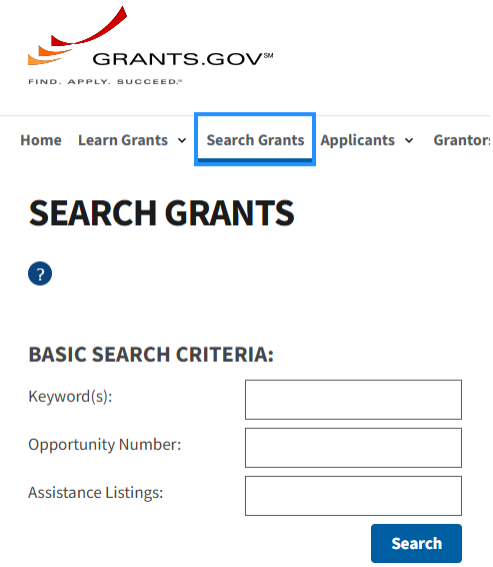
III. Prepare to Apply

The Pre-application process consists of several steps. It's critical for applicants to understand this process and to be aware of the time that it will take to complete each step.

III.100 Step 1: Search for a Funding Opportunity

Applicants can locate competitive funding opportunities and NOFOs through Grants.gov. Grants.gov lists opportunities from many different federal agencies, including NIFA.

In Grants.gov, you can search for competitive funding opportunities by navigating to the "Search Grants" tab of the website.



On this page, applicants can search by keyword, Funding Opportunity (FO) number or Catalog of Assistance Listing (AL) number. Search results can be filtered by Opportunity Status, Funding Instrument type, Eligibility, Category, and Agency.

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You can find current NIFA funding opportunities by filtering results by Agency ("NIFA") and Opportunity Status. Choose Opportunity Status "Posted" to view Current Opportunities and the status "Forecast" to view anticipated funding opportunities.

This Grants.gov search for NIFA funding opportunities will provide search results that include the following information:

- Opportunity Number
- Opportunity Title
- Agency: USDA-NIFA
- Opportunity Status
- Posted Date
- Close Date

Search Tips Export Detailed Data

SORT BY: Posted Date (Descending) Update Sort

DATE RANGE: All Available Update Date Range

1 2 3 4 5 6 ... NEXT ›

Opportunity Number	Opportunity Title	Agency	Opportunity Status	Posted Date	Close Date
USDA-NIFA-RTP-002694	New Era Rural Technology Competitive Grants Program	USDA-NIFA	Archived	11/13/2009	04/14/2010
USDA-NIFA-SLBCD-003405	State and Regional AgrAbility Program	USDA-NIFA	Archived	01/11/2011	03/10/2011
USDA-NIFA-OP-003260	Critical Issues: Emerging and New Plant and Animal Diseases	USDA-NIFA	Archived	07/14/2010	08/16/2010

After selecting a given opportunity, the user will be taken to the "View Opportunity Page" which will provide a synopsis of the FO.

On the "View Opportunity Page" for the selected FO, you can find tabs for:

- Synopsis: Provides basic information on the FO, including posting and closing dates, award ranges, basic eligibility information and a description of the finding program.
- Version History: Displays modifications or previous versions of the FO, if applicable.
- Related Documents: Provides a link to download a PDF copy of the NOFO.
- Package: Provides a link to apply.

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Applicants can also search for FOs through NIFA's Funding Opportunity Search. On the NIFA website, you can search by keyword, FO number or AL number.

Funding opportunity listings available through NIFA's search function will contain the same information as is contained in the Grants.gov Funding Opportunity search.

III.200 Step 2: Review your NOFO or RFP

The NOFO or RFP will provide detailed instructions on preparing and submitting your application. NOFOs can be downloaded in the "Related Documents" tab of the Grants.gov funding opportunity page, or through NIFA's grant opportunity page by clicking the "View NOFO" button.

Each NOFO or RFP may contain:

- All forms required for a complete application
- A detailed funding opportunity description
- Award information and eligibility criteria
- Application and submission guidance
- Application review requirements
- Evaluation criteria
- Award administration
- Any other information relevant to the funding opportunity.
- Application deadline
- Contact information for NIFA Program Staff

Questions regarding information provided in the NOFO or RFP should be directed to NIFA program staff.

Program staff contact information can be found in the Agency Contact section of FO announcement.

Note: NOFO/RFP instructions always supersede application instructions in this guide.

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III.300 Step 3: Determine Eligibility

To determine eligibility for a competitive funding opportunity, interested applicants should carefully review the NOFO. NIFA NOFOs contain a comprehensive "Eligibility" section located in Part III, Section A.

Failure to meet the eligibility criteria listed in the NOFO by the application deadline may result in exclusion from consideration or may preclude NIFA from making an award.

Any questions related to eligibility for a funding opportunity should be directed to NIFA program staff. Program staff contact information can be found in the Appendix I: Agency Contact section of the NOFO and on the FO Page on NIFA's website.

All questions regarding eligibility status should be directed to NIFA program staff.

III.400 Step 4: Register in SAM.gov, Obtain UEI and EIN

Before applying to a NIFA funding opportunity, applicants must:

1. Register in SAM.gov
2. Obtain their Unique Entity Identifier (UEI)
3. Obtain their EIN

Register in SAM.gov.

The System for Award Management (SAM.gov) is an official website of the U.S. Government operated by the General Services Agency (GSA). There is no cost to use or register in SAM.gov. You can use this site to update, renew, or check the status of your entity's registration. You can also find AL numbers through SAM.gov's search for grant opportunity listings function.

Important: Allow 4-6 weeks to complete SAM.gov registration.
Confirm deadlines to ensure that your application can be submitted on time.

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Obtain UEI (Unique Entity Identifier) number.

After your entity is successfully registered with SAM.gov, your UEI will be automatically generated and viewable in SAM.gov's workspace.

Obtain EIN (Entity Identification Number).

Applicants should go to IRS.gov to view or apply for their EIN.

III.500 Step 5: Register in Grants.gov

Follow the instructions on Registering in Grants.gov and creating an institutional profile.

Applicants are required to use Login.gov to sign into Grants.gov. See the Grants.gov help article for more information on logging in with Login.gov credentials.

The Grants.gov validation process also includes a check for an active SAM.gov registration. Applicants without a current SAM.gov registration will be rejected.

Grants.gov User Roles

Grants.gov uses "roles" to determine which tasks each user in your organization is authorized to perform. At the time of organization's registration, your organization designates one or more people with the authority to legally bind your organization in matters related to grants administration.

Some designated individuals (E-Business Points of Contact in Grants.gov) can assign roles to other user accounts to define the functions they are authorized to perform.

- E-Business Point of Contact (EBiz POC)
  The EBiz POC role is designated during organizational registration with System for Award Management (SAM.gov).

  The EBiz POC is responsible for managing grant activities for your organization, and they can authorize representatives of your organization to perform specific tasks in Grants.gov. For example, they may assign the Authorized Organizational Representative (AOR) role to users authorized to submit applications.

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- Authorized Organization Representative (AOR)

  The AOR is the Grants.gov user who has been given the AOR role by the EBiz POC. This enables them to legally bind your institution and assume responsibility for adhering to all federal grant administration requirements.

  The AOR signs and submits grant applications and required certifications and assurances for your application.

  The EBiz POC at your organization must respond to the registration email from Grants.gov and login at Grants.gov to authorize a user as an AOR. More than one person can be designated as AOR for your organization.

- Custom Roles
  Your EBiz POC can also choose to assign users in your organization with custom roles. These users will have varying permissions to complete forms and work on grant applications for your organization.

For additional information on Grants.gov roles, visit Grants.gov's Roles and Privileges resource page.

III.600 Step 6: Register in eRA Commons

Some NIFA funding opportunities are managed through the eRA Commons grants management system.

Applicants responding to NOFOs or RFPs from programs that have transitioned to eRA Commons must be registered with this system prior to application submission. The NOFO or RFP will outline whether registration in eRA Commons is required.

Organizations must designate at least one Signing Official (SO) and one Project Director (PD) in eRA Commons when submitting an application.

Important Note: Creating an eRA Commons account can take up to two weeks.

For additional information, refer to NIFA's eRA Reference Center and eRA Commons Applicant Resources.

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IV. Develop your Application

Many NIFA grants are submitted through Grants.gov using the Workspace application. Workspace is used to complete forms, assemble, and submit your grant application package.

The Grants.gov Workspace exists to make applying for a federal grant as convenient as possible. By leveraging a range of user roles and access levels, applicants can control access to forms, create a custom workflow and save time in completing their application.

For more information about Grants.gov Workspace, visit the following Workspace resources:

- Grants.gov Workspace Overview
- Article: What Is Workspace?
- Grants.gov Online User Guide

You must have a version of Adobe Reader that is compatible with Grants.gov to access, complete and submit NIFA grant applications in Workspace.

Grants.gov provides an Adobe Software Compatibility Checker that can determine if you have an acceptable version of Adobe Reader.

Please note, using Internet Explorer as your browser can also cause errors when working on forms in Grants.gov. If you experience issues, access Grants.gov using another browser or contact Grants.gov support for guidance.

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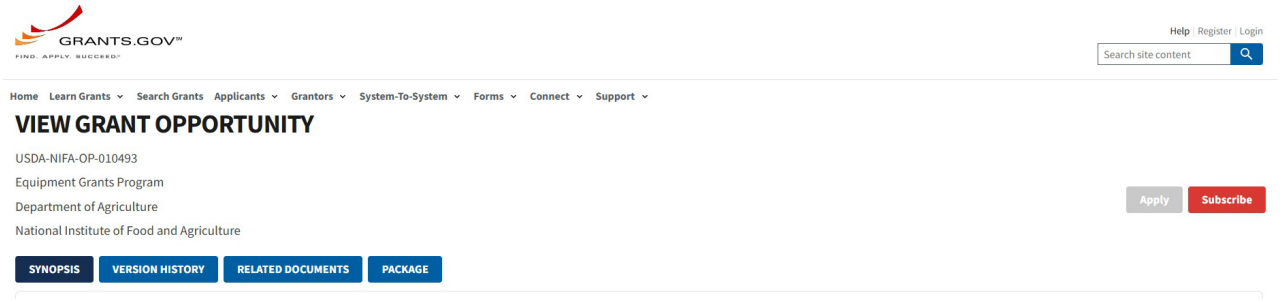
IV.100 Step 1: Start your Application in Workspace

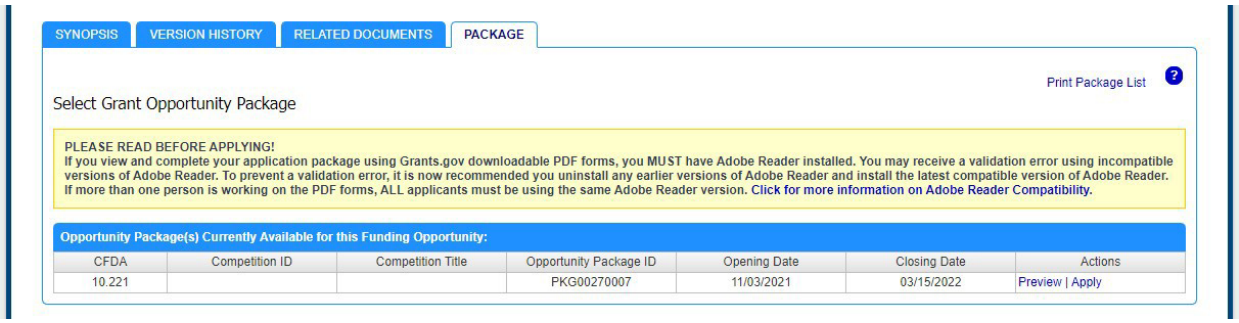
Log in to your Grants.gov account.

After selecting a funding opportunity, open the “View Grant Opportunity” page on Grants.gov. On the “View Grant Opportunity” page, a “Subscribe” button and an “Apply” button will be available.



- Subscribe: Allows you to subscribe to receive any notices (e.g., modifications) sent regarding the funding opportunity.
- Apply: Brings you to the Workspace application to begin preparing an application.

To start your application in Workspace, click the “Apply” button or go to the “Package” tab on the View Grant Opportunity page and select the “Apply” action under the available opportunity package.



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Note: If the apply button in Grants.gov is greyed out or otherwise unavailable for selection while you are logged in to Grants.gov, please contact the Grants.gov Helpdesk. This issue may be due to an application error or because you are not designated as an AOR.

IV.200 Step 2: Complete an Application with Workspace

To assemble an application, you will need to complete all the required forms and attach all the required elements outlined in the NOFO or RFP. Workspace allows grant applicants to complete required forms through the application's Webforms function or by downloading, filling out and uploading PDFs.

Review the Grants.gov Applicant Overview: Applying in Workspace resource for instructions on completing online forms and submitting your application using Workspace.

When opening your FO in Workspace, verify the required information corresponds to the grant to which you are applying. Grants.gov should auto-populate the following information:

- Opportunity Package ID
- Assistance Listing (AL) Number
- AL Description
- Competition ID: NIFA does not use this field. Leave this field blank.
- Opportunity Open Date
- Opportunity Close Date

If these elements are correct, click the button to "Create Workspace."

Note: You will only be able to create and manage a Workspace if you are designated as an Authorized Representative for your organization.

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Preparing Grant Application Attachments

All attachments to your grant application must comply with the formatting requirements in this section and must be in .pdf (portable document format).

Note that NIFA NOFOs and RFPs may include other specific formatting requirements. In these instances, it's critical to follow the guidelines listed in the funding opportunity announcement. NOFO/RFP instructions for your grant opportunity always supersede the instructions in this guide. NIFA may exclude applications that are not consistent with NOFO/RFP instructions from consideration.

Required formatting of contents

- Attachments must be created as a typed or word-processed document.
- Use font no smaller than 12 point, regardless of line spacing.
- Use at least 1-inch margins.
- Number each page of an attachment sequentially.
- The NOFO will indicate if a page limitation applies.

PDF File Format

- NIFA requires that attachments be in .pdf file format to preserve the layout and appearance of submitted documents.

File Name Restrictions

- File names of .pdf attachments must be limited to 50 characters.
- Names may not include special characters (e.g., &, –, *, %, /, #), periods (.), blank spaces or accent marks.
- An underscore (example: Attached_File.pdf) may be used to separate a filename.
- File names must be unique. No other attachment in the application package may have the same file name.

File Protections

- The .pdf attachment must not be password protected.
  Lead institutions of multi-organization applications must ensure that documents from collaborators are not password protected.

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Attach PDF files to your application

- There is a paper clip icon on the left side of the page in every application. Do not attach documents with this function. If you attach documents under this function your application will be incomplete and cause errors.
- Do not combine and attach multiple PDF files in PDF portfolio format. This can cause errors.

NOFO/RFP instructions supersede these instructions. Applications with attachments that are not compliant with relevant formatting requirements may be excluded from consideration.

IV.300 Step 3: Submit a Workspace Package

When all the required forms and attachments for your funding opportunity are complete, you can check your application for errors and submit the application package through Workspace.

You should satisfy the following conditions for an application to be considered.

Meet the Deadline

A date and time stamp will be attached to the application when you click on the Submit button to electronically send the application to Grants.gov. This date and time stamp determine whether the application was received before the deadline identified in the NOFO or RFP. An application submitted or resubmitted after the deadline is late.

For an application with a deadline of 5pm EST, the application is considered on time if it is submitted at 5:00.59 pm EST. It would be considered late at 5:01 pm EST.

Note: Consideration of late applications is only given in extenuating circumstances with proper documentation of the issue and approval from NIFA program staff. Extenuating circumstances can include natural disasters or a confirmed Grants.gov outage. Remember to check the NOFO or RFP carefully for NIFA program staff contact information.

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Extenuating circumstances do not automatically ensure that a late application will be accepted.

For more information on this topic, see NIFA's Resource on Late Application Consideration or contact NIFA program staff with specific questions.

Successful Grants.gov Validation

The Grants.gov system performs a limited check of the application, and Grants.gov will notify you of the outcome of the initial review. The registration process includes obtaining your Unique Entity Identifier (UEI) and checking System for Awards Management (SAM.gov) registration status.

Grants.gov sends applications that are successfully validated to NIFA for further processing. Applications that fail Grants.gov validation may be resubmitted to Grants.gov if NIFA's deadline has not passed.

Grants.gov may allow applications to be submitted after the deadline, but these applications can still be considered late by NIFA.

Successful Agency Validation

NIFA staff will perform a precursory review of your application. The agency validation process includes ensuring that you have met eligibility requirements and have followed NIFA application guidelines.

This check will also review the formatting of your application, confirm that page limits (if applicable) are met, and that budget requests do not exceed the stated limits from the funding opportunity's NOFO.

NIFA will notify you of the outcome of this review.

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V. Detailed Form Instructions

This section contains detailed explanations of how to complete required forms for NIFA grant submissions.

Each NOFO or RFP will require different forms. Check your selected funding opportunity announcement to determine which forms you will need to complete for a successful grant submission. See below for the major form categories.

Category 1: Research and Related (R&R) Forms
The following SF-424 (R&R) forms may be required as part of the application package. Check the NOFO or RFP to determine which forms will be required for your application.

- V.100 SF-424 (R&R): Application for Federal Assistance
- V.110 Project/ Performance Site Locations
- V.120 R&R Other Project Information
- V.130 R&R Senior/Key Person Profile (Expanded)
- V.140 R&R Personal Data: Senior/Key Person Profile
- V.150 R&R Budget
- V.160 SF-424C: Budget information for Construction Programs
- V.170 R&R Subaward Fed/Non-Fed Budget Attachments Form

Category 2: Cross Agency Forms
The following forms are used by other federal agencies when awarding a grant and may be mandatory depending on the grant. Please refer to the NOFO or RFP to determine what forms will be required for your submission.

- V.200 AFRI Project Type Form
- V.210 SBIR/STTR
- V.220 Key Contacts

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Category 3: NIFA Specific Forms & Documents
You may be required to submit NIFA-specific forms and documents as part of your grant application package. See the instructions below to complete these NIFA-specific items.

- V.300 NIFA Supplemental Information Form
- V.310 Attachments Form
- V.320 Data Management Plan

V.100 SF-424 (R&R) Application for Federal Assistance

The SF-424 (R&R) collects basic information including type of submission, applicant information, type of applicant, and proposed project dates. This form is required for all grant applications.

Conformance with SF-424 instructions is required and will be strictly enforced unless a deviation has been approved. NIFA may exclude from consideration applications that are not consistent with these instructions.

This form, along with other R&R forms, can be found in Grants.gov under R&R Family of forms listing. Instructions are available on Grants.gov to supplement the instructions in this document.

Field 1: Type of Submission

Type of Submission Options:

- Pre-Application
  Only submit a pre-application if specifically required by a NIFA NOFO or RFP.
- Application
  An "Application" is a request for financial support of a project or activity submitted on specified forms and in accordance with NIFA instructions.

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- Change/Corrected Application
  Check this box if you are correcting either system validation errors or application assembly problems that occurred during the submission process. Unless requested by the agency, applicants may not use this to submit changes after the closing date.

Note for Changed/Corrected Applications**:**
You should submit a changed/corrected application only after the appropriate NIFA program staff has been contacted, and your request to change/correct your prior application has been approved.

If you are submitting a changed/corrected application, click the Changed/Corrected Application box and enter the Grants.gov tracking number in the Federal Identifier field.

If this submission is to change or correct a “resubmission”, “renewal”, “continuation”, or “revision” application, leave the Federal identifier field as previously filled with the existing identifier (e.g., Award number). Do not insert the Grants.gov tracking number in these cases.

Field 2: Date Submitted and Applicant Identifier

Date Submitted: Enter the date the application is submitted to NIFA. Use mm/dd/yyyy format. E.g.: 06/15/2023.

Applicant Identifier: Fill in the “Applicant Identifier” field, if applicable. This field is not required.

The Applicant Identifier is reserved for applicant use, not the federal agency to which the application is being submitted.

Field 3: Date Received by State and State Application Identifier

NIFA does not use this information. Leave these fields blank.

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Field 4: Federal Identifiers

Federal Identifier Options:

- New Applications without Pre-application: Leave this field blank.
- New Applications following Pre-application: Enter the agency-assigned pre-application number.
- Resubmission, Renewal, and Revision Applications: The Federal Identifier is required. Include only the IC and serial number of the previously assigned application/award number (e.g., use CA987654 from 1R01CA987654-01A1).

Additional Instructions for SBIR/STTR: When submitting a Phase II application, enter the Phase I SBIR/STTR grant number in this field. For more information on applying for SBIR/STTR Phase I or Phase II awards, see NIFA's SBIR/STTR Program Page.

- Agency Routing Identifier: NIFA does not use the Agency Routing Identifier field; it may be left blank.
- Previous Grants.gov tracking ID: The "Previous Grants.gov Tracking ID" field is required only if you checked the "Changed/Corrected Application" box in "Field 1. Type of Submission." A Tracking ID number is of the form, for example, GRANT12345678.

Field 5: Applicant Information

Section 1: Applicant Organization

- UEI: Enter the UEI number of the applicant organization. This field is required.
- Legal Name: Enter the legal name of the applicant organization or individual in whose name an award, if awarded, should be made.
- Department: Enter the name of the primary organizational department, service, laboratory, or equivalent level within the organization.

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- Division: Enter the name of primary organizational department, service, laboratory, or equivalent level within the organization which will undertake the assistance activity.
- Address: Provide street, city, county/parish, state or province for the applicant organization.
- Zip/Postal Code: The ZIP+4 is required if the applicant organization is located in the United States. Otherwise, the Zip code is optional. Enter the ZIP+4 (nine-digit postal code) or postal code of the applicant organization. If you do not know your ZIP+4, look it up on the USPS Look Up Zip Code website.

Section 2: Person to be contacted on matters involving this application

This section of the field is for the administrative contact (e.g., AOR or business official), not the PD/PI. This person is the individual to be notified if additional information is needed and/or if an award is made.

- Contact Person Name: First Name and Last Name of Contact Person. Prefix, Middle Name and Suffix, if applicable.
- Position/Title: Enter position/title of contact person.
- Address: Provide street, city, county/parish, state or province for contact person.
- Phone: Enter best phone number for contact person.
- Fax: Enter Fax number of contact person.
- Email: Enter the email address for the person to contact on matters related to the application.

Field 6: Employer Identification (EIN) or (TIN)

Enter either TIN or EIN as assigned by the Internal Revenue Service. If your organization is not in the U.S., type 44-4444444. This field is required. If you do not have an EIN, you can create one on IRS.gov.

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Field 7: Type of Applicant

Type of Applicant: Select the appropriate applicant type code. This field is required.

If "Small Business" is selected as Type of Applicant, then identify whether the organization is Woman-owned and/or Socially and Economically Disadvantaged.

- Woman Owned: Check if you are a woman-owned small business. This is a small business that is at least 51% owned by a woman or women, who also control and operate it.
- Socially and Economically Disadvantaged: Check if you are a socially and economically disadvantaged small business as determined by the U.S. Small Business Administration pursuant to section 8(a) of the Small Business Act, U.S.C. 637(a).

Field 8: Type of Application

The type of application accepted may vary by funding opportunity. Part II, B of the NOFO will stipulate the type of application that you may submit in response to the funding opportunity.

Select the type from the following list. Check only one.

- New: An application that is being submitted to an agency for the first time.
- Resubmission: An application that has been previously submitted, but not funded, and is being resubmitted for new consideration.
  If you are submitting a resubmission application, enter the NIFA-assigned proposal number of the previously submitted application in the Federal field (Field 4 on the form).
  If you are submitting a resubmission renewal application, select "resubmission" and enter the NIFA-assigned proposal number of the previously submitted application in the Federal field (Field 4 on the form).
- Renewal: An application requesting additional funding for a period subsequent to that provided by a current award. A renewal application competes with all other

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applications and must be developed as fully as though the applicant is applying for the first time.
If you are submitting a renewal application, enter the NIFA-assigned award number of the previously funded application in the Federal field (Field 4 on the form).

- Continuation**:** A non-competing application for an additional funding/budget period within a previously approved project period. Only used for specific NOFOs.
  If submitting a continuation application, enter the NIFA-assigned award number of the previously funded application in the Federal field (Field 4 on the form).
- Revision: An application that proposes a change in – 1) the Federal Government's financial obligations or contingent liability from an existing obligation; or, 2) any other change in the terms and conditions of the existing award.

  If Revision mark appropriate box(es): May select more than one

  A. Increase Award
  B. Decrease Award
  C. Increase Duration
  D. Decrease Duration
  E. Other (specify). If "Other" is selected, please specify in text box provided.

- Is this application being submitted to other agencies?
  Enter yes or no. This field is required. If yes, enter Agency name.

- What other agencies?
  List the names or acronyms of all other public or private sponsors including other agencies within USDA to which your application has been or might be sent. In the event you decide to send your application to another organization or agency at a later date, you must inform the identified NIFA Program Contact as soon as practicable. Submitting your application to other potential sponsors will not prejudice its review by NIFA; however, submitting the same application to another NIFA program is not permissible.

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Field 9: Name of Federal Agency

This field is pre-populated from the opportunity package and reflects the agency (NIFA) from which assistance is being requested with this application.

Field 10: Assistance Listing Number and Title

This field is pre-populated from the opportunity package and reflects the Assistance Listing (AL) number of the program under which assistance is requested.

This field may be blank if you are applying to an opportunity that references multiple AL numbers. When this field is blank, leave it blank. The appropriate AL number will be automatically assigned by the agency.

Field 11: Descriptive Title of Applicant's Project

The title should be a brief, clear, and specific designation of the proposed project.

Project titles are read by a variety of nonscientific people; therefore, you should avoid highly technical words or phraseology where possible. In addition, you should not use introductory phrases such as "investigation of," "research on," "education for," or "outreach that."

Field 12: Proposed Project

Start Date: Enter the proposed start date of the project. This field is required. Please use mm/dd/yyyy format. E.g., 08/13/2023.

Ending Date: Enter the proposed end date of the project. This field is required. Please use mm/dd/yyyy format. E.g., 08/13/2023.

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Field 13: Enter Congressional District of Applicant

Enter the applicant's Congressional District. Enter the Congressional District in the format: 2-character state abbreviation, a hyphen, and a 3-character district number. Examples: CA-005 for California's 5th district, CA-012 for California's 12th district. This field is required.

If outside the US, enter 00-000.

For States and U.S. Territories with only a single congressional district, enter “001” for the district number.

For jurisdictions with no representative, enter “099.”

For jurisdictions with a nonvoting delegate, enter “098” for the district number. Example: DC-098 or PR-098.

If you do not know your Congressional District: Go to the United States House of Representatives website and search for your Congressional District by entering your ZIP+4. If you do not know your ZIP+4, look it up on the USPS Look Up Zip Code website.

Field 14: Project Director/Principal Investigator Contact Information

This information is for the PD/PI. The PD/PI is the individual responsible for the overall scientific and technical direction of the project.

The PD/PI is the single individual designated by the awardee in the application and approved by the Authorized Departmental Officer who is responsible for the direction and management of the project. To facilitate communication with NIFA, the person designated in Field 14 will be considered the contact PD/PI. The contact PD/PI will be responsible for relaying communications between all the PD/PIs and NIFA (other PD/PIs are identified on the R&R Senior/Key Person Profile).

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- Contact Person Name: First Name and Last Name of Contact Person. Prefix, Middle Name and Suffix, if applicable.
- Position/Title: Enter position/title.
- Organization name: Enter the name of the organization for the PD/PI.
- Department: Enter department name.
- Division: Enter the name of the primary organizational division, office, or major subdivision of the PD/PI.
- Address: Provide street, city, county/parish, state, or province for PD/PI.
- Phone: Enter best phone number for PD/PI.
- Fax: Enter Fax number of PD/PI.
- Email: Enter the email address for the PD/PI.

Field 15: Estimated Project Funding

All four fields in "15. Estimated Project Funding" are required.

- Total Federal Funds Requested: Enter the total federal funds, including Direct Costs and F&A Costs (Indirect Costs), requested for the entire project period.
- Total Non-Federal Funds: Enter total non-Federal funds requested for the entire project period.
- Total Federal & Non-Federal Funds: Enter total estimated funds for the entire project period, including both Federal and non-Federal funds.
- Estimated Program Income: Identify any Program Income estimated for this project period, if applicable.

Field 16: Is the Application Subject to Review by State Executive Order 12372 Process?

If yes, check box and provide review date. If the announcement indicates that the program is covered under Executive Order 12372, applicants should contact the State Single Point of Contact (SPOC) for Federal Executive Order 12372. One selection is required.

If no, check "NO, program is not covered by E.O. 12372," OR "Program has not been selected by

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State for review". NIFA programs are excluded from the scope of the Executive Order 12372 which requires intergovernmental consultation with state and local officials (see the final Rule-related Notice to 7 CFR Part 3015, Subpart V (48 FR 29114, June 24, 1983)).

Field 17: Complete Certification

Check to provide the required certifications and assurances. This field is required.

The applicable certifications and representations can be located on the NIFA website. See NIFA's Certifications and Representations resource page before signing the application.

Field 18: Enter SFLLL (Disclosure of Lobbying Activities) or Other Explanatory Documentations

If applicable, attach the SFLLL or other explanatory document per NOFO instructions. If you are unable to certify compliance with the Certification in the "17. Certification" section above, attach an explanation. Additionally, as applicable, attach the Standard Form LLL, Disclosure of Lobbying Activities (SFLLL) or other documents in this item.

Field 19: Authorized Representative

The authorized representative is equivalent to the individual with the organizational authority to sign for an application.

This individual is otherwise known as the authorized organization representative (AOR) in Grants.gov.

- Contact Person Name: First Name and Last Name of Contact Person. Prefix, Middle Name and Suffix, if applicable.
- Position/Title: Enter position/title.
- Organization name: Enter the name of the organization for the AOR.
- Department: Enter department name.
- Division: Enter the name of the primary organizational division, office or major subdivision of the AOR.

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- Address: Provide street, city, county/parish, state or province for AOR.
- Phone: Enter best phone number.
- Fax: Enter fax number.
- Email: Enter the email address.

Signature of Authorized Representative: It is the organization's responsibility to ensure that only properly authorized individuals submit the application to Grants.gov. This field is completed on submission to Grants.gov.

Date Signed: Grants.gov will generate this date upon application submission.

Field 20: Pre-Application

If submitting a pre-application, provide a summary description of the project in accordance with the announcement and/or agency-specific instructions and attach here.

Rarely, a funding opportunity will require or request submission of a preliminary application in advance of a full application. The two predominant reasons for requiring a preliminary application are to:

- Reduce the unnecessary effort in application preparation when the chance of success is very small. This is particularly true of exploratory initiatives where the community senses that a major new direction is being identified, or competitions that will result in a small number of actual awards.
- Increase the overall quality of the full submission.

The NOFO will specify content and submission requirements when preliminary applications are to be used. Note that a pre-application is not the same as a Letter of Intent which NIFA, in some cases, may require. The NOFO will state when you need to submit a pre-application or a Letter of Intent.

Field 21: Cover Letter Attachment

This optional field allows the applicant to enter a cover letter with the application.

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V.110 R&R Project/Performance Site Location(s)

This form is used for all grant applications. It is used to report the primary location of the project and include information on any other locations at which the project will be performed.

In this form you will provide the actual street address of the Project/ Performance Site(s). Do not provide PO Box, stations or building names unless included in the street address.

Checkbox: I am submitting an application as an individual, and not on behalf of a company, state, local or tribal government, academia, or other type of organization

Select only if submitting an application as an individual and not on behalf of or representing any organization. (This field is not applicable for applicants using SF-424 Individual Form Set).

Organization Name

This field is required. Enter the organization name of the primary site where the work will be performed.

UEI Number

This field is required for the primary performance site. Enter the UEI number associated with the organization where the project will be performed.

Project Site Address

Enter Street 1, City, County, State, Country and Zip Code for the Project/ Performance site.
All of these are required fields.

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Project/ Performance Site Congressional District

Enter the applicant's Congressional District. Enter the Congressional District in the format: 2-character state abbreviation, a hyphen, and a 3-character district number. Examples: CA-005 for California's 5th district, CA-012 for California's 12th district. This field is required.

If all districts in a state are affected, enter “all” for the district number. Example: MD-all for all congressional districts in Maryland.

If nationwide (all districts in all states) enter US-all.

If the program/project is outside the US, enter 00-000.

If you do not know your Congressional District: Go to the United States House of Representatives website and search for your Congressional District by entering your ZIP+4. If you do not know your ZIP+4, look it up on the USPS Look Up Zip Code website.

Project/Performance Site Location 1

Use this “Project/Performance Site Location 1” block to provide information on performance sites in addition to the Primary Performance Site listed above, if applicable. Include any VA facilities and foreign sites.

Enter for the Project/Performance Site Location 1 the information required for the Project/Performance Site Primary Location. If it is necessary to enter information for additional sites, click on the “Next Site” button.

Additional Locations

File attachments may be added to this field for additional location(s), if any.

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V.120 R&R Other Project Information

This form is used for all grant applications, and it includes questions on the use of human subjects, vertebrate animals, and environmental impact. This form also has fields to upload an abstract, project narrative, references, information on facilities, and equipment lists.

Field 1: Are Human Subjects Involved?

If activities involving human subjects are planned at any time during the proposed project at any performance site, check yes. Check yes, even if the proposed project is exempt from Regulations for the Protection of Human Subjects. If no, skip the rest of block 1. This field is required.

Projects that involve research with human subjects must ensure that subjects are protected from research risks in conformance with the relevant federal policy known as the Common Rule (Federal Policy for the Protection of Human Subjects, 45 CFR 690).

All projects that involve human subjects must either: (1) have approval from the organization's Institutional Review Board (IRB) before issuance of a NIFA award or, (2) must affirm that the IRB or an appropriate knowledgeable authority previously designated by the organization (not the PD) has declared the research exempt from IRB review in accordance with the applicable subsection, as established in section 101(b) of the Common Rule.

The box for "Human Subjects" must be checked "yes" with the IRB approval date (if available) or exemption subsection from the Common Rule identified in the space provided.

Check “yes” even if the proposed project is exempt from Regulations for the Protection of Human Subjects.

If “no”, skip the remaining questions about Human Subjects. If “no” is checked at the time of submission and subsequently it is determined that human subjects are necessary, then contact the applicable Program Contact (identified in Field 14. of Form NIFA-2009, Award Face Sheet, of the award document) for instructions on submitting updated human subject information.

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Field 1a: If YES to Human Subjects, is the project exempt from Federal Regulations?

If the project is exempt from federal regulations, check "Yes" and check the appropriate exemption number.

The eight categories of research that qualify for exemption from coverage by the regulations are defined in the Common Rule for the Protection of Human Subjects which USDA implements through 7 CFR part 1c.104. These regulations can be found in the Code of Federal Regulations: § 1c.104 Exempt research.

Human subjects research should only be designated as exempt if all the proposed research projects in an application meet the criteria for exemption.

If the project is not exempt from federal regulations, check "No."
If no, is the IRB review Pending? Select yes or no.

Applicants should check "Yes" to the question "Is the IRB review Pending?" even if the IRB review/approval process has not started by the time of submission.

IRB review is not pending (e.g., if the review is complete), check "No."

IRB Approval Date: If no, enter the latest Institutional Review Board (IRB) approval date (if available). Please use mm/dd/yyyy format (e.g., 08/13/2017). Leave blank if Pending.

Human Subject Assurance Number: Enter the approved Federal Wide Assurance (FWA), Multiple Project Assurance (MPA), Single Project Assurance Number or Cooperative Project Assurance Number that the applicant has on file with the Office for Human Research Protections, if available.

If the applicant has a FWA number, enter the 8-digit number. Do not enter the FWA before the number.

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Field 2: Are Vertebrate Animals Used?

If activities involving vertebrate animals are planned at any time during the proposed project at any performance site, check yes.

The generation of custom antibodies constitutes an activity involving vertebrate animals.

If animal involvement is anticipated within the period of award but plans are indefinite, check "Yes."

For applications that involve the use of vertebrate animals, you must provide sufficient information within the project description to enable reviewers to evaluate the choice of species, number of animals to be used, and any necessary exposure of animals to discomfort, pain, or injury. Consistent with the requirements of the Animal Welfare Act [7 U.S.C. 2131 et seq.] and the regulations promulgated by the Secretary of Agriculture [9 CFR, 1.1- 4.11] NIFA requires that proposed projects involving use of any vertebrate animal for research or education be approved by the submitting organization's Institutional Animal Care and Use Committee (IACUC) before an award can be made.

If no, check no and skip the rest of block 2. This field is required.

Field 2a: If YES to Vertebrate Animals, is the IACUC review pending?

- Is the Institutional Animal Care and Use Committee (IACUC) review pending?

Applicants should check “Yes” to the "Is the IACUC review Pending?" question even if the IACUC review/approval process has not started by the time of submission.

If IACUC review is not pending (e.g., if the review is complete), check “No."

- IACUC Approval Date: Enter the latest Institutional Animal Care and Use Committee (IACUC) approval date (if available). Please use mm/dd/yyyy format (e.g., 08/13/2017). Leave blank if Pending.

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Animal Welfare Assurance Number: Enter the Federally approved assurance number, if available. These fields are required if no is checked to the question “Is the IACUC review pending”.

Field 3: Is proprietary/privileged information included in the application?

Check “Yes” or “No”.

Patentable ideas, trade secrets, privileged or confidential commercial or financial information, the disclosure of which may harm the applicant, should be included in applications only when such information is necessary to convey an understanding of the proposed project. If the application includes such information, check yes and clearly mark each line or paragraph on the pages containing the proprietary/privileged information with a legend similar to - "The following contains proprietary/privileged information that (name of applicant) requests not be released to persons outside the Government, except for purposes of review and evaluation." This field is required.

Such information also may be included as a separate statement. If you use this method, submit the statement as a single-copy document and attach it in Field 12, Other Attachments. While NIFA will make every effort to prevent unauthorized access to such material, we are not responsible or in any way liable for the release of such material.

Field 4a-4d: Does this project have an actual or potential impact on the environment?

Indicates if this project has an actual or potential impact on the environment. Check “Yes” if this is the case. Check “No” if this is not the case. This field is required.

If yes, please explain: Enter an explanation for the actual or potential impact on the environment.

If this project has an actual or potential impact on the environment, has an exemption been authorized or an environmental assessment (EA) or environmental impact statement (EIS) been performed?

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Check “Yes” or “No”. Indicates whether an exemption [has] been authorized or an Environmental Assessment (EA) or Environmental Impact Statement (EIS) [has] been performed.

Important Notice Regarding Upcoming NEPA Changes:

USDA issued an interim final rule revising its NEPA implementing procedures at 7 CFR 1b (RIN 0503-AA86). Under this rule, USDA is rescinding all USDA agency-specific NEPA regulations, but applicants may use any of the categorical exclusions found in 7 CFR 1b.

Once the final rule is published, NIFA will update its NEPA guidance and application instructions to align with the revised Department-wide procedures, including updated categorical exclusions and processes for determining environmental review requirements.

Field 5: Is the research performance site designated, or eligible to be designated, as a historic place?

If yes, check the box and then provide an explanation in the box provided in 5a.

Otherwise, check the No box.

Field 6: Does this project involve activities outside the U.S. or partnership with international collaborators?

Indicate whether this project involves activities outside the United States or partnerships with international collaborators. This field is required. Check Yes or No.

If yes, identify countries. – Enter the countries with which international cooperative activities are involved.

Optional Explanation – Enter an explanation for involvement with outside entities (optional). Your entry is limited to 55 characters.

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Field 7: Attach Project Summary/Abstract

The Project Summary/Abstract is to be attached as a PDF document. To attach a Project Summary/Abstract, click “Add Attachment”.

The Project Summary/Abstract must contain a summary of the proposed activity suitable for dissemination to the public. It should be a self-contained description of the project and should contain a statement of objectives and methods to be employed. It should be informative to other persons working in the same or related fields and be as understandable as possible to a scientifically or technically literate lay reader. This Summary/Abstract must not include any proprietary/confidential information. A concise, informative Project Summary/Abstract is critical for successful applications.

Consult the NOFO for any word or character count restrictions applicable to your Project Summary/Abstract. The NOFO will list all required elements to be included in this document.

Review the NOFO carefully for any special guidance on formatting your Project Summary/Abstract. PDF formatting requirements outlined in the NOFO may differ from the general PDF formatting instructions found in this guide.

Your NOFO may include restrictions on the use of special characters and hard returns (also known as paragraph breaks) in your Project Summary/Abstract. NOFO instructions for your grant opportunity always supersede the instructions in this guide.

Suggested application support templates for the Project Summary/Abstract are available on NIFA's Application Template Resource Page.

Field 8: Attach Project Narrative

Provide Project Narrative in accordance with the announcement and/or agency-specific instructions. To attach a Project Narrative, click “Add Attachment.”

You must prepare the Project Narrative in accordance with the guidelines specified under Part IV, “Content and Form of the Application” in the applicable NOFO.

Field 9: Attach Bibliography & References Cited

Provide a bibliography of any references cited in the Project Narrative. Each reference must

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include the names of all authors (in the same sequence in which they appear in the publication), the article and journal title, book title, volume number, page numbers, and year of publication. Include only bibliographic citations. Proposers should be especially careful to follow scholarly practices in providing citations for source materials relied upon when preparing any section of the application. To attach Bibliography and References Cited, click “Add Attachment”.
Bibliography and References are not part of the Project Narrative page limitation, if any, unless noted otherwise.

Field 10: Attach Facilities & Other Resources

This information is used to assess the capability of the organizational resources available to perform the effort proposed. Identify the facilities to be used (Laboratory, Animal, Computer, Office, Clinical and Other).

If appropriate, indicate their capacities, pertinent capabilities, relative proximity, and extent of availability to the project. Describe only those resources that are directly applicable to the proposed work. Provide any information describing the Other Resources available to the project (e.g., machine shop, electronic shop) and the extent to which they would be available to the project. To attach Facilities and Other Resources, click “Add Attachment”.

Field 11: Attach Equipment

List major items of equipment already available for this project and, if appropriate, identify location and pertinent capabilities. To attach Equipment, click “Add Attachment.”

If you plan to request funds to purchase items of nonexpendable equipment necessary to conduct and successfully complete the proposed project, refer to Field C. of the R&R Budget for information about including those items in the budget.

Field 12: Add Other Attachments

Attach files to provide any other project information not provided above or in accordance with the announcement and/or agency-specific instruction. Multiple files may be attached.

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Include the following items in Other Attachments, as appropriate:

- Cooperation and Institutional Units Involved. Identify each institutional unit contributing to the project and designate the lead institution or institutional unit when submitting a cooperative, multi-institutional or multidisciplinary application.
- Clearly define the programmatic roles, responsibilities, and budget for each institutional partner.
- Appendices to Project Narrative. Appendices to the Project Narrative are allowed if they are directly germane to the proposed project. Do not use the addition of appendices to circumvent the text and/or figures and tables page limitations.
- Collaborative Arrangements. Fully explain and justify formal consulting or collaborative arrangements with others, should such arrangements be necessary.
- Provide a CV or resume for any consultant(s) or collaborator(s) if known at the time of application. In addition, provide evidence (e.g., letter of support) that the identified collaborators involved have agreed to render these services. You must also provide additional information on consultants and collaborators in the budget portion of the application.

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V.130 R&R Senior/Key Person Profile (Expanded)

This form is used for all grant applications and allows the collection of data for all senior/key persons associated with the project. Some information for the PD/PI may be pre-populated from the SF-424 (R&R) form.

USDA requires the use of the Science Experts Network Curriculum Vitae (SciENcv) system to generate Common Forms for the Biographical Sketch and Current and Pending (Other) Support documents. Free-form versions of these documents will not be accepted.

SciENcv produces USDA-compliant Common Forms that must be certified and submitted as PDF attachments with the application.

Field 1: Enter Profile: Project Director/Principal Investigator

Several fields in this form may be pre-populated from SF-424 (R&R) when using Workspace. These include PD/PI name, position, address, and contact information. If these are not pre-populated, provide any missing information in these fields.

- Credential: If you are submitting to an agency (e.g., NIFA) where you have an established personal profile, enter the agency ID. If not, leave blank.
- Project Role: Select one or use “other” if a category is not listed.
- Other Project Role: Complete if “other” was selected for project role.
- Degree Type: Enter the highest academic or professional degree or other credentials (e.g., RN).
- Degree Year: Enter the year the highest degree or credential was obtained.

Field 2: Attach Biographical Sketch

The Project Director/Principal Investigator (PD/PI) and all senior/key personnel must complete a USDA Biographical Sketch using SciENcv.

Prepare the Biographical Sketch following the instructions and format noted below.

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- Access SciENcv: Science Experts Network Curriculum Vitae.
- Log in using eRA Commons or another supported login method.
- Select "+ New Document".
- Choose Document Type: USDA Biographical Sketch.
- Fill in all information requested in the form. Ensure all information is accurate and up-to-date. Clarifying instructions for certain fields are provided within SciENcv.
- Review for accuracy and completeness using the preview function.
- Certify the document within SciENcv, download the certified PDF, then attach the certified PDF to the application.

SciENcv controls the format and content of the Biographical Sketch Common Form. Do not submit custom biosketches or narrative versions. Documents marked Draft will not be accepted.

Delegates may assist in preparing SciENcv documents but may not certify forms or download uncertified PDFs on behalf of the individual.

The Biographical Sketch is a required document.

Field 3: Attach Current and Pending Support

The PD/PI and all senior/key personnel must complete a USDA Current and Pending (Other) Support Form using SciENcv.

Provide a list of all current and pending support for the PD/PI for ongoing projects and pending proposals. This support information is required even if they receive no salary support from the project(s).

Show the total award amount for the entire award period, including indirect costs. Also include the number of person-months per year to be devoted to the project by the senior/key person, regardless of source of support.

The percentage of time committed should not exceed 100% of effort for concurrent projects. NIFA will not fund an application that duplicates or overlaps substantially with an application already funded (or to be funded) by another organization or agency. Disclose all resources including in-kind contributions.

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Prepare the Current and Pending support list(s) following the instructions and format noted below.

- Create a new document in SciENcv.
- Choose Document Type: USDA Current and Pending (Other) Support.
- Record information for active and pending projects (both foreign and domestic), including this proposal. Concurrent submission of a proposal to other organizations will not prejudice its review by NIFA.
- All current efforts to which project director(s) and other senior personnel have committed a portion of their time must be listed, whether salary for the person involved is included in the budgets of the various projects.
- Ensure all required information is complete and current.

Certify the document within SciENcv, download the certified PDF, then attach the certified PDF to the application.

Field 4: Enter Profile – Senior/Key Person 1

Enter data in this "Profile – Senior/Key Person 1" section to provide information on a senior/key person (other than the PD/PI listed above), if applicable.

Select "Next Person" to enter the next senior/key person entry. Complete the same information for additional senior/key persons.

A PD/PI is the individual(s) a research organization designates as having an appropriate level of authority and responsibility for the proper conduct of the project, including the appropriate use of funds and administrative requirements such as the submission of progress reports to the agency. When an organization designates more than one PD/PI, it identifies them as individuals who share the authority and responsibility for leading and directing the project, intellectually and logistically. NIFA does not infer any distinction in scientific stature among multiple PD/PIs. NIFA will consider the PD/PI entered on the SF-424 R&R Cover Sheet as the contact PD/PI.

NIFA will recognize, on any award that is issued as a result of the application, all the PD/PI co-PD/PIs entered on this form (any individual listed as a "co-investigator" is not identified on the award). You must attach "Current and Pending Support" information for each key person identified. Even if no other funding is currently reported as "Active," this application is to be identified as "Pending" in the information submitted.

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V.140 R&R Personal Data: Senior/Key Person Profile

The applicant is asked to submit the requested information for each identified PD/PI and co-PD/PIs with each proposal. Submission of the requested information is voluntary and is not a precondition of award. However, information not submitted will undermine the statistical validity, and the usefulness, of information received from others.

Any individual not wishing to submit some, or all the information should check the box provided for this purpose. Upon receipt of the application, this form will be separated from the application. This form will not be duplicated, and it will not be a part of the review process. Data will be confidential.

V.150 R&R Budget

R&R Budget Forms collect data related to the proposed expenditures for your proposal.

Organizational UEI

This is the UEI number of the applicant organization. For the project applicant, this field is pre-populated from the SF-424 R&R Cover Page. For subaward applicants, this field is a required enterable field.

Name of Organization

Pre-populated from the SF-424 R&R. The organization name.

Budget Type

Project, Subaward/Consortium: Check the appropriate block.

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- Project: The budget requested for the primary applicant organization.
- Subaward/Consortium: The budget requested for sub awardee/consortium organization(s).

Note: Separate budgets are required only for sub awardee/consortium organizations that perform a substantive portion of the project.

If creating Subaward Budget, use the R&R Subaward Budget Attachment and attach as a separate file on the R&R Budget Attachment(s) form.

Budget Period

Pre-populated from the SF-424 R&R. Enter the requested/proposed start date of each budget period. This field is required.

Identifies the specific budget period: e.g., 1, 2, 3, 4, 5. If submitting through Grants.gov, the system will automatically generate a cumulative budget for the total project period.

Section A: Senior/Key Person

This section identifies names of Senior/Key Personnel. Each person identified in the Senior/Key Person profile who is an employee of the applying organization must be listed in this section if funds are requested.

Salaries of the PD/PI(s) and other personnel associated directly with the project should constitute direct costs in proportion to their effort devoted to the project. Charges by academic institutions for work performed by faculty members during the summer months or other periods outside the base salary period are to be at a monthly rate not in excess of that which would be applicable under the base salary and other provisions of the applicable cost principles. All requested salaries must be consistent with the regular institution practices.

You may not use award funds to augment the total salary or rate of salary of project personnel or to reimburse them for consulting or other time in addition to a regular full-time salary covering the same general period of employment.

The Prefix, First Name, Middle Name, Last Name, Suffix, and Project Role fields for the PD/PI will be pre- populated from the SF-424 R&R. For the PD/PI, complete the remaining fields

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following the instructions below.

You should also use the instructions included in this section to complete information for up to seven more Senior/Key Persons.

- Base Salary ($)

Enter the annual compensation paid by the employer for each senior/key personnel. This includes all activities such as research, teaching, patient care, or other. You may choose to leave this column blank.

- Cal. Months

Identify the number of calendar months devoted to the project for each Senior/Key person.

- Acad. Months

Identify the number of academic months devoted to the project for each Senior/Key person.

- Sum. Months

Identify the number of summer months devoted to the project for each Senior/Key person.

- Requested Salary ($)

Regardless of the number of months being devoted to the project, indicate only the amount of salary being requested for this budget period for each senior/key person. This field is required.

- Fringe Benefits ($)

Enter applicable fringe benefits, if any, for each senior/key person. This field is required.

If the grantee's usual accounting practices provide that its contributions to employee benefits (social security, retirement, etc.) are treated as direct costs, NIFA funds may be requested to fund fringe benefits as a direct cost.

- Funds Requested ($)

This field will auto-calculate. This field is required.

- Additional Senior/Key Persons

If funds are requested for more than 8 Senior/Key Persons, include all pertinent budget information, and attach as a file here. Enter the total funds requested for all additional senior/keypersons in line 9 of Section A.

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Your organization may request that salary data on senior personnel not be released to persons outside the federal government during the review process. Such information may be included as a separate statement. If you use this method, you must submit the statement electronically as an attachment in Block 12 of the SF-424 R&R Other Project Information Form. This statement must include all the information requested on the budget for each person involved. NIFA will not forward the detailed information to reviewers and will hold it privileged to the extent permitted by law.

Section B: Other Personnel

- Number of Personnel

For each project role category, identify the number of personnel proposed. This field is required.

- Project Role

List any additional project role(s) in the blank(s) provided, e.g., Engineer, IT Professionals. This field is required.

- Cal. Months

Identify the number of calendar months devoted to the project for each project role category.

- Acad. Months

Identify the number of academic months devoted to the project for each project role category.

- Sum. Months

Identify the number of summer months devoted to the project for each project role category.

- Requested Salary ($)

Regardless of the number of months being devoted to the project, indicate only the amount of salary/wages being requested for each project role. This field is required.

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- Fringe Benefits ($)

Enter the applicable fringe benefits, if any, for this project role category. This field is required.

- Funds Requested ($)

This field will auto-calculate. This field is required.

- Total Number Other Personnel

This total will auto-calculate.

- Total Other Personnel

Total Funds requested for all Other Personnel. The total will auto-calculate.

- Total Salary, Wages and Fringe Benefits (A+B)

Total Funds requested for all Senior Key Persons and all Other Personnel. The total will auto-calculate.

- Enter the number of personnel proposed for each project role category.

In most circumstances, the salaries of administrative or clerical staff at educational institutions and nonprofit organizations are included as part of indirect costs. Clearly describe in the budget justification the circumstances for requiring direct charging of these services.

If appropriate, a zero may be entered in any of the fields that require a dollar amount.

Section C: Enter Equipment Description

- Equipment item

Equipment is defined as an item of property that has an acquisition cost of $5,000 or more (unless the organization has established lower levels) and an expected service life of more than one year. List each item of equipment separately and justify each in the budget justification section.

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Allowable items ordinarily will be limited to research equipment and apparatus not already available for the conduct of the work.

General-purpose equipment, such as a personal computer, is not eligible for support unless primarily or exclusively used in the actual conduct of scientific research. General-purpose equipment requires special justification and prior approval from NIFA's Office of Grants and Financial Management (OGFM). This includes equipment whose use is not limited to research, medical, scientific, educational, or other technical activities; e.g., office equipment and furnishings, air conditioning equipment, reproduction and printing equipment, motor vehicles, and automatic data processing equipment.

- Funds Requested ($)

List the estimated cost of each item of equipment including shipping and any maintenance costs and agreements. This is required information.

- Total funds requested for all equipment listed in the attached file

If this section cannot accommodate all the equipment proposed, attach a file in the block provided. List each additional item and the funds requested. For all additional items in the attached file, list the total funds requested in the appropriate block of this section.

- Total Equipment

Total funds requested for all equipment. The total will auto-calculate.

Section D: Travel

- Domestic Travel Costs (Incl. Canada, Mexico, and U.S. Possessions) Funds Requested ($)

Identify the total funds requested for domestic travel. Domestic travel includes Canada, Mexico and U.S. Possessions. In the budget justification section, include purpose, destination, dates of travel (if known), and number of individuals for each trip. If the dates of travel are not known, specify estimated length of trip (e.g., 3 days).

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- Foreign Travel Costs Funds Requested ($)

Identify the total funds requested for foreign travel. Foreign travel includes any travel outside of North America and/or U.S. Possessions. In the budget justification section, include purpose, destination, dates of travel (if known) and number of individuals for each trip. If the dates of travel are not known, specify estimated length of trip (e.g., 3 days).

Travel and subsistence should be in accordance with organizational policy. Note that 2 CFR Part 200.475 is applicable to air travel.

- Total Travel Costs

Total Funds requested for all travel. This total will auto-calculate.

Section E: Participant/Trainee Support Costs

Participant costs are the costs associated with conference, workshop, or symposium attendees who are not employees of the applicant or a sub awardee. Trainee costs are the costs associated with educational projects that support trainees (pre-college, college, graduate, and post-graduate). List total costs for each budget item and the number of participants/trainees. In the budget justification, identify the purpose of the conference/training, dates, and places and justify costs.

- Tuition/Fees/Health Insurance

List total funds requested for Participant/Trainee Tuition/Fees/Health Insurance.

- Stipends

List total funds requested for Participant/Trainee Stipends.

- Travel

List total funds requested for Participant/Trainee Travel. Travel should be in accordance with organizational policy.

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- Subsistence

List total funds requested for Participant/Trainee Subsistence. Subsistence should be in accordance with organizational policy.

- Other

Describe any other participant trainee funds requested. List total funds requested for any other Participants/Trainee costs described.

- Number of Participants/Trainees

List the total number of proposed participants/trainees.

If you request participant support costs for conferences/meetings, indicate the purpose, dates, and place of the conference/meeting; number of participants; cost for each; speaker fees (include number of persons, number of days, and cost per person); cost of facilities rental; and other related expenses.

- Total Participant/Trainee Support Costs

Total Funds requested for all participant/trainee costs. This total will auto-calculate.

Section F: Other Direct Costs

- Materials and Supplies

List total funds requested for materials and supplies. In the budget justification, indicate general categories such as glassware, chemicals, animal costs, including an amount for each category. Categories less than $1,000 are not required to be itemized.

In general terms, indicate the types of required expendable materials and supplies and their estimated costs.

- Publication Costs

List the total publication funds requested. The proposal budget may request funds for the costs of documenting, preparing, publishing or otherwise making available to others the findings and

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products of the work conducted under the award. In the budget justification, include supporting information.

You may include anticipated costs of preparing and publishing the results of the proposed project, including costs of reports, reprints, page charges or other journal costs, and necessary illustrations.

- Consultant Services

List the total costs for all consultant services. In the budget justification, identify each consultant, the services he/she will perform, total number of days, travel costs, and total estimated costs. Applicants normally are expected to the services of their own staff to the maximum extent possible in managing and performing the activities supported by awards.

If you anticipate the need for consultant services, you must provide in the "Other Attachments" (Field 11 of the SF-424 R&R Other Project Information) a justification for the use of such services, a statement of work to be performed, and a resume or curriculum vitae for each consultant.

The proposal budget should indicate the amount of funds required for this purpose. The budget narrative should list the name(s) of the consultant(s), the name(s) of their organization(s), and a breakdown of the amount being charged to the award (e.g., number of days of service, rate of pay, travel, per diem). If this information is not available at the time of award, funds for this purpose will be withheld until the information is provided to and approved by NIFA.

- ADP/Computer Services

List total funds requested for ADP/Computer Services. The cost of computer services, including computer-based retrieval of scientific, technical and education information may be requested. In the budget justification, include the established computer service rates at the proposing organization if applicable.

- Subawards/Consortium/Contractual Costs

List total funds requested for 1) all subaward/consortium organization(s) proposed for the project and 2) any other contractual costs proposed for the project.

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- Equipment or Facility Rental/User Fees

List total funds requested for Equipment or Facility Rental/User Fees. In the budget justification, identify each rental/user fee and justify.

- Alterations and Renovations

List total funds requested for Alterations & Renovations. In the budget justification, itemize by category and justify the costs of alterations and renovations including repairs, painting, removal or installation of partitions, shielding, or air conditioning. Where applicable, provide the square footage and costs.

- Other (specify)

Add text to describe any "other" Direct Costs not requested above and list the funds requested. Use the budget justification to further itemize and justify.

- Total Other Direct Costs

Total Funds requested for all other direct costs. This total will auto-calculate.

Section G: Total Direct Costs

- Total Direct Costs (A through F)

Total Funds requested for all direct costs. This total will auto-calculate.

Section H: Indirect Costs

- Indirect Cost Type

Indicate the type of base; e.g., Salary & Wages, Modified Total Direct Costs, Other (explain). Also indicate if off-site. If more than one rate/base is involved, use separate lines for each. If you do not have a current indirect rate(s) approved by a Federal agency, indicate, "None--will

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negotiate" and include information for a proposed rate. Use the budget justification if additional space is needed.

- Indirect Cost Rate (%)

Indicate the most recent Indirect Cost rate(s) (also known as Facilities & Administrative Costs [F&A]) established with the cognizant Federal office, or in the case of for-profit organizations, the rate(s) established with the appropriate agency.

If you have a cognizant/oversight agency and are selected for an award, you must submit your indirect rate proposal to that office for approval. If you do not have a cognizant/oversight agency, contact the awarding agency.

- Indirect Cost Base

Enter the amount of the base for each indirect cost type.

- Funds Requested ($)

Enter funds requested for each indirect cost type. This field is required.

- Total Indirect Costs

Total Funds requested for indirect costs. This total will auto-calculate.

- Cognizant Federal Agency

Enter the name of the cognizant Federal agency, name and phone number of the individual responsible for negotiating your rate. If no cognizant agency is known, enter "None".

Many NIFA programs have statutory limits on the amount of F&A/indirect cost recovery. This limitation flows down to subcontracts. Check Part IV of the NOFO or RFP for the limitations, if any, on F&A/indirect costs. If indirect costs are allowed under the program, then the following applies as appropriate:

When NIFA is not the cognizant Federal agency, you should use the current negotiated indirect cost rate(s) established by your cognizant Federal agency (the agency that provides the most funds). If awarded, you will be required to produce a negotiated indirect cost rate(s) agreement from the cognizant agency in order to recover indirect costs.

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You may request (i.e., budget) indirect costs using the lesser of: (a) the negotiated rate; or (b) the maximum statutory rate stated in the NOFO or RFP, if any. If unable to obtain a negotiated rate agreement from your cognizant agency, you are not permitted indirect cost reimbursement (you may only be reimbursed for allowable direct cost) unless you are eligible for the 15% de minimis.

Violation of cost accounting principles is not permitted when re-budgeting or charging costs to awards. Rather, costs must be consistently charged as either indirect or direct costs. Also see 15% de minimis information in this section.

If the cognizant agency issues a negotiated rate subsequent to award, the negotiated rate may not be retroactively applied.

• When NIFA is the cognizant Federal agency. If you do not have a negotiated rate(s) agreement, and NIFA is the cognizant agency, you must calculate an indirect cost rate(s) in order to request indirect costs. NIFA's indirect cost website provides several sample indirect cost rate calculations. NIFA's Indirect Cost Resource provides more information on indirect costs. During the application process, you are not required to complete the entire indirect cost package identified on NIFA's website. Rather, you need only calculate an indirect cost rate to serve as a basis for requesting indirect costs. If awarded, you will be required to submit a complete Indirect Cost Proposal (ICP) package as explained on NIFA's indirect cost website. Also see 15% de minimis information in this section.

• 15% de minimis indirect cost rate. If you are new to Federal awards, and have never received a negotiated rate, you may elect to forgo calculation of an indirect cost rate and request a 15% de minimis indirect cost rate. The 15% de minimis rate is applied to modified total direct costs (MTDC). MTDC means total direct costs related to the award, such as direct labor, fringe benefits, materials and supplies, publications, consultant services and travel costs. MTDC excludes the following costs: equipment, capital expenditures, participant support costs and the portion of each subaward and subcontract in excess of $50,000. Violation of cost accounting principles is not permitted when charging costs to awards. Rather, costs must be consistently charged as either indirect or direct costs.

If the 15% de minimis option is chosen, it must be used consistently for all Federal awards until such time you choose to negotiate for a rate(s), which you may apply to do at any time. NIFA

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will revisit its cognizant agency responsibilities at that time. If cognizant, NIFA will establish a negotiated rate. The negotiated rate may not be retroactively applied.

For more information on indirect costs, see NIFA's Indirect Cost Resource.

Section I: Total Direct and Indirect Costs

Total Direct and Indirect Institutional Cost (G+H) – Total Funds requested for direct and indirect costs. This total will auto-calculate.

Section J: Fee

Generally, a fee is not allowed on a grant or cooperative agreement. Do not include a fee in your budget unless the program announcement specifically allows the inclusion of a "fee" (e.g., SBIR/STTR). If a fee is allowable, enter the requested fee. Inclusion of fees (profit) in a budget is allowable only if specifically authorized by a NIFA program solicitation.

Section K: Total Costs and Fee

Total Costs and Fee (I and J) – Total Direct and Indirect Costs and Fee requested. This total will auto-calculate.

Section L: Attach Budget Justification

Use the budget justification to provide the additional information requested in each budget categories identified above and any other information you wish to submit to support your budget request. The budget justification detail should follow the same order as the budget. While you should provide information for each item of the budget, you must justify the following budget categories, where applicable: salaries (justification is to include the Base Annual Salary for each key person), equipment, travel, participant/trainee support and other direct cost categories. Only one file may be attached.

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V.160 SF-424C: Budget Information for Construction Programs

This form provides budget information for construction programs.

Line 1: Administration and legal expenses

- 1a: Enter the total cost of Administrative and legal expenses.
- 1b: Enter costs not allowable for participation in administration and legal expenses. Check the NOFO and reach out to program staff with questions regarding expenses that may be unallowable.
- 1c: Total Allowable Costs (Columns a-b) will be calculated automatically if submitted via Workspace. This is the total of 1a and 1b.

Line 2: Land, structures, rights-of-way, appraisals, etc.

- 2a: Total cost of Land, structures, rights-of-way, appraisals, etc.
- 2b: Enter costs not allowable for land, structures, rights-of-way, appraisals, etc.
- 2c: Total Allowable Costs is the total of 2a and 2b.

Line 3: Relocation expenses and payments

- 3a: Total cost of relocation expenses and payments.
- 3b: Costs not allowable for relocation expenses and payments.
- 3c: Total of 3a and 3b.

Line 4: Architectural and engineering fees

- 4a: Total cost of Architectural and engineering fees.
- 4b: Total cost of non-allowable Architectural and engineering fees.
- 4c: Total of 4a and 4b.

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Line 5: Other architectural and engineering fees

- 5a: Total cost of Other architectural and engineering fees.
- 5b: Total cost of non-allowable Other architectural and engineering fees.
- 5c: Total of 5a and 5b.

Line 6: Project inspection fees

- 6a: Total cost of Project inspection fees.
- 6b: Total cost of non-allowable Project inspection fees.
- 6c: Total of 6a and 6b.

Line 7: Site work

- 7a: Total cost of Site work.
- 7b: Total cost of non-allowable Site work.
- 7c: Total of 7a and 7b.

Line 8: Demolition and removal

- 8a: Total cost for Demolition and removal.
- 8b: Total cost for non-allowable Demolition and removal.
- 8c: Total of 8a and 8b.

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Line 9: Construction

- 9a: Total cost for Construction.
- 9b: Total cost for non-allowable Construction.
- 9c: Total of 9a and 9b.

Line 10: Equipment

- 10a: Total cost for Equipment.
- 10b: Total cost for non-allowable Equipment.
- 10c: Total of 10a and 10b.

Line 11: Miscellaneous

- 11a: Total cost of Miscellaneous.
- 11b: Total cost of non-allowable Miscellaneous.
- 11c: Total of 11a and 11b.

Line 12: Subtotal

- 12a: Subtotal of Lines 1-11 for Total Cost.
- 12b. Sum of lines 1-11 for Costs Not Allowable.
- 12c. Sum of lines 12a-12c. Calculated automatically if submitted via Grants.gov.

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Line 13: Contingencies

- 13a: Total cost of Contingencies.
- 13b: Total cost of non-allowable contingencies.
- 13c: Sum of 13a and 13b.

Line 14: Subtotal

- 14a: Subtotal of Lines 12-13 for Total Cost.
- 14b. Sum of lines 12-13 for Costs Not Allowable.
- 14c. Sum of lines 14a-14c. Calculated automatically if submitted via Grants.gov.

Line 15: Program/Project Income

- 15a: Total cost of Project (program) income.
- 15b. Costs Not Allowable for Participation in Project (program) income.
- 15c. Total Allowable Costs (Columns a-b). Calculated automatically if submitted via Grants.gov.

Line 16: Total project costs

Subtract line 15 from Line 14.

- 16a: Total Cost of Total Project Costs.
- 16b: Total of Costs Not Allowable for Participation.
- 16c: Total Allowable Costs. Calculated automatically if submitted via Grants.gov

Line 17: Federal assistance requested

Enter eligible costs from line 16c. Multiply x Federal percentage share %.

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V.170 R&R Subaward (Fed/Non-Fed) Budget Attachment(s) Form

This form is used for applications with a subaward or consortium. This form is required only when the primary grantee is submitting an R&R Budget Form and has subaward and/or consortium budgets.

On this form, you will attach the R&R Subaward (Fed/Non-Fed) Budget files for your grant application. Only subaward (Fed/Non-Fed) budgets are to be attached to this form.

Complete the sub awardee budget(s) in accordance with the R&R (Fed/Non-Fed) budget instructions. This includes the preparation of a budget justification for the subaward and attaching it in Field K. of the subaward budget. Any files you attach must be in PDF format.

The R&R Subaward (Fed/Non-Fed) Budget Attachment(s) Form allows no more than 30 R&R Subaward (Fed/Non-Fed) Budget Files for a grant application. Include any remaining subaward budget(s) (beyond the 30 subaward budget attachments) under Field K. "Budget Justification" of the applicant organization, incorporating them as part of the required PDF attachment.

Annual budgets including a budget justification and a cumulative budget are required for each sub contractual arrangement only when: 1) subawards comprise 50 percent or more of an overall award amount (individually or cumulatively); or 2) subawards are directed to Federal agencies.

To extract or download, fill, and attach the additional R&R Subaward (Fed/Non-Fed) Budget Attachment(s) Form:

1. On the R&R Subaward (Fed/Non-Fed) Budget Attachment(s) Form, press the "Click here to extract the R&R Subaward (Fed/Non-Fed) Budget Attachment" button to download the form.

2. Save the sub awardee budget file(s) with the name of the sub awardee organization. Each file name attached to the R&R Subaward (Fed/Non-Fed) Budget Attachment(s) Form must be unique.

3. Open the form that you have just saved.

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4. Enter your sub awardee organization information in this supplemental form. Complete the sub awardee budget(s) in accordance with the R&R (Fed/Non-Fed) budget instructions.

5. When you have completed the supplemental form, save it and close it.

6. Return to the "R&R Subaward (Fed/Non-Fed) Budget Attachment(s) Form."

7. Attach the saved supplemental form that you just completed and saved to one of the blocks provided on this "attachment(s)" form.

8. Extract and attach additional R&R Subaward (Fed/Non-Fed) Budget Attachment forms for the subaward organizations as necessary using the process outlined above. The files you attach must be a previously extracted R&R Subaward (Fed/Non-Fed) Budget Attachment form. Attaching any other type of file may result in the inability to submit your application to Grants.gov.

Annual budgets including a budget justification and a cumulative budget are required for each sub contractual arrangement only when: 1) subawards comprise 50 percent or more of an overall award amount (individually or cumulatively); or 2) subawards are directed to Federal agencies.

If there are more than 10 sub contractual arrangements, you must add the budgets—including the budget justification for the sub contractual arrangements that are not included in the R&R Subaward (Fed/Non-Fed) Budget Attachment(s) Form—to the application by including them in the primary applicant's budget justification *or* by attaching them to Field 12, Other Attachments, of the R&R Other Project Information form.

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V.200 AFRI Project Type Form

This form is only required for applications submitted to the Agriculture and Food Research Initiative (AFRI) program.

Field 1: Project Type

Select one Project Type.

- Research
- Education
- Extension
- Integrated

Note: Integrated proposals contain at least two of the three project type categories, and they may be any combination of research, education, and extension.

The NOFO will include descriptions, as appropriate, and state which types of projects are being solicited.

Field 2: Grant Type

Select one Grant Type.

The NOFO includes descriptions, as appropriate, and state which types of grants are being solicited.

- Standard
- Coordinated Agricultural Project (CAP)
- Planning / Coordination
- Conference
- Food and Agriculture Science Enhancement (FASE)
- Other: If Other is the selected, you must include a description.

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If FASE is the selected grant type, you must identify the type of FASE Grant by selecting one from the list of five types. See NOFO for the types of FASE Grants being solicited for a given funding opportunity:

- Predoctoral Fellowship
- Postdoctoral Fellowship
- New Investigator Seed
- New Investigator Standard
- Strengthening.

If Strengthening is the selected FASE Grant, you must identify the type of Strengthening project by selection one from the list of nine types. See NOFO for descriptions and the types of Strengthening projects being solicited.

- Sabbatical
- Equipment
- New Investigator Strengthening Seed
- New Investigator Strengthening Standard
- Strengthening Seed
- Strengthening Standard
- Strengthening CAP
- Strengthening Conference
- Other. If Other is the selected, you must include a description.

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V.210 SBIR/STTR Information

Use this form only if you are submitting to the NIFA Small Business Innovation and Research (SBIR) or Small Business Technology Transfer (STTR) grants.

Field 1: Agency to which you are applying (select only one):

Agency to which you are applying. This field is required. Select USDA.

Field 2: SBC Control ID

Enter the nine-digit SBC Control ID. This number is obtained through the Login/Register process on the Small Business Administration (SBA) website.

Field 3: Program Type (select only one):

Select only one from the following Program Type:

- SBIR: Apply for SBIR Only
- STTR: Apply for STTR Only
- Both: Apply for both SBIR and STTR in a single submission

To apply for "SBIR Only" the PD/PI must be employed more than one-half (51%) of the time with the small business for Phase I and Phase II and the small business must perform a minimum of two-thirds (66%) of the proposed research or analytical work for Phase I and a minimum of fifty percent (50%) for Phase II.

To apply for "STTR Only", at least one of the PD/PI or Co-PD/PIs must be employed more than one half (51%) of the time with either the small business or non-profit research institution and the small business must have a single non-profit research institution conduct a minimum of 30% and a maximum of 60% of the research or analytical work for Phase I and Phase II, and the small business must perform a minimum of 40% of the proposed research or analytical work.

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To apply to “Both” (SBIR and STTR), the PD/PI must be employed more than one-half (51%) of the time with the small business for Phase I and Phase II and a minimum of 30% and a maximum of 33% of the research and analytical work for Phase I and a minimum of 30% and a maximum of 50% of the research and analytical work for Phase II must be conducted by a single non-profit research institution. The small business must perform a minimum of 40% of the proposed research or analytical work.

Field 4: Application Type (select only one):

See agency-specific instructions to determine application type participation.
Application Type field is required.

If you are submitting a Phase I application, check the Phase I box. NIFA does not require a Phase I Letter of Intent Number, therefore, N/A should be entered in the applicable field. If you are submitting a Phase II application, check the Phase II box. When submitting a Phase II Application following an awarded Phase I, be sure to include the Phase I SBIR/STTR grant number in the "Federal Identifier" in field 4.a. of the SF-424 R&R Cover Page.

Field 5: Agency Topic/Subtopic

NIFA will not be using any information entered in this field; you may enter N/A.

Question 1a: Do you certify that at the time of award your organization will meet the eligibility criteria for a small business as defined in the funding opportunity announcement?

If you certify that at the time of award, your organization will meet the eligibility criteria for a small business as defined in the funding opportunity announcement, check the Yes box.

Otherwise, check the No box.

Question 1b: Anticipated Number of personnel to be employed at your organization at the time of award

Enter the number of personnel anticipated to be employed by the small business at the time of award.

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Question 1c: Is your small business majority owned by venture capital operating companies, hedge funds, or private equity firms?

If your small business is majority owned by venture capital operating companies, hedge funds, or private equity firms, check the Yes box. Otherwise, check the No box.

Question 1d: Is your small business a Faculty or Student-Owned entity?

If your small business is a faculty or student-owned entity, check the Yes box. Otherwise, check the No box.

Question 2: Does this application include subcontracts with Federal laboratories or any other Federal Government agencies?

If this application includes subcontracts with Federal laboratories or any other Federal Government agencies, check the Yes box and insert the name of the Federal laboratories/agencies in the space provided. Otherwise, check the No box.

If yes, insert the names of the Federal laboratories/agencies.

Question 3: Are you located in a HUBZone?

To find out if your business is in a HUBZone, use the mapping utility provided by the Small Business Administration on the SBA's HUBZone Map.

If you are located in a HUBZone check the Yes box. Otherwise, check the No box.

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Question 4: Will all research and development on the project be performed in its entirety in the United States?

If all research and development on the project will be performed in its entirety in the United States, check the Yes box. Otherwise, check the No box and use the Add Attachment button below to attach an explanation. If no, provide an explanation in an attached file.

Question 5: Has the applicant and/or Program Director/Principal Investigator submitted proposals for essentially equivalent work under other Federal program solicitations or received other Federal awards for essentially equivalent work?

If the applicant and/or Program Director/Principal Investigator submitted proposals for essentially equivalent work under other Federal program solicitations or received other Federal awards for essentially equivalent work, check the Yes box.

If yes, insert the names of the other Federal agencies. Otherwise, check the No box.

Question 6: Disclosure Permission Statement

If this application does not result in an award, is the Government permitted to disclose the title of your proposed project, and the name, address, telephone number and e-mail address of the official signing for the applicant organization to organizations that may be interested in contacting you for further information (e.g., possible collaborators, investment)?

If yes, check the Yes box. Otherwise, check the No box.

Question 7: Does the application include a request of SBIR or STTR funds for Technical and Business Assistance (TABA)?

If yes, please follow the agency specific instructions to provide the budget request and justification. Please answer no if you plan to use the agency TABA vendor, which does not require you to include a request for TABA funds in your application

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Question 8: Commercialization Plan

If you are submitting a Phase II Application, include a Commercialization Plan in accordance with the agency announcement and/or agency-specific instructions.

Question 9: Have you received SBIR/STTR Phase II awards from the Federal Government?

Please respond if applying for SBIR Only, STTR Only or Both SBIR and STTR. If you have received SBIR Phase II awards from the Federal Government then check the Yes box and use the Add Attachment button below, to attach a company commercialization history in accordance with agency- specific instructions. Otherwise, check the No box.

Question 10: Will the Project Director/Principal Investigator have his/her primary employment with the small business at the time of award?

Please respond if applying for SBIR Only, STTR Only or Both SBIR and STTR. If the Project Director/Principal Investigator will have his/her primary employment with the small business at the time of award, then check the Yes box. Otherwise, check the No box.

Question 11: Please indicate whether the answer to BOTH of the following questions is TRUE.

Please respond if applying for SBIR Only, STTR Only or to Both SBIR and STTR. If the Project Director/Principal Investigator has a formal appointment either with the small business (as an employee or contractor) or as an employee of the nonprofit research institution that has made a commitment to the small business through the STTR Application process AND if the Project Director/Principal Investigator will devote a minimum of 10% of their efforts to the proposed project, then check the Yes box. Otherwise, check the No box.

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Question 12: In the joint research and development proposed in this project, does the small business perform at least 40% of the work and the research institution named in the application perform at least 30% of the work?

Please respond if applying for STTR Only or to both SBIR and STTR. If the proposed joint research and development is performed at least 40% by the small business and at least 30% by the nonprofit research institution, then check the Yes box. Otherwise, check the No box.

Question 13: Provide UEI of the nonprofit research partner for STTR.

Please respond if applying for STTR Only or to both SBIR and STTR. Enter the UEI number.

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V.220 Key Contacts Form

The purpose of this form is to identify key contacts that are not the PI/PD. A Key Contact is a user that is designated to be a point of contact for USDA if any questions arise during the application life cycle. Any user associated with the applicant can be a Key Contact. All user roles may be assigned as Key Contacts.

Field 1: Applicant Organization Name

Enter the legal name and information of the applicant that will undertake the assistance activity. This field is required. The remaining fields are self-explanatory.

Field 2: Contact 1

Enter the name and information of each contact. Select “Next Person” to enter the next contact person entry. Complete the same information for additional contacts.

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V.300 NIFA Supplemental Information Form

This form is used in conjunction with the SF-424 (R&R): Application for Federal Financial Assistance.

Field 1: Funding Opportunity

- Funding Opportunity Name: Pre-populated from the opportunity package. Verify the accuracy of the funding opportunity name. This field is required.
- Funding Opportunity Number: Pre-populated from the opportunity package. Verify the accuracy of the funding opportunity number. This field is required.

Field 2: Program to which you are applying

Program Code Name: Enter the name of the program to which you are applying exactly as instructed in the full announcement. This field is required.

Program Code**:** Enter the program code to which you are applying exactly as instructed in the full announcement. This code is used to route an application within the agency. This field is required.

Field 3: Type of Applicant

Pre-populated from the SF-424 R&R.

Field 3 describes the legal applicant that is identified in Field 5 of the SF-424R&R.

Field 4: Additional Applicant Types

Select one of the following options if it is applicable to the legal applicant of this application.

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The following are a few examples to illustrate how fields 3 and 4 might be completed.

- If the applicant is an 1862 Land-grant University, the type of applicant is “Public/State Controlled Institution of Higher Education” and the additional applicant type is “1862 Land-Grant University.”
- If the applicant is an 1890 Land-grant University, the type of applicant is “Public/State Controlled Institution of Higher Education” and the additional applicant type is “1890 Land-Grant University.”
- If the applicant is a 1994 Land-grant University, the type of applicant is “Public/State Controlled Institution of Higher Education” and the additional applicant type is “1994 Land-Grant University.”
- If the applicant is a USDA Agency, the type of applicant is “Other” and the additional applicant type is “USDA Agency.”

Field 5: Supplemental Applicant Types

Select any of the listed options that are applicable to the legal applicant of the application. More than one option can be selected, if applicable.

Field 6: ASAP Recipient Information

If the legal applicant has an active (Automated Standard Application for Payments) ASAP Recipient Identification Number, select Yes. If it does not select No. This field is required.

Enter the ASAP Recipient ID to be used in the event of an award. This field is to be completed if yes is selected as answer to previous question.

This information will no longer be used as payments will be made via the Automated Standard Application System (ASAP) operated by the U.S. Department of Treasury’s Financial Management Service.

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Field 7: Key Words

Enter the most relevant words which describe the proposed project. This field is required.

Field 8: Conflict of Interest List

Unless stated otherwise in the NOFO or RFP, a Conflict of Interest (COI) list is required for each Senior/Key Person included in the R&R Senior/Key Person profile.

Prepare the COI list(s) following the instructions and format below. A suggested template for the COI list is available at NIFA's Application Support Template Resource.

Attach a single attachment containing a COI list for each Senior/Key Person included in the R&R Senior/Key Person Profile (i.e., one attachment containing all the COI lists).

For each Senior/Key Person, list alphabetically by last name (and with last name first), the full names of individuals in the following categories and mark each category which applies with an "x".

- All thesis or postdoctoral advisees/advisors
- All co-authors on publications within the past 3 years, including pending publications and submissions
- All collaborators on projects within the past 3 years, including current and planned collaborations
- All persons in your field with whom you have had a consulting/financial arrangement/other conflict-of-interest in the past 3 years including receiving compensation of any type (e.g., money, goods, or services).

Note: Other individuals working in the applicant's specific area are not in conflict of interest with the applicant unless those individuals fall within one of the listed categories. The Program Contact must be informed of any additional conflicts of interest that arise after the application is submitted.

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V.310 Attachments Form

The attachments form is an optional form that NIFA will use in limited circumstances.

Use the form following instructions in the NOFO or RFP.

Please note: If matching funds and a Matching Source Document are required under the funding opportunity announcement, this Matching Source Document will generally be submitted on the Attachments Form. The Matching Source Document must be in PDF format, and the applicant must assemble the Matching Source Document according to funding opportunity announcement instructions.

Matching documentation will include any non-federal matching fund sources. When documenting matching sources, please specify:

- Type of match
- Source of match
- Amount of match for each source
- Total amount of all match support

This document should also include the program name, the fiscal year and be signed by an Authorized Representative of the entity.

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V.320 Data Management Plan

A Data Management Plan (DMP) is required for many competitive grants programs.
Within the DMP, applicants should clearly articulate how the project director (PD) and co-PDs plan to manage and disseminate the data generated by the project.

The DMP is limited to two pages. These two pages do not count toward the page limits for the project narrative and should not be used to circumvent the project page limit.

If a project does not include data collection (e.g., a meeting with no proceedings), the DMP document may be limited to the statement "No data will be produced", accompanied by a clear explanation of why there will be no data produced by the project.

Otherwise, the DMP must address the following topics depending on the type of research, education, and extension activities being conducted, unless otherwise stated in the NOFO or RFP.

Expected Data Type

Describe the type of data (e.g., digital, non-digital), how it will be generated, and whether the data are primary or metadata.

- Research examples may include lab work, field work and surveys.
- Education examples may include number of students enrolled/participated, degrees granted, curriculum and training products
- Extension examples may include outreach materials, number of stakeholders reached, number of activities and assessment questionnaires.

Data Format

For scientific data to be readily accessible and usable it is critical to use appropriate community-recognized standard and machine-readable formats when they exist. If the data will be managed in domain-specific workspaces or submitted to public databases, indicate that their required formats will be followed. Regardless of the format used, the data set must contain enough information to allow independent use (understanding, validation, and analysis) of the data.

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Data Storage and Preservation

Data must be stored in a safe environment with adequate measures taken for its long-term preservation. Applicants must describe plans for storing and preserving their data during and after the project and specify the data repositories if they exist. Databases or data repositories for long-term preservation may be the same that are used to provide Data Sharing and Public Access.

Estimate how much data will be preserved and state the planned retention period. Include any strategies, tools, and contingency plans that will be used to avoid data loss, degradation, or damage.

Data Sharing, Protection and Public Access

Describe your data access and sharing procedures during and after the grant. Name specific repositories and catalogs as appropriate.

Include a statement, when applicable, of plans to protect confidentiality, personal privacy, proprietary interests, business confidential information, and intellectual property rights. Outline any restrictions such as copyright, confidentiality, patent, appropriate credit, disclaimers, or conditions for use of the data by other parties.

Roles, Responsibilities and Reporting

State the party or parties who will ensure DMP implementation. This item is particularly important for multi-investigator and multi-institutional projects.

Provide a contingency plan in case key personnel leave the project. Consider the following questions: What resources will be needed for the DMP? If funds are needed, have they been added to the budget request and budget narrative? Projects must budget sufficient resources to develop and implement the proposed DMP.

Applicants are encouraged to consider using platforms, catalogs and workspaces provided by USDA (e.g., the Ag Data Commons), and include adequate funds in the budget to support data management and submission fees as required by the platforms, catalogs, etc. Successful

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projects should monitor the implementation of the DMP throughout the life of the project and after, as appropriate.

Implementation of the DMP must be a component of annual and final reports to NIFA (REEport) and include progress in data sharing (publications, database, software, curriculum, outreach materials, etc.). The final report should also describe the data that was produced during the award period and the components that will be stored and preserved (including the expected duration) after the award ends. The DMP should be compliant with the Research Terms and Conditions that govern NIFA-funded projects. The DMP is not intended to be a replacement for other grant reporting requirements.

Note: Some NIFA funding programs may require different standards for DMPs. NOFO/RFP instructions always supersede application instructions in this guide.

To learn more about DMPs, please see NIFA's Data Management Plan resource page. This resource page also contains a DMP FAQ that addresses common applicant questions about the DMP.

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VI. Grant Application Package Management, Status & Awards

Within two days of submitting a grant application, Grants.gov will send you two email messages:

- The first email will confirm receipt of the application.
- The second email will indicate whether the application has been validated by the system OR has been rejected due to errors.

If your application was successfully validated, Grants.gov will send you a third e-mail notifying you the application has been passed to the agency.

VI.100 Track your Application

There are two ways to verify the status of an application submitted to Grants.gov.

Option 1: Use the "Track My Application" feature on Grants.gov

Check your Grants.gov Application Status on the Track My Application Page. This page doesn't require a username or password.

Once on the Track My Application page, enter up to five Grants.gov tracking numbers (one per line) and select the Track My Application(s) button. The system will display general information about the status of each application.

This application tracking feature only confirms whether an application has successfully been retrieved by the awarding agency.

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Option 2: Use the "Check Application Status" Tool on Grants.gov

Check your Grants.gov Application Status on the Check Application Status Page.

This tool is located under your Applicant Login in the Applicants section of Grants.gov, and it requires you to enter your username and password.

"Check Application Status" gives you the opportunity to view a manifest of submitted forms and files within Grants.gov. You can use this manifest to review the list of forms and file attachments that were properly uploaded and received in the system.

On the "Check Application Status" page, you will be given the option to search for your application in several different ways. You may view the list of a particular application's file(s) and attachment(s) by selecting the link in the Actions column for that application and selecting either the Details or Download Link.

It's important that you thoroughly review the manifest to ensure that required attachments outlined in the NOFO or RFP are included and that you have followed NIFA's attachment formatting requirements.

Submitted applications that do not contain the required forms and file attachments will not be reviewed.

VI.200 Addressing Issues with Submitted Applications

If you discover any issues when reviewing your submission status and/or file manifest in Grants.gov, your next steps will depend on whether the problems with your application were discovered prior to, or following, the grant application deadline.

- If application issues are discovered prior to the application deadline:
  Please correct your application and submit it before the established deadline.
  You must notify the NIFA Agency Contact, identified in the NOFO, via telephone or email immediately if you are planning to submit a corrected application.

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The Agency Contact must be aware that there are two applications, so that one may be accepted, and the other removed from consideration. Without this notification, both applications may be excluded from consideration.

- If application issues are discovered after the application deadline:
  We advise you to correct the application and submit it as soon as possible.
  In this circumstance, you must notify the NIFA Agency Contact, identified in the NOFO or RFP, via telephone or email immediately.

  The Agency Contact must be aware that there are two applications with one submitted prior to the deadline and a corrected version submitted following the deadline. Without this notification, both applications may be excluded from consideration. If the late application is not accepted for consideration, it is possible that the one submitted prior to the deadline may be considered.

  Note: You must provide documentation of any extenuating circumstance (e.g., hurricane, flood, fire) along with your late application.

VI.300 USDA/NIFA Application Status

After receipt of your application through Grants.gov, NIFA will send you two email messages.

- The first will confirm NIFA's receipt of your application.
- The second will indicate whether NIFA has accepted OR declined to review the application.

Application Updates – Post Submission and Awards

Applications submitted through Grants.gov are considered official submissions to the federal

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government. You should immediately contact the appropriate NIFA Agency Contact, as identified in the NOFO or RFP, if you need to change or correct a previously submitted application.

If you have any questions about application decisions (including whether funding decisions have been made), please contact the NIFA agency program contact listed in the NOFO or RFP for the relevant funding opportunity.

For questions regarding awards:
Email awards@usda.gov for competitive grants.
Email capacitygrantquestions@usda.gov for capacity grants.

Remember to include your award number, if applicable.

Information regarding the administration of NIFA awards, including relevant award conditions, is available on NIFA's Regulations and Guidelines Page.

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VII. Appendix

VII.100 Application Guide Version Change List

Summary of Recent Changes

Changes in version dated March 2026

Section III.600: Added new section containing information on eRA Commons

Section v.120: Updated NEPA instructions and notice

Section V.130: Added information on SciENcv

Throughout Guide: Updated Request for Applications (RFA) to Notice of Funding Opportunity (NOFO), added references to Request for Proposals (RFPs)

Changes in version dated March 2025

Section V.100: Updated instructions for SF-424 (R&R) Application for Federal Assistance

Section V.130: Updated instructions for Current and Pending Support Template

Throughout Guide: Updated references from Catalog of Federal Domestic Assistance to Assistance Listing

Throughout Guide: Updated hyperlinks and webpage screenshots

Changes in version dated January 2025

Section V.140: Updated instructions for R&R Personal Data: Senior/Key Person Profile

Changes in version dated July 2023

Section V.110: Added additional instructions for Project/Performance Site Addresses

Section V.120: Updated instructions for Project Summary/Abstracts

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Section V.200: Updated form instructions for AFRI Project Type Form V2.0

Section V.210: Updated SBIR/STTR form instructions

Section V.310: Added Matching Source Document information and description

Throughout Guide: Updated NOFO citations; guide references to STTR program; formatting and colors in accordance with NIFA Style Guide

Table of Contents: Updated page number references

Changes included in version dated October 2022

Removed references to form AD-3030

Updated formatting of guide for readability

Updated Table of Contents page number references to reflect guide revisions

Changes in version dated May 2022

Updated AFRI Project Type form instructions for AFRI Project Type Form V2.0

Changes included in version dated March 2022

Section I:

I.100: Added Acronym List

I.200: Added Glossary of Applicant Resources

I.300: Added Overview of NIFA Grants Process

I.400: Added Grant types and requirements overview

I.500 Added Tips for Grant Applicants subsection

Information on Adobe Acrobat and Grants.gov system compatibility moved to Section II

Section II:

Expanded and updated applicant resources and contact information list

Information on application search moved to Section III

Section III:

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III.400: Removed outdated DUNS references

III.400: Added instructions on obtaining and using Unique Entity Identifier (UEI)

III.500: Expanded instruction section re: Grants.gov registration. Updated information on Login.gov credentialing.

Section IV:

Reorganized section

Moved post-application instructions to Section VI

Section V:

Updated all form instructions to reflect most recent form versions as of April 2022

Removed instructions on FY21 pilot capacity budget process

V.320: Added information and guidance re: Data Management Plan development

Section VI:

VI.100-VI.300: Updated instructions on application tracking and addressing issues with submitted applications

Section VII:

VII.100: Added Application Guide Version Change List

VII.200: Added Frequently Asked Questions list to Appendix

Throughout Guide:

Staff and Agency contact information and hyperlinks have been updated throughout the document

Instructions were revised for readability. Images of form sections removed

Format and design of guide were updated to enhance readability

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VII.200 Frequently Asked Questions

In this Appendix you will find a list of frequently asked questions.

If your question is not included in this FAQ list, and you haven't been able to find additional information in this guide, please contact the appropriate support team from the Contact Information Section.

Q. How do I know if I am eligible, or if my organization is eligible, to apply for a NIFA grant?

Eligibility for any NIFA grant program is determined by the authorizing and annual appropriation legislation.

For competitive grants, you can check the "Eligibility" section of the appropriate NOFO (located in Part III, A).

For non-competitive opportunities, NIFA notifies eligible grant recipients directly.

Q. Does NIFA accept unsolicited grant applications?

No. NIFA must comply with the Departmental regulation 2 CFR 415.1.

As a result, NIFA is to enter into grants and cooperative agreements only after competition and the competitive award process. The regulation includes an exception to this rule for awards to fund unique and innovative unsolicited applications. However, NIFA receives annual appropriations that require the agency to fund very specific areas of agricultural research, education, and extension. Therefore, NIFA does not normally accept or consider unsolicited grant applications for funding.

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Q. What is a Notice of Funding Opportunity?

A Notice of Funding Opportunity, or NOFO, is a notice that provides potential applicants with detailed information about an opportunity to submit an application for federal financial assistance.

The NOFO generally includes the purpose, eligibility, restrictions, focus areas, evaluation criteria, and regulatory information and instructions on how to apply. NIFA's NOFOs are posted on NIFA's NOFO List.

Q. What is a funding opportunity announcement? What is a funding opportunity package?

A funding opportunity announcement is when a federal agency makes known its intentions to award discretionary grants or cooperative agreements, usually as a result of competition for funds.

NIFA posts funding opportunity announcements to Grants.gov, which posts discretionary funding opportunities from a variety of different agencies and provides a platform for grantees to find and apply these opportunities.

A funding opportunity announcement includes a synopsis and a funding opportunity package.

The synopsis provides basic information for the applicant to determine if they want to look at the NOFO; it includes information about how to locate the NOFO.

The funding opportunity package includes the necessary forms to apply as well as the general instructions for completing the forms. The NOFO and the funding opportunity package are used simultaneously in the preparation of an application.

Q. How do I know when NIFA publishes a funding opportunity announcement or an NOFO?

In Grants.gov, you can subscribe to receive notifications of when NIFA or other Federal agencies post a funding opportunity announcement or update previously posted funding opportunities.

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You do not need to be a registered user of Grants.gov to sign-up for this service. For more information, visit Manage Subscriptions.

NIFA also uses listservs and its bi-weekly publication, NIFA Update, and may issue a press release to notify potential applicants that a funding opportunity announcement and a NOFO is available. In rare instances (e.g., legislatively required), NIFA will publish a funding opportunity announcement or the NOFO in the Federal Register; in such instances it is in addition to the Grants.gov postings.

Q. Where can I get a copy of an NOFO and the application forms necessary to apply for a funding opportunity?

NIFA's competitive NOFOs are posted alphabetically on NIFA's NOFO List. Also included on the page is a link to the NOFO search page.

Each NOFO includes instructions about how to locate the funding opportunity announcement which contains the funding opportunity package. The funding opportunity package includes the necessary forms to apply as well as the general instructions for completing the forms.

Q. Who should I contact if I have a question about a specific NOFO?

Appendix I of the NOFO lists the NIFA Agency Contact(s). If you have programmatic questions, contact the Programmatic Contact. If you have an administrative question, contact the Administrative/Business contact.

Q. Where can I send comments about a particular NOFO to be considered in the development of the NOFO for the next fiscal year?

At the beginning of the NOFO there is a section titled Stakeholder Input.

Interested parties should submit written comments in accordance with instructions of that section.

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Q. Do I have to register with Grants.gov before submitting an application through Grants.gov?

Yes. You must be registered with Grants.gov. There is a one-time registration process for Grants.gov, regardless of the Federal agency you may be submitting an application to through Grants.gov.

Information about how to register is included on the Grants.gov registration page. If you are with an institution, we strongly recommend that you reach out to your grants office or grants team to confirm that your institution is registered with Grants.gov.

Q. How long does the Grants.gov registration process take?

The registration process must be completed prior to submission of an application. The following is guidance so you can gauge the amount of time it may take to register.

- Organization applicants with an Employer Identification Number (EIN) should allow 7 business days to complete all registration steps, but additional time may be required for AOR Authorization depending upon the responsiveness of your E-Biz POC.
- Organization applicants applying for an EIN should plan on a minimum of 2 full weeks, but additional time may be required for AOR Authorization depending upon the responsiveness of your E-Biz POC.
- Individual applicants can potentially register in as little as 1 business day.

Q. Does NIFA require any agency specific registration in addition to the required Grants.gov registration?

No. NIFA requires no separate registration beyond the Grants.gov registration, and the registrations that are required for a successful Grants.gov registration (e.g., UEI, SAM.gov). Some applicants will also need to register in eRA, if their target funding opportunity is being managed through that system.

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Q. I will be the Project Director on the proposal. Do I need to register with Grants.gov?

No, unless you are also the person authorized to submit an application on behalf of their organization. This is generally this is not the case if you are part of an institution.

For example, the Project Director for a for-profit company submitting a proposal to the Small Business Innovation Research (SBIR) program or the Small Business Technology Transfer (STTR) Program may also be the person authorized to submit applications.

Q. What software do I need to apply through Grants.gov?

Grants.gov requires using Adobe Acrobat Reader for Windows or MAC OS.

To determine if your Adobe Reader or Adobe Acrobat software is compatible with Grants.gov, use the Grants.gov Adobe Software Compatibility Checker.

Q. What process does NIFA use to evaluate proposals submitted for competitive review?

Using the evaluation criteria specified in the RFA, the proposals are evaluated through a peer review process.

See the NIFA Peer Review Process for Competitive Grant Applications page for further details.

Q. What are indirect costs?

Indirect costs are those costs that are incurred for common or joint objectives and therefore cannot be identified readily and specifically with a particular sponsored project.

Examples of indirect costs include depreciation and use allowances for an organization's building and equipment, operation and maintenance expenses, sponsored projects administration, and departmental administration.

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Q. Can I include indirect costs in my application budget?

Some competitive financial assistance programs supported by NIFA allow for indirect costs. However, for some of these awards the amount is limited by legislation. The amount of allowable indirect costs will be included in the "Funding Restrictions" section (Part IV) of the RFA. To assist in the understanding of the applicable indirect cost rate under NIFA programs, an indirect cost chart is available on the NIFA web site on the Indirect Cost Chart.

While the chart is available, NIFA applicants are to follow any indirect cost limitation identified in the applicable NOFO or RFP and comply with any indirect cost limitation identified in an award.

Q. How do I obtain an indirect cost rate agreement?

See NIFA's Indirect Costs Page for information.

Q. How do I know if my application has been received by Grants.gov?

Within 2 days of submitting a grant application, Grants.gov will send you two email messages:

- The first email will confirm receipt of the application.
- The second email will indicate whether the application has been validated by the system OR has been rejected due to errors.

If the application was successfully validated, Grants.gov will send you a third e-mail notifying you the application has been passed to the agency.

Receipt of the Grants.gov e-mails does not indicate the application has been accepted for review. The Authorized Representative will be notified in up to two subsequent e-mails if the application has been accepted or rejected for program review. If accepted, the application will be assigned a NIFA application number (e.g., 2009-XXXXX). This number should be cited on all future correspondence.

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Q. If I'm required to submit a Conflict of Interest List with my Grants.gov application package, what format can I use?

It's important to follow the instructions in the RFA for the correct format of your application and any required attachments. Unless stated otherwise in the RFA, a Conflict of Interest (COI) list is required for each senior/key person included in the R&R Senior/Key Person profile.

Prepare the COI list(s) following the instructions and format below. A suggested template for the COI list is located through NIFA's Application Support Template Resource. Attach a single PDF attachment containing a COI list for each senior/key person included in the R&R Senior/Key Person Profile (i.e., one attachment containing all the COI lists).

For each senior/key person, list alphabetically by last name (and with last name first), the full names of individuals in the following categories and mark each category which applies with an "x".

• All thesis or postdoctoral advisees/advisors

• All co-authors on publications within the past three years, including pending publications and submissions

• All collaborators on projects within the past three years, including current and planned collaborations

• All persons in your field with whom you have had a consulting/financial arrangement/other conflict-of-interest in the past three years including receiving compensation of any type (e.g., money, goods, or services).

Note: Other individuals working in the applicant's specific area are not in conflict of interest with the applicant unless those individuals fall within one of the listed categories. The program contact must be informed of any additional conflicts of interest that arise after the application is submitted.

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Q. If I'm required to submit Current and Pending Support documentation with my Grants.gov application package what format can I use?

It's important to follow the instructions in the NOFO or RFP for the correct format of your application and any attached documents.

Unless stated otherwise in the NOFO or RFP, applicants are encouraged to use the suggested Current and Pending Support Template for each key personnel. The Current and Pending Support information is to be attached as a PDF document to the R&R Senior/Key Person Profile.

Q. If I'm required to submit a Project Summary/Abstract with my Grants.gov application package what format can I use?

It's important to follow the instructions in the funding opportunity announcement for the correct format. Unless stated otherwise in the NOFO or RFP, applicants are encouraged to use the suggested Project Summary/ Abstract Template. The Project Summary/Abstract is to be attached as a PDF document to the R&R Other Project Information.

Q. How do I ensure that I'm applying to the correct NIFA funding opportunity?

Field 1 of the Supplemental Information form is prepopulated with the funding opportunity name and number from the funding opportunity package.

Check this field to ensure it contains information for the opportunity to which you intend to apply.

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Q. There are a number of places where information is to be included in the application as an attachment. What type of attachments will NIFA accept?

NIFA requires attachments to the application to be in Portable Document Format (PDF). PDF allows applicants to preserve the formatting of their documents.

If you need assistance with Adobe software, Grants.gov has PDF resources available at Grants.gov's software compatibility page.

Q. Will applicants have to put the attachment in PDF format?

Yes. The applicant is responsible for converting an attachment file to PDF prior to attaching it to the application and submitting it in Grants.gov.

Q. How does NIFA determine if an application has met the deadline?

A date and time stamp are attached to the application when you click on the Submit button to electronically send the application to Grants.gov.

The date and time stamp determines whether the application was received by Grants.gov before the deadline which is identified in the applicable NOFO or RFP. An application submitted or resubmitted after the deadline is late.

For example, if a NOFO or RFP lists a deadline of 5:00 pm EST, an application is considered on time at 5:00.59 pm EST but would be late at 5:01 pm EST.

Q. How do I know my application was received by the deadline date and time?

After submitting an application to Grants.gov, users will receive the electronic equivalent of a postmark stamp on the application confirmation screen. This contains the date and time the application was received by Grants.gov. Applicants should print out this page for their records.

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Q. When do I need to submit my application?

Refer to the NOFO or RFP for the established deadline.

Q. What if I experience a technical problem with Grants.gov on a deadline date?

You are advised to maintain documentation (e.g., case number provided by Grants.gov Customer Support) of the matter and submit the application as soon as is feasibly possible.

If the application is submitted following the deadline, contact the Agency Contact (Appendix I of RFA) and inform them that you would like a late application considered under an extenuating circumstance.

See NIFA's Late Application Consideration page for further information.

Q. Should I look for an opportunity by entering the AL number on Grants.gov?

From the Grants.gov Search Grants page, you can search for funding opportunities using the AL number or the more effective way is using the funding opportunity number. You may also perform basic searches using the opportunity status, funding instrument type, eligibility, etc.

NIFA also has a Search for a Funding Opportunity page where searches may be performed using key word(s), funding opportunity number, AL number, etc.

Q. What's the difference between the checks that Grants.gov performs on the application and those performed by NIFA?

The Grants.gov system performs a limited check of the application, including a check for completion of all required form fields. Grants.gov will notify you of the outcome of the initial review.

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NIFA staff perform precursory review of the application. The agency validation process includes meeting eligibility requirements and following NIFA application guidelines. This will include a check for correct formatting, conformance with page limitations, and budget request limits.

NIFA will notify you of the outcome of this review.

Q. Can an individual serve as a PI on more than one grant or would this be considered a multiple or duplicate submission?

The same PI can be listed on multiple grants as long as they are different proposals.

A person serving as PI on more than one different proposal would not cause these applications to be considered multiple or duplicate submissions.

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